



A living sanctuary

ORDER

Deliverance, Conscience, and the Architecture of Freedom

By Kirby de Lanerolle

“He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation. For by Him all things were created that are in heaven and that are on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers. All things were created through Him and for Him. And He is before all things, and in Him all things consist.”

— Colossians 1:15–17

To Africa — beloved, rising, and stepping into her new season of light.

WOW Media Productions (PVT) Ltd · 2026

How to use this book

This book is both a roadmap and a feast. It offers simple direction for those beginning their journey of faith and deep revelation for individuals who are walking closely with the Holy Spirit. To receive its fullness, we urge you to read it completely and prayerfully. Every page carries a piece of the whole, and its true power unfolds when the process is experienced from beginning to end.

This is neither a quick fix nor a formula; it is an invitation to a transformational lifelong journey that begins with surrender. As you open these pages, expect to encounter the Spirit of God speaking to your heart, revealing patterns, and bringing freedom one layer at a time. Try not to think of it as an exercise to be rushed through, or a book to be ticked off the list. God has brought you to this place; let Him guide you through the process day by day, and reveal to you the freedom and authority that was designed to be yours.

As you read, you will notice certain truths and principles appear more than once. This is intentional. The language of the Spirit is layered, and revelation often unfolds through repetition that deepens your understanding and anchors truth in your spirit. This pattern follows Bishop Kirby de Lanerolle's teaching rhythm, through which profound concepts are revisited from new angles until they move from knowledge into experience. Allow the repetition to shape you; every return is a new depth.

The three parts

Part One — Understanding the Battlefield. This first part lays a firm foundation of theology upon which you can build understanding. It wakes you up with a bang, reveals the patterns that have shaped your life, and then prepares your heart and conscience to reclaim the spiritual authority that is your inheritance. Read it slowly. Pause where the Holy Spirit highlights truth. Allow each insight to settle and reshape how you see God, yourself, and the world around you. Keep a journal beside you to record what is revealed. Part One builds the inner frame that will hold the weight of what comes next.

Part Two — Taking Back Authority. Here you move from understanding to application. The 7 steps of Taking Back Authority guide you through awareness, confession, repentance, alignment, and testimony. Each step contains teaching and reflection exercises designed to help you partner with the Holy Spirit in practical ways. Take your time with each one. The steps are not meant to be rushed. You may spend days, or even weeks, on a single step as you discern, pray, and apply what God shows you. To support you in this section we have included tools such as the Strongholds and Legal Rights Assessment and the 7 Steps at a Glance to help you develop a daily practice. Transformation takes place when truth becomes lived reality.

Part Three — Walking in the Light. Freedom flourishes in community. You were never meant to walk alone. Even your freedom has an outward purpose—to build up the Body of Christ. The same grace that restores you will flow through you to help others rise. Your story will become someone else's hope. Stay connected to a spiritual covering, a fellowship of believers, or a trusted pastoral team. If you do not yet have a spiritual home, Kirby invites you to connect with WOWLife Church. You are about to rediscover what it means to walk in authority, as a son or daughter who reigns from rest.

Keys to the Order

Infiltration, not invasion. Jesus did not take first-century Palestine by spectacle. He entered quietly, and occupancy shifted. Loud religion often drives away the very people who need to come near.

Rank under Christ. Freedom is not the absence of structure. It is life under a rightful King. Command without obedience is just noise.

The tribunal of the heart. Conscience is where Heaven holds court. If the truth never reaches your sleep, your gut, your startle — it is still only an idea.

Sit before you study. Stillness is not an accessory to this book. Authority that does not come from intimacy with God will, sooner or later, become ambition.

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Introduction

Over a period of six months, Fiona and I lost three of our closest friends— our spiritual father and mother, and the co-founder of WOWLife Church who served as a father figure on our diocesan board. As we stepped into a broader apostolic calling, we keenly felt the absence of the grey-haired guides to whom we could bow our own heads. I had recently engaged a mega-church pastor whose wisdom, lineage, and steadiness impressed me— a man whose apostolic reach might easily open great doors. Yet the Lord settled something quite different in my heart; a kingdom businessman, reluctant even to take a title, quietly drew my allegiance. Fiona, ever the clear judge of spirits, confirmed we should book tickets to the All Shall Prosper summit on the Gold Coast in Australia, so that we might meet this man, Dave Hodgson. There, amid his careful oversight of sound and media— calling his team to run a world-class conference on kingdom economy— we approached him and asked him to be our covering and spiritual father.

Dave Hodgson ticks every box: apostolic in temperament, unbending in justice amidst a world governed by false scales, co- founder of the All Shall Prosper movement which is rooted in applied biblical economics, billionaire, inventor, strategist, SAS commando, mercenary, and founder of Kingdom Initiatives— the world’s largest network of Christian business leaders. Yet it was the formation of his Selous Scouts that struck me as the word for this season: men trained not for bluster or parade, but for infiltration— to transform or dismantle. Infiltrate to remediate! The phrase stayed with me like the steady measure of a marching drum, a whisper of Heaven’s own strategy.

Our world today is weighed down by injustice, corruption, and the shadow-workings of Babylon. If we are to topple corrupt seats, our first movement must be infiltration, not invasion. Most kingdom strategies to date have mirrored invasion— loud, bright, insistent. The gospel shines, but often so fiercely that those who glimpse it recoil, covering their eyes instead of drawing near. Why did the Anointed King urge those who discovered His power to remain silent? Why did the Wise Men refrain from returning to Herod? Why was He hidden in a manger, the most unlikely place for a king? Could it be that Heaven’s stratagem was infiltration: to step into the world unobserved, inconspicuous, clothed not in pomp but in quiet authority.

When Satan confronted Jesus of Nazareth, the carpenter’s son, his probing was not merely temptation but reconnaissance. Jesus answered, “Do you dare to test the Lord your God? Bow and worship the King.” Later, meeting him in Peter, Jesus responded with a command of rank, not rage. It was the clipped order of a seasoned officer: Get thee behind me. Not an expulsion, but a correction of station.

Jesus knew from the Scriptures where such words were first spoken. Jehu, anointed yet unrecognized, driven to Jezreel under prophetic mandate, issuing that same command— servo acharai— and the servants aligned themselves at once. The kingdom was not seized by force but settled by rightful authority; the servants, long propping up a false throne, cast Jezebel down at a single word. Three eunuchs — neutral powers hijacked by lower dominions— shifted allegiance in a breath. Perhaps the pattern holds: that principalities, elements, the very forces that shape wind, water, earth, fire, and even the stars designed to serve God’s children, have been unlawfully commandeered only because rightful kings abdicated, as Ahab did.

“He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation. For by Him all things were created that are in heaven and that are on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or

dominions or principalities or powers. All things were created through Him and for Him. And He is before all things, and in Him all things consist. And He is the head of the body, the church, the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in all things He may have the preeminence.”

Col. 1:15

Can this chapter in Colossians literally mean what it says: That it's not them against us; they were all created to worship our God; and the Ekklesia are destined to bring them back under authority?

At home, Fiona and I do not fight with our dogs. Though their nature includes the instinct to bite and attack, that impulse is not directed toward us. They were created to rule, govern, and destroy the sons of men who mirror them, but not the sons of God who are transformed into His image.

When Jannes and Jambres confessed, “This is the finger of God,” they recognized, through their henotheistic lens, that their own gods had turned against them. Moses, emissary of El Elyon, used their symbols to dismantle their systems— the serpent of Apophis was swallowed by its own likeness. Yahweh was not confusing the matter; He showed His supremacy over every lesser throne; His servant commanded their gods! We have mistaken spiritual warfare for a pitched battle against principalities, when the call is to command them into rank under the Anointed King.

Allow me a personal story— not to mystify, but to steady the reader's hand through these harder sayings. Let the spirit of this testimony be its test: if Christ emerges with greater preeminence in your life, then the doctrine has done its work... Our Diocese in Sri Lanka grew from a single church to six hundred in nine months— a full gestational season. For the first time in the nation's history, a prime minister attended a Pentecostal, Charismatic, Evangelical (non-denominational) ordination. Growth of this sort stirs resistance. Ours is a Buddhist nation which has long been hostile to the Gospel; churches burned, pastors beaten, the soil drenched with the blood of martyrs. A sign and wonder that marked our ministry went viral, reaching millions. In a secular land where Christians are dismissed as myth-peddlers, a cabinet minister branded us as scammers.

Licenses came under pressure; companies were forcibly closed; I was painted as a drug exporter and a foreign spy. Fiona's modesty was stripped and misrepresented from mainline pulpits; books were written warning against our theology and good work. Our name even became an election weapon against the prime minister who had honored my ordination. Accusations multiplied without any hearing. My board urged Fiona and me to leave immediately, for containers belonging to my export firm had been seized. “Drugs to Iraq,” they alleged, though none had been opened— arrest first, evidence later. I left the country uncertain of return. Properties were marked for foreclosure; companies were shuttered without trial. Denominational leaders joined the chorus, and I was condemned without audience.

In exile, I wrestled with God over the apparent powerlessness of His kingdom against Leviathan's coils. Night after night I soaked my pillow, not for myself but for what looked like the triumph of corruption over the justice of Christ. International publications piled on. Even vindication did not grant rest; threats required bodyguards and constant relocation. Until one night, during a one-sided shouting match with the Maker, I heard Him speak to me like He spoke to Job:

Gird yourself and get ready to answer Me!

Can you draw out Leviathan with a hook, Or snare his tongue with a line which you lower?

Can you put a reed through his nose, Or pierce his jaw with a hook?

Will he make many supplications to you?

Will he speak softly to you?

Will he make a covenant with you?

No one is so fierce that he would dare stir him up.

Who then is able to stand against Me?

Who has preceded Me, that I should pay him?

Everything under heaven is Mine.

The Lord flashed back to my childhood when I was playing in the river next to my house and I was attacked by a massive Indian saltwater crocodile. That creature, feared and almost legendary in our town, became the living symbol of Leviathan— both in flesh and spirit. Just as the crocodile struck with stealth and power, so Leviathan had sought to strike fear, scandal, and oppression into my life. The crocodile's bite, though it missed my physical heel, had firmly taken hold of my soul. A year or so after that incident, my life went into turmoil. A scandal the size of a nation came upon me. At fifteen, I was falsely accused, arrested at my school, and splashed across every newspaper in the country. I was taken to the highest Criminal Investigation Unit— an environment no child should ever enter— where drug lords, kingpins, and serial killers walked the corridors. In the ensuing years of my adult life, I visited that unit twice more, on occasions where the mark of scandal placed on my life had now been integrated into my soul.

The Lord said, You have trafficked with Leviathan since youth. Everything under heaven is Mine. I answered, Lord, you know. Your King has been glorified; help me understand. The voice that followed was like many waters: Will you put a hook in his mouth? Will he no longer thunder but speak softly? Will he obey your command? I replied, Only in the name of the King. Fear left me, replaced by an authority I had never known. A shout roared out of me: In the name of Jesus, Leviathan, heel!

The heavens opened. A beast with a crocodile's head emerged through cloud and knelt: Command me, and I shall go where you send. Isaiah 54 rang out: "No weapon formed against you shall prosper... I created the destroyer to destroy; yet it shall not destroy you, for your righteousness is from Me."

So, I commanded it: Go to the swine of the earth— those who hate God, to the perversions and injustices of the world, to those misaligned with the Lord's commission. It departed, and the vision closed.

Within a week the government had fallen; the minister who opposed us was exposed for bribery and abuse, and sent to prison. Religious leaders who sided with him faced similar disgrace. Overnight, the tide turned: I was appointed coordinator to the President over 2,000 non-denominational churches and Bishop over nearly 800 free churches in Sri Lanka. I was later made General Secretary of the International Independent Apostolic Diocesan Synod (IIADS), serving over eleven thousand churches worldwide.

Since then, Fiona and I have walked in peace and favor, our work thriving, amidst a flourishing community

at home and abroad.

The pages ahead will, I trust, open your eyes to the keys of the kingdom, my prayer echoing Paul's ancient cry: that you may behold the glory of God in His Ekklesia.

Part One • Understanding the Battlefield

Opening · El Mistater (“The Hidden One”)

The Hidden One unveils what was concealed.

Have you ever wondered why deliverance beats at the very heart of the ministry of the Lord Jesus Christ? Or what ancient knowledge stirred in the demons of the Gerasene when they cried, “Let us alone! What have we to do with You, Jesus of Nazareth? Have You come to destroy us?” What did they recognize in Him— who He was, or the moment He carried— that made them tremble at the thought He might be arriving before the appointed time? How could they be so certain their judgment was inevitable, yet so unsure of when He would activate it?

Have you considered why Jesus granted Legion’s plea to enter the swine? Could it be that he was not acquiescing, but rather releasing a force that would overturn an entire economy, sinking it beneath the waves? His deliverance was never tame. It did not loosen chains from wrists and ankles only.

What follows is an intentionally unsettling invitation into a revolutionary vision of deliverance. Jesus was— and remains— a figure who divides the room. Every miracle, every healing, every exorcism carried both offense and freedom in equal measure. His birth, His death, His resurrection all moved in the rhythm Paul called foolishness— the strange wisdom by which God chooses the low, the despised, and the dismissed to dismantle the structures of the wise.

“*I thank You, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that You have hidden these things from the wise and prudent and have revealed them to babes.*”

The Kingdom of God is an upside-down system through which the Father unveils Himself to the mature— the babes— those who hunger beyond the surface of things. This book is a summons to that maturity. The Father does not trade in trivialities; His Kingdom comes in Spirit, and with power. It is imbued with the wisdom Paul described as that which is whispered “among the mature,” the ancient mystery ordained before time that the secret rulers never understood; for had they known, “they would not have crucified the Lord of glory.”

The Book of Isaiah, chapter 54, is our doorway into this hidden wisdom. It describes a lament reborn as a promise in which Zion— the barren, forsaken woman— is told her womb will swell with life. Shame will fall away, her borders will stretch, and her descendants will overflow the limits once imposed on her. A new order is being announced— one that expands, restores, and rebuilds. Yet Isaiah refuses to let us settle for comfort. He pushes us into deeper, stranger questions:

Who is the destroyer— and why did God create him?

Is the barren woman Eden, the Church, or the earth itself?

Who are the children she will bring forth, and how will they ransack desolate cities?

The chapter crescendos into a luminous, unshakeable vision: foundations laid with jewels, walls cut from gems, children taught by the Lord Himself, a people living in the deep currents of shalom. Oppression breaks. Fear dissolves. Terror loses jurisdiction. Though enemies may gather like storm clouds they cannot

breach her walls— for God Himself stands within them.

And then Isaiah seals this word with a vow carved into eternity:

“No weapon formed against you will prosper. Every accusing tongue will fall silent.”

This vindication is the inheritance of the servants of the Lord and the song of those who seek out what has been hidden.

Will you dare to let Him uncover what has been hidden in you?

“He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together.”

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. Why does deliverance beat at the heart of Christ’s ministry — and where have you asked Him to “let us alone”?
2. What did occupancy recognize in Him that you have refused to recognize?
3. Where is God still El Mistater in you — hidden — and where is He unveiling?

Activate • The Hidden One

Father, You are El Mistater — the God who hides, and the God who reveals.

Unveil what was concealed. I will not fear the hidden.

I receive Your light in the places I have kept dark.

Amen.

Exercise • Name the hidden

Write one thing occupancy has asked Jesus to leave alone in you — and one unveiling you consent to before you leave this chamber.

Chapter 1 • An Offensive Kingdom

The kingdom advances by infiltration, not spectacle.

A KINGDOM THAT NEVER BOWS



Since the foundation of the world, the Kingdom of God has been advancing. Creation itself carries the mystery of this Kingdom, visible only to those with eyes to see. God dwells in the invisible realm, and from that realm He shaped the visible universe. He upholds it all by the word of His power. Whenever God claims territory, He does not fight for it — He creates it. God never battles for what He already owns. He placed the very glory that makes Heaven unique into the Garden of Eden. His presence, Heaven's essence, permeated the garden like a fragrance. Humanity, in Eden, bore God's likeness, and Eden reflected Heaven.

This crest of history which we currently inhabit mirrors the crescendo of the age into which Jesus Christ entered first-century Palestine. To see this strategy more clearly, we must first consider the political and economic landscape of that place and time. It was a violent, volatile, and brutally exploitative world, where Israel had lived under foreign domination for nearly four hundred years, passing from empire to empire. After the Maccabean revolt, the Hasmonean rulers held power for about a century, but instead of restoring justice, they plundered their own people, often in worse ways than the foreign powers they had overthrown, while simultaneously claiming Mosaic legitimacy.

By the time Rome took control, the situation had become unbearable. Roman occupation relied on a local aristocracy who maintained their wealth and privilege by squeezing their own people with oppressive taxation. Ordinary Jews were effectively double taxed, first by the Temple system, which had become economically extractive, and then by the Roman state, which demanded unrelenting tribute.

The priestly elites entrusted with stewarding the covenant participated in, and benefited from, structures that drove their own communities into poverty and starvation. Many families became so economically crushed that they sold their children into servitude. This desperation ignited periodic rebellions, which Rome squashed with such unrelenting terror that the region was stripped bare and its population left traumatized, fragmented, and exhausted under an economy of fear. This is the world that Jesus confronted, not by mirroring Rome's violence, but by unleashing a Kingdom that healed, restored, and reordered human life

from the inside out.

Jesus directly challenged the corrupt economic, religious, and political systems of His day. He called their leaders to repent, but they refused because they had too much to lose. Their allegiance was neither to God, nor the people, but rather to the systems that served their own selfish gain by making them rich. Jesus' ministry exposed these systems by offering the people what neither Rome nor the Temple could ever provide: freedom, healing, dignity, and direct access to God without an intermediary.

In turning over the tables of the money changers at the Temple, Jesus confronted the machinery of exploitation by transforming the money system from within. Jesus called tax collectors like Matthew and Zacchaeus into discipleship. By redeeming those embedded in the taxation network, he weakened the internal structure of economic oppression. Then He healed the people without cost— restoring bodies and dignity outside the economy of religious transaction— which had a profound impact upon the Temple healing rituals that relied on offerings and sacrificial payments and cut into a major revenue stream of the Temple establishment.

Both the religious and the Roman rulers preferred a weakened population who were dependent on them, but Jesus restored strength, hope and agency to the people, to build a community that could not be easily controlled. He forgave sins— directly offering forgiveness outside the sacrificial system— and He bypassed the Temple's monopoly on atonement. This struck at the theological and economic heart of their power. When Jesus turned over the tables of the money changers, this was not just a physical act that disrupted the Temple's commercial engine, it was also a prophetic act of enormous symbolism that heralded the collapse of an oppressive system that exploited pilgrims in God's name.

These were not random events. They were deliberate, strategic blows against an entire ecosystem of oppression. The religious and political elites saw exactly what He was doing and set about to eliminate Him. His actions undercut their profit, threatened their authority, and dismantled the narrative that justified their dominance. Jesus was arrested and brought before Pilate, the representative of Rome in Israel, who questioned Him about His kingship, and Jesus declared, "My Kingdom is not of this world." At first glance this seems paradoxical, but the parable he tells in Matthew 21:33–45 explains it.

Jesus speaks of a landowner who plants a vineyard and leases it to tenants. When the landowner sends his servants to collect the fruit, the tenants beat them and stone them to death. Finally, the landowner sends his son, but the tenants murder him too, hoping to seize the inheritance. Jesus asks the listeners what the owner will do, then when the religious leaders are too afraid to speak, He declares that the owner will destroy those wicked tenants and give the vineyard to others. He then sends His message home when he quotes Psalm 118, "The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone," revealing that Israel's leaders are the violent tenants, His prophets are the servants they rejected, and He is the Son they are about to kill. Because of this, Jesus declares, the Kingdom will be taken from them and given to a people who bear its fruit. The priests and Pharisees understand that He is speaking about them, but fearing the crowds, they seek to arrest Him at another time.

Jesus affirmed His kingship, but because it did not originate from this world, He refused to defend it by worldly means. And therefore, the world had no authority to grant or remove it. They could not "reject" Him as King or take His life— He laid it down of His own volition. The world was too small to contain His reign,

but for those with ears to hear, He was asserting His supremacy over the entire cosmos.

Pilate questioned Jesus about kingship from a political frame of legalities, declarations, and worldly legitimacy. But Jesus answered from a Kingdom mindset rooted in obedience to His Father's will, not the approval of empires. Rome could interrogate His kingship, but it could neither recognize nor invalidate it. This posture is not passive; it is authority. As God's Son, His very being and identity naturally carried dominion. Pilate was not executing Him, for he had no jurisdiction to judge Him; Jesus chose to lay down His life. His death, therefore, was not defeat but enthronement.

The parable and the trial reveal the same dynamic: Pilate and the religious leaders claimed to care about truth, law, and God, yet could not perceive the Kingdom standing before them. Christ's Kingdom is received by those who discern the invisible realm and allow its truth to transform them. He rules and advances His Kingdom on earth not through coercion, but through truth. Jesus entered the world at a moment of systemic corruption to confront it, and to give us a model for doing the same.

Today, as it was then, self-centered and malevolent forces resist God's redemptive plan for creation, imposing cycles of distress and disorder to divert humanity from flourishing. Yet the Kingdom of God is one of order, and God's desire is for creation to flourish. Misreadings of Matthew 11:12: "The Kingdom of Heaven suffers violence, and the violent take it by force," have fueled forms of radical Christian fundamentalism that promote violent zeal and division, but this was never the intention of Scripture. The "violence" Jesus speaks of is not directed toward people or creation. God's love aims to bless and prosper humanity. The violence is directed at the forces that persecute, corrupt, and deform human life. When God gave Adam and Eve dominion, it was over creation—not over other human beings. Anything contrary to this is witchcraft.

Dominion is the right to rule over a sphere of influence, and Adam was given authority to extend God's influence over the earth. In the same way God is King over the universe, Adam was installed as king over the earth because the mandate to govern had been entrusted to him by God. His dominion was positional—something he had to occupy—and it was connected to place, rank, and appointment. He was set in the Garden of Eden to rule over creation. He did not seize this authority; it was assigned to him. He held dominion even before he understood how to exercise it, just as a child born a prince possesses positional authority before he develops governance skills.

His dominion was also ontological, flowing from the image and likeness of God he bore. Hebrews 1:3 speaks of Christ as "the radiance of the Father's glory," and Adam reflected that glory as God's image-bearer. His dominion was therefore not merely a role he held, but a nature he carried. And it was rooted in his story—his origin, purpose, relationship, and destiny. His dominion was his identity, not a tactic.

The tragedy of history is that angelic rebellion, together with a fallen humanity, twisted dominion into domination, unleashing chaos across creation, which included human societies. Thus, "the violent take it by force" is not a mandate for zealotry and aggression, it is a description of God's strategy to overthrow the kosmokrator, the world-ruler or dark spiritual power, but more on that shortly. For now, hold this frame in your heart and your mind as we move into the unfolding story.

THE STENCH OF DEATH

“For we are to God the pleasing aroma of Christ among those who are being saved and those who are perishing. To the one we are an aroma that brings death; to the other, an aroma that brings life. And who is equal to such a task?”

2 CORINTHIANS 2:14–16

The Kingdom challenges everything that resists the rule of Christ. And we, as members of His triumphant procession, are charged with releasing that very fragrance wherever we go. However, the Kingdom does more than offend human sensibilities, it advances. It moves. It takes ground. It is a strategic weapon forged in Heaven, aimed at dismantling the oppressive systems of darkness that still try to govern the earth. As the people of Christ move, so does His fragrance— permeating cities, families, systems, and nations until the whole earth is saturated with the knowledge of the glory of the Lord. We do not determine how it is received; we simply bear it. We carry the scent of His knowing into every space He leads, trusting that His presence will do what only His presence can.

SUB CONTRARIO

Yet, despite its offensive nature, the Kingdom remains subtle and hidden to all except those with the eyes to see. Therefore, it must be sought. The wisdom of the Kingdom runs contrary to the world’s logic; it is sub contrario, with its power being revealed through what appears to be weak. The glory of the Kingdom is veiled in what looks ordinary, and its authority is disguised in humility.

Scripture describes earth as a kind of vassal state, entrusted to stewards who often reject the true King. Even Jesus had to ask, “Who do men say that I am?” because the Kingdom is recognized only by revelation. It cannot be grasped through performance or status, only through divine unveiling.

When the enemy rushes in like a flood, the Lord raises a standard of righteousness, and the ambassadors of His Kingdom carry that standard not with arrogance but with grace, humility, and authority enabled by the Spirit. Justice and righteousness operate quietly, counterintuitively, upside-down from the world’s expectations, to establish the order of the King wherever they are embodied.



“He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together.”

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. Where have you been invading (loud, bright, insistent) instead of infiltrating (quiet occupancy)?
2. God never battles for what He already owns. What have you been fighting for that is already His?
3. Where does spectacle still recoil the ones who need to draw near?

Activate • Infiltration

King Jesus, I receive Your strategy: infiltration, not invasion.

I refuse spectacle as my default. I occupy quietly under Your command.

This ground is already Yours. I take my place in it.

Amen.

Exercise • One quiet occupancy

Name one sphere where you have been loud. Write the quieter occupancy you will practice this week.

Chapter 2 • Order and Rank

Freedom flourishes within structure.

THE THEOLOGY OF ORDER, RANK, AND JUDGEMENT

The theological premise of rank and order is well illustrated in the second book of Kings, Chapter Nine. In this account, God sent the prophet Elisha to anoint Jehu, a military commander, as the new king over Israel. Elisha was instructed to go to Ramoth-Gilead, find Jehu, and secretly pour oil over him as a sign that he was God's chosen instrument. The prophet obeyed God's command precisely. A servant of Elisha found Jehu, poured oil on his head, and told him, "The Lord has anointed you king of Israel. You are chosen to overthrow the house of Ahab and bring judgment on Jezebel for her wickedness." Through Elisha, the Lord gave Jehu a clear commission: to strike down the house of Ahab, bring judgment on Ahab's family for their evil actions, and avenge the blood of the Lord's servants shed by Jezebel and her family.

When Jehu's fellow officers heard what had happened, they quickly rallied to support him as king. Jehu mounted his chariot and rode toward Jezreel, where King Joram, Ahab's son, was recovering from his battle wounds whilst King Ahaziah of Judah was visiting him. As Jehu approached, messengers were sent to ask if he came in peace. He replied, "What peace, as long as the sins and witchcraft of Jezebel continue?" Realizing Jehu's intent, Joram tried to flee, but Jehu shot and killed him with an arrow. Ahaziah also attempted to escape but was wounded and later died.



Then Jehu went to Jezebel, who was in her palace. She painted her eyes and dressed herself up to face him from an upper window. Jehu called out to the palace servants, "Who is on my side?" A few eunuchs looked down at him and Jehu commanded them, "Throw her down!" They promptly threw Jezebel out of the window, and she died. Her body was eaten by dogs, fulfilling the prophecy Elijah had spoken years before—that Jezebel would be eaten by dogs in Jezreel.

POSSESSION AND DRIVE



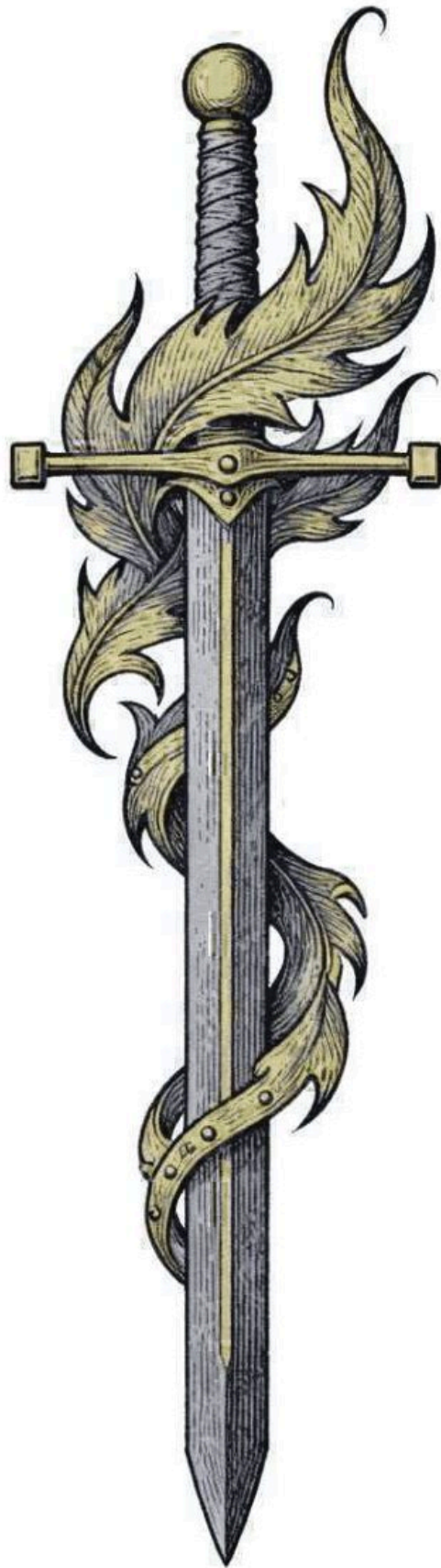
2 Kings 9 portrays Jehu as a man possessed by divine purpose and an uncompromising momentum toward justice and purity.

The Bible describes his speed, fury, and violence almost as if he's under an overwhelming force: "The driving is like that of Jehu son of Nimshi... he drives like a madman." Jehu fulfilled prophecy by destroying the house of Ahab and the worship of Baal; but he didn't act on personal vengeance—he was under prophetic commission.

Jesus too had a sense of intensity about him. After His baptism, "The Spirit drove Him into the wilderness." This drivenness wasn't manic or egoic, it was Spirit-led compulsion toward purification and testing. The Greek word *ekballei* (drive out) implies a strong inner compulsion, not random wandering, but inspired confrontation. Yet there was a key difference in order and scope: Jehu was driven to purify Israel outwardly, confronting sin and injustice in the nation; Jesus was first led inward, to be purified, tested, and prepared.

In the wilderness, Jesus faced the adversary, who offered the distorted desire of power, pride, and appetite. For only after His own purification could Jesus step into His mission to purify and restore humanity. The wilderness of testing equipped Him to confront not only human weakness but the power of darkness itself. It was the Spirit who drove Jesus into the wilderness, not Satan.

RIGHTEOUS ZEAL AND DIVINE ORDER



Jehu's mission was to restore divine order which had been corrupted by idolatry, manipulation, and confusion. He removed the rulers who had inverted divine order, and he restored the rank which Ahab had abdicated and Jezebel had usurped. He was a corrective force against chaos and spiritual rebellion.

When Peter tried to persuade Jesus not to go to the Cross, Jesus said, "Get behind Me, Satan! You are an offense to Me, for you are not mindful of the things of God, but the things of men." Jesus was not issuing a rebuke, nor was he imploring Satan not to tempt Him, rather He was restoring divine order because Peter was speaking from fear and self-preservation. Jesus was saying, "I lead, you follow!" thereby restoring a godly hierarchy. "Get thee behind me!" was therefore a command to realign with purpose and mission. By referring to Peter as Satan he was identifying and naming the rebellious energy that inverts order and exalts self-will over divine will. Jesus perfectly modeled authority under authority. He did not destroy the one who was out of order, He re-positioned him into the flow of obedience, for the Kingdom of God is a structured domain with rank and file, authority, and obedience.

"Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation... But if I cast out demons by the Spirit of God, then the Kingdom of God has come upon you."

MATTHEW 12:25-28

RANK, ORDER, AND NEUTRALITY

Every kingdom, whether divine or rebellious, operates through rank and file. At the top are the ruling principles (prince or principality); in the middle are those who serve or carry out the will of the ruling principle— such as agents, soldiers, or various instruments of power; and at the bottom are those elements controlled by the ruling principle— what we may refer to as the field. This includes human hearts, environments, and systems (both living and non-living). Neutrality is the zone of non-alignment, or the part that could tip either way. This is what Jesus was referring to in Matthew 12:30 when he said, "He who is not with Me is against Me; and he who does not gather with Me scatters." This neutral space is the battleground for allegiance. The question you must ask yourself in your neutral ground, is whether it will come under divine order or demonic distortion?



In Jehu's story, the Eunuchs were the neutral zone. When Jehu rode into Jezreel, Jezebel painted her eyes, looked down from the window, and taunted him. Jehu did not strike Jezebel himself, but he issued an order: "'Who is on my side? Who?' Two or three eunuchs looked out at him. Then he said, 'Throw her down!' So they threw her down." The eunuchs (castrated male servants) represented those caught in Jezebel's system, but who did not fully identify with her spirit. They served her outwardly, but inwardly they were disempowered and stripped of generative authority (literally and symbolically). Think about Jezebel's eunuchs. They were right there in the palace, operating like shadows, doing what she told them, but they couldn't really create anything of their own. They were cut off, with no virility, no power to reproduce, and no legacy. They could follow orders, but they couldn't build a future. Their impotence symbolized a deeper truth: systems that castrate their servants can demand loyalty, but they cannot impart life. They produce activity, but never inheritance.

And this is the point— inheritance is not the product of coercion or performance. True inheritance is never seized; it is received. It flows by grace, not by striving. It cannot be taken by force, earned through effort, or manufactured within a barren system. Inheritance comes from the source of life itself, like a gift from a generous parent to a child. Jezebel's system could command obedience, but it could not give identity, future, or fruitfulness.

Yet in this moment, they shifted allegiance. When Jehu rode in and asked, "Who's on my side?" a few responded. Their act of throwing her down was more than a physical gesture or a political betrayal, it was the collapse of a system that had kept them disempowered. They responded to Jehu's call— which was the Spirit's call for re-alignment with divine order— and by doing so, they became the tipping point that dethroned their oppressor.

The eunuchs represent inner faculties or soul aspects that have been neutralized and made passive or voiceless under controlling systems of fear, manipulation, and self-protection. When divine authority arrives, those same parts are reawakened to agency and turn against their false master. We see this beautifully illustrated in Isaiah.

"Do not let the son of the foreigner who has joined himself to the LORD speak, saying, 'The LORD has utterly separated me from His people'. Nor let the eunuch say, 'Here I am, a dry tree.' For thus says the LORD: 'To the eunuchs who keep My Sabbaths, and choose what pleases Me, and hold fast My covenant, even to them I will give in My house and within My walls a place and a name better than that of sons and daughters. I will give them an everlasting name that shall not be cut off.'"

ISAIAH 56:3-5

In Matthew 16:23, when Jesus says to Peter, "Get thee behind Me, Satan," He was reordering the rank. Peter was not evil, but he had temporarily become a neutral host for a principle of fear of suffering. Jesus did not destroy Peter, he repositioned him behind, not in front. "Behind Me" restored the correct spiritual formation with Christ leading and Peter following as His disciple. Just as Jehu called out, "Who is on my side?" and the eunuchs responded, Jesus called the neutral part of Peter, the confused, well-meaning but misaligned will, back into order. The eunuchs' act of throwing Jezebel down was equivalent to the soul's act of "casting down arguments that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God, bringing every thought into captivity to

the obedience of Christ, and being ready to punish all disobedience when your obedience is fulfilled.”

Likewise in Mark 5:1–20, in the Gerasene deliverance, Jesus meets a man possessed by Legion, a vast network of demonic influence. When Jesus cast the demons out, they begged to enter a herd of pigs. Jesus gave them permission to enter the pigs which rush into the sea and are drowned. The man represented the human vessel that was once possessed and enslaved by the legion of demons and is now restored. The pigs represented neutral flesh that was ungoverned, instinctual, and without divine alignment. The sea represented the chaos of the unstructured unconscious.

The demons were seeking a neutral host with no inner hierarchy, rank, or spiritual spine. The pigs could not order or resist them, so they self-destructed under that weight. The story dramatizes the danger of neutral ground held under hostage by entities out of rank. So, where there is no clear alignment, chaos enters and consumes the vessel.

NEUTRALITY IS NEVER NEUTRAL



Every soul carries eunuch parts— energies, memories, or aspects that were once fruitful but became sterile and barren through trauma, fear, or domination. They stand at the window of Jezebel’s tower, watching, waiting.

They are battlegrounds of allegiance. When divine authority calls, those parts must choose— Jezebel or Jehu, fear or order, ego or Spirit— and move from neutrality into alignment, restoring divine rank, order, and flow. The Spirit moving through Jehu doesn’t destroy the eunuchs, but calls them to step out of fear, reclaim agency, and throw down control. In the same way, Jesus’ command, to “Get behind Me,” restores proper alignment. The story of the pigs warns us that if the soul remains neutral, without Spirit or moral order, it becomes a vessel for chaos. What is ungoverned, like the pigs, self-destructs. Conversely, the eunuchs reveal what happens when neutral ground turns toward God.

MOCKERY, MASKS, AND IMPOSTER ENERGY



“When Jehu came to Jezreel, Jezebel heard of it, and she painted her eyes and adorned her head and looked out of the window. And as Jehu entered the gate, she said, ‘Is it peace, Zimri, murderer of your master?’”

2 KINGS 9:30–31

Jezebel painted her eyes, not merely as an act of beauty but as ritualized self-presentation. In ancient cultures, eye-painting with kohl symbolized charisma, control, and enchantment. We can equate Jezebel painting her eyes with donning a mask. In his work on agency disruption and altered identity states, Patrick McNamara (2009; 2022), describes the donning of masks as a possession ritual that prepares the wearer for the onset of a possession experience. In Jezebel's case, she was entering into a ritual technology through which she was arming herself with power. The kohl became a portal between the threshold of the physical and the spiritual for entities to oscillate in and out of her.

This practice was probably rooted in her identity as the daughter of Ithobaal, King of Tyre and Priest of Astarte, the Phoenician goddess of love, war, and sovereignty. Her father's name, Ithobaal, means “Baal is with him.” Jezebel's marriage to Ahab was likely part of a state alliance between Israel and Phoenicia. As the daughter of the high priest, Jezebel would have been initiated into the mysteries and ritual practices of Baal and Astarte worship, serving as a priestess or spiritual intermediary herself. It was vital that Jehu confronted Jezebel because her reign had led Israel astray by uniting God's people with Baalistic Phoenician powers, and Yahweh was no longer their only God.

Jezebel was using the eye makeup as a mask to channel her priestess authority and invoke the gods she served. The eyes are considered windows to the soul, and she was using kohl as a conjuring tool to summon the gods of her father Ithobaal. She employed kohl as a technology of the numinous interface, to create a portal between the physical and the spiritual. The kohl was used to ward off evil, bad luck, or harmful influences. Like the sigil of a sorcerer, the kohl transformed her gaze into a spiritual force, amplifying her presence and making her appear unshaken even as her kingdom was collapsing. It was a projection of image-based power — the invocation of the spirit of illusion or control through perception. This is the root of mockery and impostor energy that maintains an external mask to hide internal defeat.

Her taunt, “Is it peace, Zimri, murderer of your master?” was a psychological strike, not a physical one. By calling him “Zimri,” Jezebel was referring to an earlier commander who assassinated King Elah, seized the throne briefly, and was quickly destroyed. Jezebel was saying, You're just another pretender. You'll die like the rest. You're not a true king. It was a direct attack on Jehu's identity, legitimacy, and calling. Mockery is the voice of illegitimate authority defending its illusion. It cannot overpower truth, so it uses ridicule to sow doubt. The goal is to pull you down from your rank before you even take your position. Jezebel's taunt was not to win the battle, but to disrupt Jehu's internal authority to keep him from standing fully in his God-given role.

Jehu did not answer Jezebel's taunt. He didn't justify himself or defend his calling. He redirected his attention to alignment and loyalty by saying, “Who is on my side?” That's the posture of true authority. It does not argue with mockery, it commands order. When Peter says, “Far be it from You, Lord; this shall not happen to You,” Jesus recognized the same spirit of seductive influence. He replied, “Get thee behind Me, Satan; for you are not mindful of the things of God, but of men.” Like Jezebel's taunt, Peter's words tempted

Jesus to doubt the path and mission ahead and compromise rank, order and purpose. And just as Jehu did not reply to Jezebel, Jesus did not debate. He reordered the voice to get behind him and repositioned authority.

SILENCING THE MOCKERY OF THE IMPOSTOR



The anatomy of mockery comprises: Jezebel— who masks insecurity through control, performance, and manipulation with the mocking, accusatory voice of the inner impostor who questions your legitimacy; Jehu — the divine drive or purpose that rises to restore truth and alignment; and the window— which is the interface of the psyche that looks out into the world or the space where ego projects image. When Jehu (purpose and drive) confronts Jezebel (ego illusion), mockery is the last defense before collapse.

In Part Two, you will learn to recognize the voice of Jezebel that taunts from a height but has no real power. Like Jehu, you will discover how to lift your gaze and act from your commission. You will learn to call for alignment, “Who is on my side?” and give the command, “Get behind Me.” Then you will reorder your inner rank by placing the Holy Spirit at the top and ego beneath, until Jezebel’s painted face is crushed underfoot and you have reclaimed your spiritual rank through obedience, not image.

SINGULARITY OF PURPOSE



In the Book of Acts, chapter 4, when the Apostles— Peter and John— were threatened by the Sanhedrin and commanded not to speak or teach in the name of Jesus, instead of being quiet, they prayed and asked God to fill them with even more boldness. They refused to back down, and God honored their resolve such that, “When they had prayed, the place where they were assembled together was shaken; and they were all filled with the Holy Spirit, and they spoke the word of God with boldness.” This kind of drive is an offensive force that gets things done. It is the relentless, energetic effort that overcomes obstacles with a singularity of purpose. Interestingly, being offended by structures of injustice and unrighteousness can give us the drive needed to tear them down. Jesus encourages us that, “The Kingdom of Heaven suffers violence, and the violent take it by force.” In this passage Jesus was referring to John the Baptist as a transitional figure between the old order of the Law and the Prophets, and the new Kingdom breaking in through Himself. He was highlighting this moment as a head-on collision between the internal and external worlds.

Rather than inciting physical aggression here, Jesus is calling us to foster the inner propulsion and spiritual drive that refuses passivity. It is the divine order of Heaven to advance beyond our human limitation and refuse to let apathy, fear, or offense dictate reality. God honors an offensive posture of faith that moves toward purpose, rather than one that waits for it. It’s the spiritual muscle, developed through practice, that won’t let go until the promise is fulfilled. The violence of Matthew 11:12, therefore, is not destruction, but momentum. It is your agreement with the Kingdom of Heaven and your refusal to shrink back. It is your insistence to press through resistance and to yield your will to divine purpose.



THE BREATH THAT MOVES US



Psychologically, such drive emanates from desire and intention. It is the inner propulsion system— the force that compels you to act, pursue, create, and overcome. The Hebrew concept of ruach (רוּחַ) meaning spirit, breath, or wind— often represents God's life-giving power and presence. It is the Spirit of God that hovered over the waters at creation, symbolizing the creative and sustaining power that brings life and order out of chaos. This same Spirit is involved in inspiring ability, craftsmanship, and creative vitality in the individual members of the body. We encounter the Ruach in Ezekiel 37 (the Valley of Dry Bones), where the Spirit of God reanimated what was dead and dry, symbolizing renewal and revival that enables faith and spiritual action. In the New Testament He appears as the Ruach HaKodesh (Holy Spirit) who fell on believers to empower their faith and mission, activating their will and vision to advance God's Kingdom.

WHEN BREATH BECOMES DRIVE

When we talk about drive being linked to ruach, we are saying that our impulse to move, to act, to bring forth, is not merely psychological, it is pneumatic, meaning it is breathed into us from the same essence that moved over the waters in Genesis 1:2. For before there was order, before there was light, there was movement. The Ruach was hovering. The Hebrew word *merachefet* (מְרַחֵף) means to vibrate, tremble, and pulse with energy. Creation begins with the drive of divine energy in motion, seeking to bring forth life from chaos, and we learn from the Creator himself that before you do, something moves you. And that movement, that stirring of purpose is Ruach. But it is not yet moral, it is simply energy, capable of being directed toward good or evil. Throughout scripture, ruach governs both creation and judgement. Isaiah 40:7, reveals Ruach as disruptive: “The grass withers, the flower fades, because the breath of the LORD blows upon it; surely the people are grass.” Ruach is described as a purifier in Malachi 3 and a force of judgement in Isaiah 20:28: “His breath is like an overflowing stream, which reaches up to the neck, to sift the nations with the sieve of futility; and there shall be a bridle in the jaws of the people, causing them to err.”

WHEN TRUTH BECOMES NON-NEGOTIABLE

Conviction is the inner compass (the moral and spiritual clarity) that tells your drive where to go and why; if drive is the engine, conviction is the steering wheel. As Paul said, “I am fully persuaded...” It is formed by truth that has penetrated your heart so deeply that it becomes non-negotiable. This immovable certainty is conviction.

When the mind drifts from conviction, it becomes a slumbering spirit, not dead, but disconnected from its source of fire. We become enervated— even indolent— and we lose the fire in our soul. It is not so much the intentional choice of laziness but rather a disengaged heart, and a mind dangerously untethered from purpose. It's why scripture reminds us to, “Awake, you who sleep, arise from the dead, and Christ will give you light.”

So, we have discovered that the Kingdom of God operates on the offensive— with boldness, conviction, and drive— but we must also be aware that offense is the very weapon the enemy uses to neutralize that zeal for God's Kingdom purpose in your life. In the next chapter we will look at the anatomy of offense and how it can draw you out of the ranks of God's army and isolate you from your Kingdom assignment.

“Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation... But if I cast out demons by the Spirit of God, then the Kingdom of God has come upon you.”

Matthew 12:25–28

Ponder

1. Where is occupancy sitting in a seat that is not its own — in your house, your mind, your work?
2. Jehu did not seize by force; he settled by rightful authority. Where have you been seizing?
3. Who or what have you been propping up that Heaven has already judged?

Activate • Rank restored

I take my place under the command of Christ.

False thrones, lose your seat. Servants of occupancy, turn and follow the King.

Freedom flourishes within structure. I receive Order.

Amen.

Exercise • Name the false throne

Write the seat occupancy still holds. Then write the command of rank — not rage — you will speak over it.

Chapter 3 • The Trap of Offense

Offense is a legal right given away.

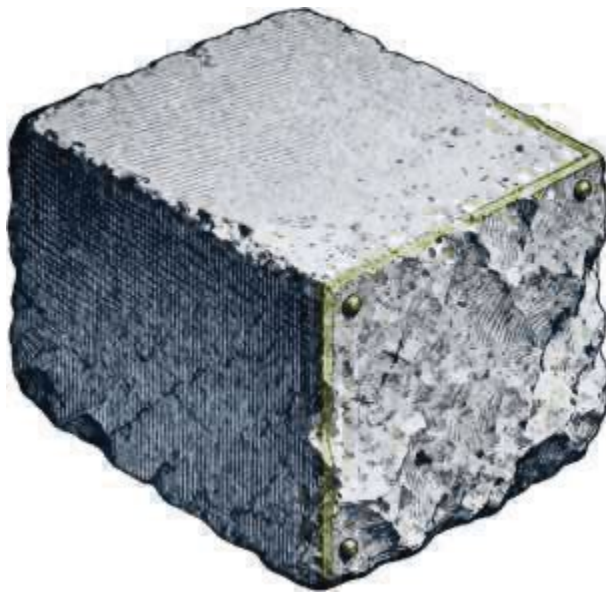
SCANDALON: THE TRAP THAT TRIPS YOUR FAITH

Can you remember a time when a promise you thought God had given you was not fulfilled? Did it lead to disappointment? Were you offended?

When we are drawn away from our purpose because of offense, our heart becomes lethargic, as the Apostle Paul emphatically warns us, “I myself always strive to have a conscience without offense toward God and men.” Jesus tells us in Matthew 11:6, “Blessed is he who is not offended because of me.” The Greek word for offense in this instance is scandalizo (μῆσκανδαλίσθῃ), from the word scandalon. In the Greek, scandalon originally meant a trap, a snare, or a stumbling block. More specifically, it is the trigger in a trap that causes it to close on its victim.

Scandalon is that offense that trips your momentum towards God, for when your heart is offended, your drive is redirected, or it simply comes to a halt. You begin to push against others instead of moving in the flow of the Spirit, and your understanding of and perspective on other people and the Word becomes so warped that it poisons your life. Instead of energy flowing forward in obedience, it starts looping inward as resentment and self-justification. The same passion that could build the Kingdom now builds walls of bitterness.

GOD AS SCANDALON



However, offense is also the test of every calling. Later we will examine how this works, but for now, just be aware that before you ascend to the next level of obedience, your drive will be confronted by something that offends your ego, your theology, and your sense of justice. Such offense is the scandalon, placed by God, not to destroy your drive but to refine it and separate fleshly zeal from spiritual conviction. God Himself becomes your scandalon, the rock of offense that confronts your drive so that it can be purified.

“Behold, I lay in Zion a stumbling stone, a rock of offense that causes people to stumble, and the one who believes in him will never be put to shame.”

ROMANS 9:33

THE SNARE IN THE HIGH PLACE



Offense can also show up as pride, and it will always come before a fall. Proverbs 16:18 tells us that “Pride goes before destruction, And a haughty spirit before a fall.” This proverb is not just moral advice but a spiritual law. Pride is the posture that lifts the self against God, and because God alone is the source of life, truth, and order, to rise against Him is to fall away from Him. Pride as a haughty spirit is the trajectory towards collapse. Passages like Isaiah 14:12–15, Ezekiel 28:12–17, and Jesus’ own words in Luke 10:18 paint a consistent picture of pride as an ontological rebellion. Pride is a manifestation of offense. It creates the inner posture that is easily wounded, easily threatened, and easily angered. Offense is pride’s emotional fruit. It is a distortion that flows from the desire for control and, without alignment to divine authority, it becomes a rebellion that seizes power.

With pride, it is the self and not the Master, that is the measure of what is fair, right, and worthy. You are enthroned at the center, and pride veils your sight, causing you to trip— not over something outside you— but over the height of your own ego. When pride becomes offense wearing the mask of justice, your emotions stop flowing from inspiration and begin moving by reaction. Your focus narrows to self- protection or vindication, which paves the way for a victim mentality.

The “rock of offense” is Christ Himself; He is the truth that confronts your false vision and invites you to see rightly. But if you remain offended, you stay on the surface, caught in a warped reflection, unable to discern the deeper pattern of grace at work.

OFFENSE DISGUISED AS JUSTICE



When you choose to use your own scales of justice because you don't trust those provided by the Master, self-righteousness is in play — another way that offense can manifest itself. Let's look at the Parable of the Workers in the Vineyard, in which a landowner hired laborers at different hours of the day— dawn, mid-morning, noon, afternoon, and even in the final hour. When evening came, he paid everyone the same wage, but those who worked longest took offense. Verse 12 says, "These last men have worked only one hour, and you made them equal to us who have borne the burden and the heat of the day." On the surface, it appears that their complaint was regarding money, but in reality, it was about justice on their terms.

Theirs was a self-righteous scale that measured worth by effort, not by the generosity of the Master, and it left them feeling cheated because they had confused merit with favor. Their work was motivated by ego, and it exposed their need to earn love and recognition.

In this case, self-righteousness cut them off from grace and became the will to achieve goodness without intimacy with the Giver. The older workers stumbled because the gift did not fit their sense of proportion; their offense twisted their drive into accusation, forcing them to see equality as injustice. Their drive to serve faithfully became resentment once reward was filtered through entitlement.

What was the opportunity being offered to the workers by the master? The answer is found in verses 13–15: "Friend, I am not being unfair to you... Don't I have the right to do what I want with my own money? Or are you envious because I am generous?" The Master was inviting them to see differently. He was not scolding

them but unveiling their lens. He was inviting them to move from justice by comparison to joy in grace. When drive aligns with grace, it produces joyful service, but when drive aligns with self-righteousness, it produces offense and, eventually, burnout. Verse 16 reveals that the logic of the Kingdom is, “the last will be first, and the first will be last.” In God’s Kingdom, the measure is mercy, not merit. Those who release their right to compare, move freely but those who cling to fairness become trapped in offense.

Faith is the inner drive that orients us toward what we cannot yet see. It is what Hebrews 11:1 describes as “the substance of things hoped for, and the evidence of things not seen.” Offense pulls faith in the opposite direction. Where faith moves us forward into what is unseen, offense locks us into what is immediately felt. Pride is the mechanism behind this, it is subtle, internal, and persuasive. It showed up as the whisper that first turned humanity inward on itself in the garden, saying “You deserve more... you are being withheld from... you should decide for yourself.” That whisper created offense before there was any wound. It planted suspicion toward God, and elevated self-perception over divine revelation.

THE WHISPERER IN THE GARDEN



How unexpected that in the rarified perfection of Eden, the shadow of offense was already lurking. Genesis 2–3 unveils this moment with striking clarity. God placed Adam and Eve in the garden to tend it and guard it. Out of the ground, He caused every tree to grow — trees that were not only good for food but also delightful to the eyes, full of beauty, pleasure, and abundance. Among them stood the Tree of Life and the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil. Adam and Eve were free to enjoy every tree except the one that carried the consequence of death. But whilst God was giving these instructions, another presence was listening from the margins. Hidden within Eden’s serenity, the whisperer watched and waited. And in that sacred place, the serpent approached Adam and Eve, introducing them to a voice that questioned, distorted,

and ultimately invited offense.

A UNIVERSAL SERPENT



It is striking that the serpent— who is otherwise known as the accuser, tempter, destroyer, and agent of death — appears not only in Christianity but across many of the world’s spiritual traditions. He is woven into humanity’s universal story.

The English word devil comes from the Hebrew *ha-satan*, meaning the adversary or the one who opposes, which is also the root of the name Satan. Scripture shows that there can be many adversaries, but we often group these opposing forces under the single title ‘Satan’. Our adversary is not concerned with our culture or background; he seeks only a vessel he can influence and inhabit. Every spirit— whether the Holy Spirit or a lesser being— seeks a place to dwell, and the whisperer never arrives alone. His companions linger in the shadows, waiting to occupy any space we open through deception, offense, or compromise. In Eden, this intrusion fractured the human heart, sowing offense, judgment, and suspicion where trust and harmony once lived.

THE STUMBLE

This word “fall” is translated from the Hebrew kishalon (כִּשְׁלוֹן) meaning “to stumble”. It is closely tied to the theme of pride we explored earlier, for pride is often what causes the stumbling in the first place. When Adam and Eve fell, their eyes closed to the things of God, but they were opened to the things of the world. The serpent came to the woman and told her, “God knows that on the day you eat of it [the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil] your eyes will be opened, and you will be like God, knowing good and evil.” But they were already like God! Genesis 1:26–28 tells us that God made man, “in His own image; in the image of God He created him, male and female he created them.”

Because they believed the serpent’s lie, Adam and Eve stepped out of God’s truth and into a polarity that was never intended for them. They began to create reality out of an environment projected by lies. Now their world was polarized into good and evil. Separated from their original wholeness, humanity began seeking solutions outside themselves, through effort, ritual, performance, and control. It trained their hearts to process life through external measurements, which made them vulnerable to what Paul referred to as the “weak and beggarly elements.” By embracing polarity, they forfeited union with God for a realm where everything is filtered through contrast, judgment, and self-referential awareness. Instead of being conscious of God, they became self-conscious and now “knew that they were naked.”

The testing of Adam and Eve’s hearts came because they were the sons of God. They already had the spirit of God on them and God had revealed their inheritance. The whisperer entered with the haughty question, “Did God really say?” And this same haughty spirit, lurking in the shadows of Genesis 2 and 3, appears again in the story of Cain and Abel.

CAIN’S WOUND



“Now Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground. And in the process of time it came to pass that Cain brought an offering of the fruit of the ground to the LORD. Abel also brought of the firstborn of his flock and of their fat. And the LORD respected Abel and his offering, but he did not respect Cain and his offering. And Cain was very angry, and his countenance fell.”

GENESIS 4:2–5

Because Cain was offended by the favor God showed Abel, he fell into blame, domination, and rivalry with his brother, that led to bitterness and murder. As his gaze turned downward (“his countenance fell,”) Cain lost sight of God and his brother and only saw his wound, his comparison, and his shame.

“So the LORD said to Cain, “Why are you angry? And why has your countenance fallen? If you do well, will you not be accepted? And if you do not do well, sin lies at the door. And its desire is for you, but you should rule over it.”

GENESIS 4:6–7

Cain mistook God’s correction for rejection. His gaze, like the laborers in the field, became clouded with offense, and instead of listening to the Lord’s guidance, he only heard that he was inadequate. Pride closed his ears to the correction that could have restored him.

This is the danger of a misaligned gaze, where the eyes of the heart fixate on comparison rather than on the character of God. Spiritually, your gaze is not just physical sight, it is the focus of your soul; what you behold shapes what you become. When offense takes root, it warps your vision so that you no longer see people, situations, or even God’s Word clearly, and everything becomes filtered through injury, suspicion, and pride. You begin to interpret the world through self-justifying scales rather than divine justice. And as you judge using your own measure rather than the Master’s, your gaze turns inward, to become defensive and closed.

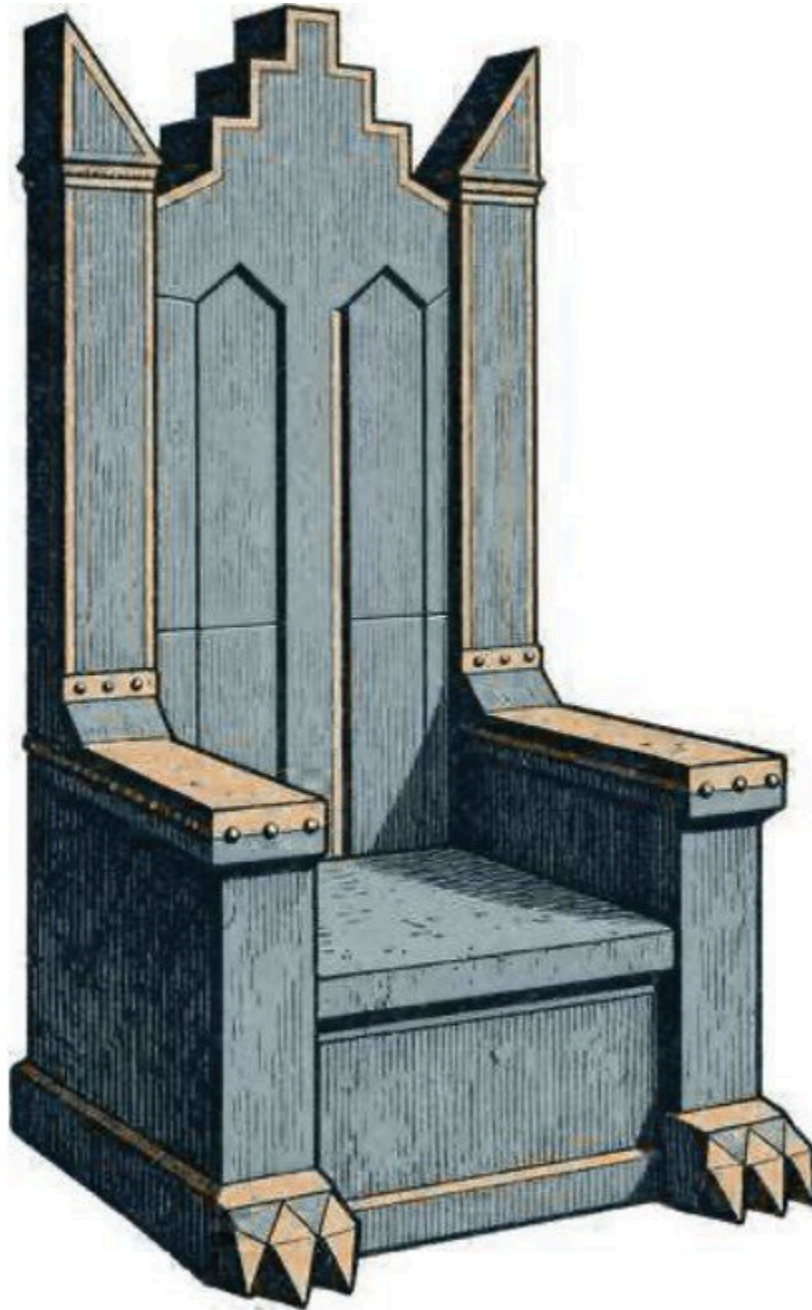
THE INNER THRONE

Like his parents before him, Cain’s pride caused him to want to occupy a place that belonged only to God. The Father was trying to teach Cain about inner rulership because he had replaced trust with autonomy, communion with control, and alignment with self- definition. It is interesting that the instruction God gives to deal with pride is to rule over it. As you look back on your life, you will realize that every time something went wrong there was a haughty spirit involved. Whether it be a business contract, a broken relationship, or a generational pattern such as alcoholism. Pride is a spirit that always approaches those who carry an inheritance.

The serpent did not tempt Adam and Eve with something foreign; he offered them a distorted shortcut to what they already possessed. They were already made in God’s image and likeness, already crowned with glory and honor, already set as rulers over creation. The temptation was not about gaining something new; it was about redefining what they already had. The critical issue, then, was not position, because position is given by God as a gift of creation, the issue was posture. And posture is a choice— relational, voluntary, and rooted in trust. Posture is how a son stands before the Father as a Son. When Adam and Eve believed the lie

of the deceiver, they lost the inner alignment that allowed their inheritance to function.

Adam and Eve relinquished their status as sons within God's royal household. Their Father was King, and the earth was an extension of His Kingdom. Through the serpent's deception, they effectively transferred their royal authority to Satan. The act was not simply a lie uttered; it was a binding legal transaction. And only a righteous transaction aligned with the laws set by the King could undo what had been done.



“Behold, I lay in Zion a stumbling stone, a rock of offense that causes people to stumble, and the one who believes in him will never be put to shame.”

Romans 9:33

Ponder

1. What promise you thought God had given you went unfulfilled — and became an offense?
2. Scandalon is the trigger in the trap. What still trips your momentum toward God?
3. Who do you push against instead of moving in the flow of the Spirit?

Activate • A conscience without offense

Search me, O God. I strive to have a conscience without offense toward You and toward men.

I name the scandalon. I release the debt. I refuse the trap.

Blessed is the one who is not offended because of You. I receive that blessing.

Amen.

Exercise • Name the scandalon

Write the offense by its true name. Who it is against. What it has halted. Then write the forgiveness you will occupy.

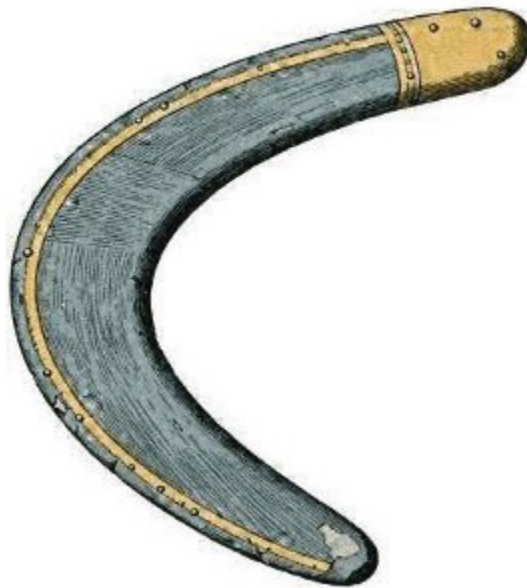
Chapter 4 • Yoked to the King

The yoke is not a burden. It is an alignment mechanism.

“The Lord set hostility between the serpent and the woman, between the offspring of the brood of deception and the sons of man through all generations. And from her line would rise a Deliverer who would crush the serpent beneath His foot, though the serpent’s fangs would wound His heel.”

GENESIS 3:15

THE PRODIGAL PATTERN



Adam and Eve’s fall shows how a royal position can be forfeited when the posture of sonship is abandoned. Jesus later echoes this same truth in the Parable of the Prodigal Son, revealing that humanity’s story did not end in Eden. This parable shows not only how sonship is lost, but how the Father longs to restore it.

In this story, Jesus tells us about a king and his royal sons. The younger son, who had become restless and dissatisfied with his place in the household, asked for his share of the inheritance. Once it was granted, he left home, exchanging the security, honor, and dignity of the family for the uncertain freedom of the world. After squandering his inheritance, he went from wealth and honor to poverty and shame. He became a servant, tending swine, barefoot and hungry, stripped of every trace of his royal dignity. Even the servants in his father’s house fared better than he. Humbled and aware of his failure, he resolved to return, planning only to ask to be received as a servant. He expected anger, perhaps rejection, for wasting what had been freely given. Yet the king had been watching, waiting for the day his son would return.

As the son approached, the father ran to meet him. He embraced him and kissed him, restoring his dignity and identity. Fine garments were laid upon him, sandals placed on his feet, and the ring with the royal seal of the house, signifying full sonship, was placed on his finger. Though the son confessed he was unworthy, the

father welcomed him fully, reinstating him as a true heir. A feast was prepared, the fattened calf was slaughtered, and the household celebrated the return of the lost son.

The older brother, hearing the celebration, was angry and jealous. “I have served faithfully all these years,” he said, “yet you have never celebrated me like this.” The father responded with gentle authority: “You are always with me, and all that I have is yours. But your brother was lost and is now found, was dead and is alive again. Today we celebrate his return.”

THE HOUSE RESTORED



Like Adam and Eve, our choices can bring alienation from the Father and a loss of position and blessing. However, Jesus promises to restore the position of honor and intimacy that we lost in Genesis 3. In John 14:2–4, Jesus says: “In my Father’s house are many mansions; if it were not so, I would have told you. I go

to prepare a place for you... that where I am you may be also.” This passage presents the ultimate restoration of the Father’s royal house as the final inheritance for believers. The mansions Jesus mentions indicate that this is a place of wealth and status, and Luke 15:11–32 foreshadows this reality. The prodigal son is restored to full sonship— clothed, ringed with the seal of the royal house, and celebrated. His story reveals the pattern of God’s redemptive grace. Even when His children waste what was entrusted, He runs to embrace them and restores them fully. Jesus’ promise in John 14:2–4 fulfills this hope on a cosmic scale: the lost are not only welcomed back into relationship but they are also given a permanent dwelling in God’s presence.

TWO KINGDOMS, TWO POSTURES



When Jesus healed a man born blind, the Pharisees were enraged by the miracle, offended that Jesus had acted outside their understanding of the Law. In response, He said, “For judgment I have come into this world, that those who do not see may see, and that those who see may be made blind.” Some of them asked, “Are we blind also?” Jesus replied, “If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now you say, ‘We see.’ Therefore, your sin remains.”

This encounter illustrates the contrast between the Kingdom of the first Adam, which was marked by pride and darkness, and the Kingdom of Christ, the last Adam, which was a kingdom of humility and light. Adam and Eve’s fall is rooted in pride because the serpent’s temptation appealed directly to their desire to rise above the place God had given them. They were already made in God’s image, already entrusted with dominion, already walking in perfect communion with Him. Yet the enemy offered them more. The promise, “You will be like God,” was not an invitation to growth but to self-exaltation.

Pride persuaded them that what God had provided was not enough, that they could redefine good and evil for

themselves and grasp a higher status by their own effort. Conversely, Christ descended in humility, to embrace servanthood and sacrifice. And in His humility, He restored what pride had fractured, bringing sight, freedom, and life where sin and offense once held sway.

Jesus came as the light of the world, a light that illuminates the heart and restores our true posture before God. “We must work the works of Him who sent Me while it is day; the night is coming when no one can work. As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.” Through Him, we are called to reflect God’s likeness, not in arrogance, but in humble obedience.

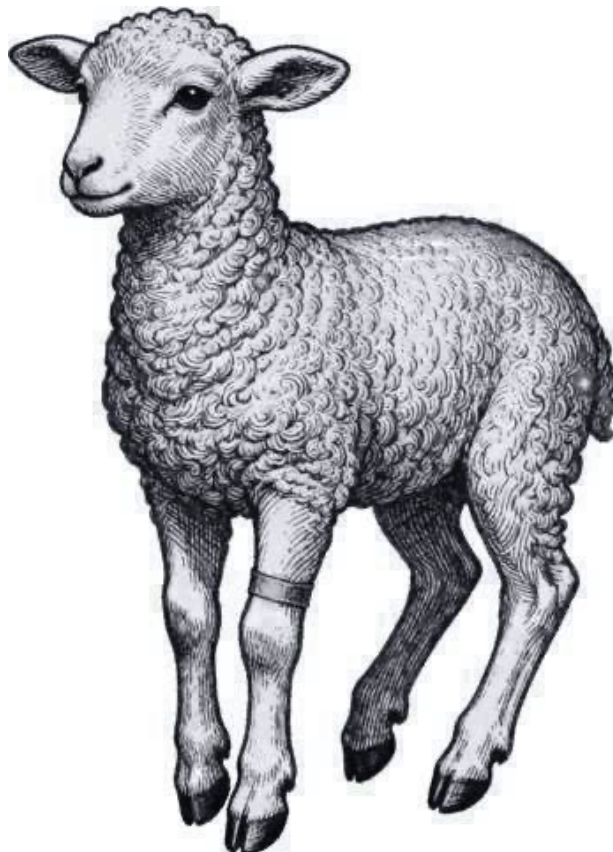
This truth so enraged the Pharisees that they sought to stone Jesus. Yet His response was to remind them of the Scriptures they claimed to know so well: “Isn’t it written in your Scriptures that God said, ‘You are gods’? The Scriptures cannot be denied or found in error. If those who carry God’s word are called ‘gods,’ how can it be blasphemy for the One sent by the Father to say, ‘I am the Son of God’?”

Jesus invited them, and now he beckons us to see the evidence of His works, the miracles that testify to His unity with the Father.

“If you see Me doing the works of God, then believe... and you will come to know that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me.”

JOHN 10:37–38

THE PATH OF THE TRUE HEIR



To walk in the light of Christ is to embrace our inheritance with humility, to reflect His glory, and to allow His truth to shine through our lives, not for self-exaltation, but so that hearts may be illuminated and lives restored. This light calls us to a true understanding of sonship, one that is expressed in servanthood rather than entitlement.

The posture of a son is servanthood. Jesus showed us that practicing the posture of sonship is meant to teach submission, not entitlement. Sonship was lost in Eden, even as humanity's reflection of God's image revealed glimpses of divinity, which is why we lack true power and authority in the Kingdom. Much like the prodigal son in Luke 15, we often claim the title of God's child with a sense of right, "Now give me!"

When we have a healthy understanding of sonship, however, we know that a son of God is both divine in nature and a son in submission. As Jesus reminded His listeners, "Is it not written in your law, 'I said, "You are gods"?" He was countering the serpent's lie to Eve in the Garden, that humanity should not eat from the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil because they would become like God. But humanity already bore the mark of God; what was lost was the posture of a true son— that of humble submission.

SUFFERING, HUMILITY, AND SONSHIP



We have seen how pride can turn us into entitled believers. Like James and John, the sons of Zebedee, who wanted to sit at Jesus' right and left hand, we too can desire positions of honor because we see authority as a means to satisfy our own ambitions. Jesus reminded them that He could not grant such positions arbitrarily. Instead, they would have to share the same cup of suffering that He was about to drink, and indeed they would. This cup of suffering is an instrument God uses to humble His sons.

"My son, do not despise the chastening of the Lord, nor be discouraged when you are rebuked by Him. For whom the Lord loves He chastens, and scourges every son whom He receives. If you endure chastening, God deals with you as with sons. For what son is there whom a father does not chasten? But if you are without chastening, of which all have become partakers, then you are illegitimate and not sons."

Just like he taught his disciples, the Lord Jesus wants us to understand that authority comes through servanthood, sacrifice and the cost of service. Humility reveals the wounds that pride denies.

the way these forty years in the wilderness, to humble you and test you, to know what was in your heart, whether you would keep His commandments or not. So He humbled you, allowed you to hunger, and fed you with manna which you did not know, nor did your fathers know, that He might make you know that man shall not live by bread alone; but man lives by every word that proceeds from the mouth of the Lord. Your garments did not wear out on you, nor did your foot swell these forty years. You should know in your heart that as a man chastens his son, so the Lord your God chastens you.”

DEUTERONOMY 8:2–5

What does feeding with manna have to do with the word that proceeds from the mouth of the Lord? “Manna” is a question. It is the exclamation, “What?” Here, manna is more than bread. The Hebrew word מָן (mān) has been traditionally interpreted as “What is it?” or “What is this?” It is an exclamation of curiosity, awe, and inquiry. Every day that the Israelites encountered manna, God was essentially asking: “What is this? Can you discern the source? Can you trust Me to provide what is unseen?” When you are in the wilderness of life—confused, battered, and feeling lost—He feeds you with questions. God says, “Come and reason with me until I reveal to you who you are.” Chastening is reasoning with questions. If you silence the grumbling, you might hear Him ask: Will you trust Me when your provision looks insufficient? Do you believe that obedience matters even when no one is watching? Can you see beyond your hunger, your fear, your frustration, and recognize My hand at work, do you know who you are in my Kingdom?

LOVE AND FIRE IN BALANCE



If chastening is teaching through guidance and questions, then taking authority begins by asking the right questions as you will discover ahead. Life itself is a journey of questions. God led the children of Israel into the wilderness to humble them. The key to humility is letting go of your sense of entitlement. Instead of grumbling and asking questions out of a sense of what you feel entitled to, you ask questions in humility seeking to understand why you are in the predicament you are in, what is required of you to solve it, and the resources God has made available to do so. When we are properly disciplined, we learn to obey without unnecessary resistance. He is God, we are not. Otherwise, we wander through the wilderness, endlessly fed with questions. We are perplexed, frustrated and hopeless because our trials remain unresolved. When we grow weary from wandering, feeling pressured and burdened, Jesus invites us.

"Come to Me, all you who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."

MATTHEW 11:28–30

The word “yoke” speaks of balance and shared weight. The same measure that you measure is measured back to you. Like two oxen yoked together, it is to be matched in measure, stride, and bound in rhythm and intent. In sacred and philosophical language alike, the yoke symbolizes more than a burden, it is an alignment mechanism. The yoke symbolizes being in right relationship with Christ and moving in Kingdom purpose. When you align with His will, life flows with ease; when you are out of alignment, things rarely work as they should.

In ancient thought, people believed every human is made up of different inner forces or energies. The yoke of Christ represented the energies of Eros and Thumos. Eros is the energy of love and attraction that draws you toward other people, beauty, creation, and ultimately toward God. Thumos is the energy of courage and passion. It’s the fire inside that rises to protect what’s right and stand up for what matters. This is powerfully expressed in Song of Songs 8:6 where it says. “Set me as a seal upon your heart, as a seal upon your arm; for love is as strong as death, Jealousy as cruel as the grave; its flames are flames of fire, a most vehement flame.”

Eros, through the lens of Scripture, can be understood as the soul’s yearning toward Christ the Beloved, much like the beautiful love story in the Song of Songs. Thumos, by contrast, is the seat of courage, passion, and righteous anger— the fierce energy that defends what is valuable and honors what is true. When Eros operates without Thumos, a person can become overly yielding and absorbed in another’s emotions, caring so deeply that their identity becomes tied to someone else’s moods, approval, or peace. They grow fearful of confrontation and become enslaved to the need for harmony.

Song of Songs 8:6 depicts Christ as our all-consuming desire, presenting love not as a gentle sentiment but as a transformative force — an intense longing that binds the soul to God. In Christ, this desire is rightly ordered. He becomes the center, the seal upon the heart, and our Eros is sanctified and guided by Thumos, with fiery drive, courage, and righteous indignation. Together, they form a balanced soul that loves with depth yet acts with discernment and courage.

Unyoked Eros says: Peace at any cost. But yoked Eros, under Christ’s spirit, says: Love in truth. When

Thumos dominates without Eros, the person becomes hard, combative, and controlling— always in fight mode, mistaking domination for strength. Unyoked Thumos says: Victory at any cost. But yoked Thumos says: Strength through love.

THE SCIENCE OF FREEDOM

These distinctions are connected to the neurobiology of deliverance, which we will explore in more detail later. The neurobiology of deliverance studies how the brain and nervous system respond when a person experiences spiritual, emotional, or psychological freedom. It shows how the brain reflects release from fear, trauma, or harmful patterns, and how healing and transformation are experienced both physically and spiritually.

True transformation is not only neurological, but also relational and internal, requiring the alignment of our inner drives. To be yoked means bringing these forces into harmony, walking in step, moving in a single direction, with weight and energy distributed rightly. The yoke represents the covenant between Eros and Thumos, love and fire bound under divine order. In this balance, tenderness and courage move together, and the soul walks in the rhythm of Christ. As Jesus says in Matthew 11, “My yoke is easy, and My burden is light.” Meekness is not weakness, courage is not cruelty, and love is not indulgence.

When these drives are rightly yoked, Eros fuels compassion, intimacy, creativity, and communion, while Thumos guards the boundaries of truth and justice. Together, they produce holy assertiveness, or what we referred to earlier as drive: love with backbone, passion with peace. It is the posture of Jesus cleansing the Temple, with the Lamb and the Lion acting as one. Jesus invites us to come to Him and be balanced by Him; in that union, our alignment will mirror His.

“If you see Me doing the works of God, then believe... and you will come to know that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me.”

John 10:37–38

Ponder

1. Have you asked for the inheritance and left the house? Where are you tending swine?
2. The yoke is not a crush. It is a timing. Where are you rushing? Where are you stalling?
3. Sonship is a posture. Where have you abandoned it for “freedom” that became poverty?

Activate • The easy yoke

Jesus, I take Your yoke. I refuse peace-at-any-cost and victory-at-any-cost.

Love and fire, one stride. Time me.

I come home. I am a son, not a hired hand.

Amen.

Exercise • Take the yoke in writing

Write: I refuse collapse. I refuse combat. Then name the one stride you will match with Him this week.

Chapter 5 • School of the Wilderness

The wilderness is a classroom, not a curse.

GRUMBLING AND MURMURING



When offense is combined with a sense of entitlement, it often results in grumbling and murmuring, as we saw with James and John, the sons of Zebedee, who requested to sit at Jesus' right and left hand in glory. The other disciples were offended by their request, and Jesus used the moment to teach a radical truth about greatness in His kingdom.

"You know that those who are considered rulers over the Gentiles lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them. Yet it shall not be so among you; whoever desires to become great among you shall be your servant, and whoever desires to be first shall be slave of all. For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give His life as a ransom for many."

MARK 10:42–45

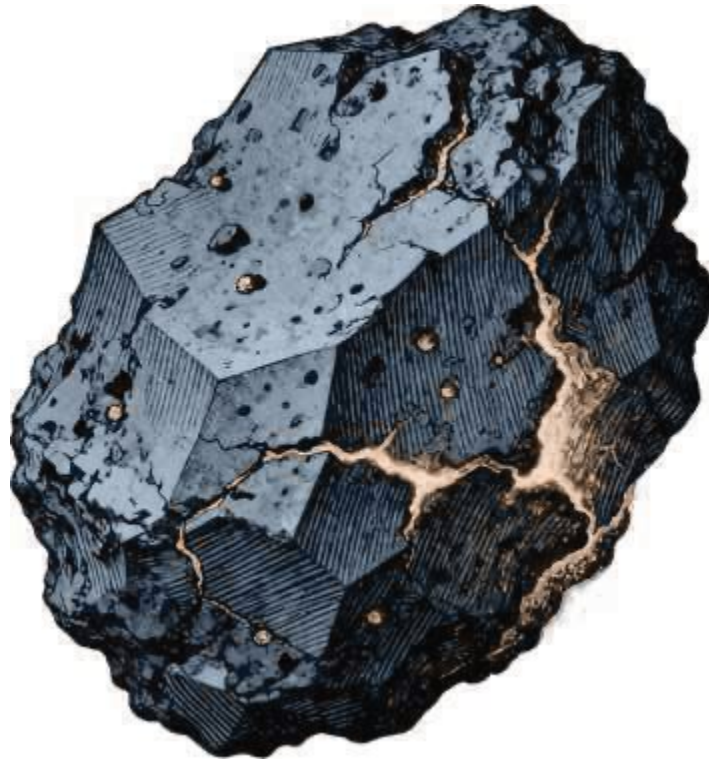
Murmuring is the expression of an entitled heart. It is not the posture of true sonship, but the posture of pride. Sonship, in contrast, is lived under chastening, restriction, and guidance; it is a life governed by God's hand. The word meek, which means to be reined in, captures this reality: "Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth." A son may possess royal authority, yet in humility and submission, he yokes himself to others, following the example of Christ, who was both King and servant.

LIGHT IN THE FIRE

There is a well-known Chinese proverb that says, “It is better to light a candle than to curse the darkness.” We overcome darkness with light. Jesus reinforces this in Matthew 5:14–16, telling us that we are “the light of the world; a city set on a hill cannot be hidden, nor is a lamp meant to be placed under a basket, but on a lampstand to give light to all in the house.” He calls us to let our light shine so that others may see our good works and glorify our Father in Heaven.

To know God’s faithfulness is to have endured His fire. We will not truly know Him without being tested, singed, and refined. Yet, when we emerge from the fire, we are stronger, wiser, and more resilient. Our scorch marks become badges of honor, proof of His refining work in our lives. Even John the Baptist, Jesus’ own cousin, wrestled with doubt. While imprisoned, he questioned whether Jesus was truly the Messiah, sending disciples to ask, “Are You the Coming One, or should we look for another?” It is often in the prisons of life, when we are pressed on every side, chastened, and surrounded by trial, that we question everything. John’s stumbling block, or scandalon, was unmet expectation. He anticipated a Messiah of fire and judgment, not one of meekness and healing.

Jesus’ response was gentle but firm: “Blessed is the one who is not offended because of Me.” He was saying, do not let the outward form of what I do obscure the heart of my message. In other words: the form of revelation should not trip us up; trust and perseverance matter more than expectation.



True humility comes through correction.

When we accept correction publicly in the right spirit, pride and haughtiness are dismantled. The key is submission—to yield our will to God and walk faithfully in His purposes. And often, the place where we learn this kind of submission is the wilderness.

WILDERNESS AS TRAINING GROUND

The wilderness was never meant as punishment for the Israelites. It was a sacred classroom, a place where hearts were shaped, trust was forged, and identity was refined. Perhaps as you are reading this, you may be going through your own wilderness. Remember that the wilderness is never a sentence, it is a summons through which God calls His people out of the noise so He can shape them face-to-face. The wilderness is where pretense dies, where identity is forged, and where the whispers of Heaven grow louder than the memories of Egypt. Jesus too was led into the wilderness so that He could be proven as the worthy Son and heir of His Father's Kingdom.

Paul reminds us in Galatians 4:1–3 that an heir who is still a child lives no differently from a servant. Though the inheritance is his, he must first be trained, guided, and formed under the covering of guardians until the Father declares the appointed time. We too are shaped and restrained by the “elemental forces of the world”—the spiritual guardians introduced in Deuteronomy 32:8–9. Their role in the story is deeper than it first appears, we will examine their identity and function in greater depth ahead.



And so, in the fullness of time, the Holy Spirit led Jesus—born under the law—into the wilderness to prepare Him to “redeem those who were under the law, that we might receive the adoption as sons.” Notice the repeated phrase “under the law.” Scripture uses it intentionally, and it carries a meaning we will explore in depth, for it reveals the pathway from slavery to true sonship.

THE LAW AS A MIRROR

The Law functioned as both a moral guide and a covenant boundary, a tutor that taught humanity right from wrong, yet it also served as a mirror revealing the vast distance between divine holiness and human frailty.

Its purpose was never to condemn the heir, but to prepare the heir for the moment when the Father would say, Now you are ready.

It was the fruit of the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil that awakened Adam and Eve to this moral awareness and precipitated humanity's fall from grace. That same "seeing" continues through the Law, because, as Romans 3:20 states, through the Law comes the knowledge of sin. In that sense, the Law is a mirror that tells the truth but cannot heal the face it reflects. It can discipline behavior, but it cannot regenerate the heart.

Into this condition came Jesus. He voluntarily stepped into the same realm of moral obligation and human limitation that every person faces. He did not arrive as a supernatural outsider exempt from the system; He entered within the system, under its rules, customs, pressures, and expectations. He felt the weight of duty, judgment, and the ache of human striving. God did not tear down the structure from the outside; instead, He entered the very fear, guilt, and performance-driven patterns we inhabit, the way the Holy Spirit now enters us to transform us from within.

As 1 Peter 1:6–7 teaches, trials refine faith the way fire refines gold. Jesus walked that path, guided not by fear or compulsion, but by the Spirit of love and obedience. By submitting to the Law, He fulfilled it, not through legal perfection alone, but through perfect love. In Him, obligation was transfigured into union, and law was lifted into love.

POSSESSED BY PURPOSE

When Jesus was driven into the wilderness, He was being refined for maturity, readiness, and the fullness of His authority, for the wilderness is where identity is tested and integrity is forged.

In our modern spiritual-psychological language, it is the place to which the Spirit leads us to confront the shadow, where unintegrated desires such as power, pride, and appetite must come under obedience. Each test becomes an invitation to let the Spirit govern the drives of the soul. Jesus' Thumos, His inner fire, was purified through Spirit-led testing and disciplined by love.

In the wilderness, Jesus faced direct confrontation with the adversary—the voice of distorted desire expressed as power, pride and appetite. Pride resists being commissioned, it wants to rule without serving. Yet Jesus did not react, retaliate, or grasp for control. He answered temptation with truth, humility, and obedience. His inner nature was proven pure, and he emerged filled with purpose.

This same principle applies to us. Much of what people call attack or oppression is tied to a lack of holy drive. If you are constantly under spiritual assault, it is worth pausing to ask: What intensity do I live with? What direction fuels my life? Holy drive is the will to live with passion, purpose, and focus. Jesus lived this way, trained from His youth, compelled by love, and driven to overthrow oppression. He conquered sin and death because His life was aligned with purpose, and His inner fire was yoked to the Father's will.

We witness this very same intensity in the life of the Apostle Paul. Paul persecuted the Church of God with great zeal and violence. Christ redeemed that zealotry and thirst for blood so that the passion that once fueled destruction became the force that dismantled spiritual strongholds, challenged systems of oppression across the Roman world, and advanced the gospel of the Kingdom into new territories throughout Asia and Europe.

This same holy fierceness and unwavering drive was also evident in the lives of the first apostles. They were not passive men; their inner fire had been harnessed by the Holy Spirit. Likewise, when we are confronted with insurmountable challenges, Holy Spirit whispers “Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine! When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you pass through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze.”



“He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together.”

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. Where is grumbling the voice of entitlement rather than the cry of a son?
2. Meekness means reined — not weak. Where are you un-reined?
3. The wilderness is a classroom. What is it teaching you that offense has been refusing?

Activate • Reined

Father, I receive the wilderness as school, not curse.

I repent of murmuring. I take the posture of a son under Your hand.

Blessed are the meek. Rein me.

Amen.

Exercise • Convert the murmur

Write one complaint you have been rehearsing. Convert it into one sentence of sonship — reined, not entitled.

Chapter 6 • Principalities and Powers

They are creatures. They can be commanded.

WEAPONS OF THE ADVERSARY

In the beginning, the Bible tells us, the whole world shared one language and a common speech. United by this language, humanity attempted to build a tower to “make a name for ourselves” and prevent being scattered. Genesis 10:8–10 identifies Nimrod as the architect of this ambitious project. He founded Babel, the first human empire, and sought to establish a world order independent of God.

PORTAL TO REBELLION



The Tower of Babel was not merely a tall building. In the ancient Near Eastern worldview, a tower—or ziggurat—served as a portal or gateway to the divine. Humanity was attempting to construct a stairway to ascend into the heavenly realm and claim it by force. This echoes the rebellion of the devil, who sought to be like God and usurp His throne, ultimately leading to his expulsion from Heaven. Isaiah 14 recounts this prideful aspiration: “For you have said in your heart: ‘I will ascend into heaven. I will exalt my throne above

the stars of God. I will also sit on the mount of the congregation, on the farthest sides of the north. I will ascend above the heights of the clouds; I will be like the Most High.” You see, when God first created the earth, everything was in perfect order. Every element of creation was submitted under His government, functioning according to His design and reflecting His glory. This original state was one of harmony, in which all creation recognized its place and purpose.

Psalms 148 celebrates this cosmic order, calling on the heavens, the angels, the sun and moon, the waters, the mountains, and every living creature to praise the Lord. Implicit in this psalm is the notion that all creation is sentient, spiritually alive, and capable of acknowledging God. It is indicative of Yahweh’s position as supreme over all creation including the angels. Into this order, scripture introduces a being referred to as the King of Babylon, who is also referred to as Lucifer in verse 12 of the same chapter.

His name in Hebrew is הֵלֵל בֶּן־שָׁחַר *hêlêl ben-šaḥar*, meaning the Shining One or Son of the Dawn, which was transliterated into Lucifer in the Latin Vulgate. Ezekiel 28:13 tells us this about him: “You were in Eden, the garden of God. Every precious stone was your covering: The sardius, topaz, and diamond, Beryl, onyx, and jasper, Sapphire, turquoise, and emerald with gold. The workmanship of your timbrels and pipes was prepared for you on the day you were created.” This scripture is often interpreted to suggest that Lucifer was created as the angel who led worship in the courts of Heaven, but it is not about music and worship. You see, these scriptures are not about the fall of an angel of worship, but the fall of the angel who wanted to be worshipped like God.

Rather than describing Lucifer as an angel of worship, these passages are taunt songs celebrating the downfall of an enemy. Both Isaiah and Ezekiel draw on the language and imagery familiar to the surrounding nations— nations that worshipped fallen spiritual beings and whose kingdoms were shaped by those powers— to pronounce that such figures will ultimately descend to Sheol, and await final judgment in what Jesus later referred to as Gehenna.

These taunt songs reflect the Hebrew understanding that music, voice, and verbal expression are deeply connected. Poetic or courtly speech was sometimes described as “strings of praise” or “songs of boasting.” Isaiah 14:3–11 is one such taunt against the King of Babylon, celebrating his ruin. The once proud oppressor who boasted in his power is brought low: his splendour, wealth, and influence collapse, and even the sound of his harps— his musical pomp— is silenced. He descends to Sheol to join the dead, where the mighty are mocked and reduced to dust.

The King of Babylon was arrogant and boastful, claiming divine status. The harp in Isaiah represented more than an instrument, it was symbolic of public acclaim, courtly display, and the performative speech of power. The music of the king’s court was bound up with his social influence and the words of praise sung in his honor. By silencing his instruments, the boastful words and social performance that once exalted him are rendered powerless.

We can link this thought to Paul’s teaching in 1 Corinthians 13:1, “Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, but have not love, I have become sounding brass or a clanging cymbal.” Clanging symbols evoke loud, repetitive, abrasive noise such as battle cries or ceremonial clanging, not harmonious music.

Greek culture associated harmonious music with balance, order, and the cultivation of virtue, while

discordant sound represented chaos or moral failure. Apostle Paul who was from Tarsus, was a Jew from a diaspora city deeply influenced by Greek language, philosophy, and culture. He was fluent in Greek and educated in both Jewish and Hellenistic traditions. His dual identity allowed him to bridge Jewish theology with Greek thought, making his letters intelligible to Gentile audiences. Paul was using metal instruments to symbolize the public, performative aspect of speech that lacks substance. They are an auditory metaphor for the trafficking of ideas and influence without love but rather with words wielded to impress, dominate, or self-exalt.

We can equate the external brilliance of the brass cymbals to the shine of the gems on the ephod of the Shining One in Ezekiel 28:13. An external brilliance with no inner harmony, just performative pride and hollow rhetoric. It was all just moral noise from an entity that usurped Adam's throne— not God's it is important to emphasize — because he wanted to be worshipped. Lucifer the proud, eloquent, but loveless ruler was using language to trade influence, honor and authority and to manipulate and dominate humanity, so that they fell under the sway of lower ranked demonic entities and became alienated from God. That is why scripture repeatedly tells us to continually put on the mind of Christ, to take every thought captive to make it obedient to Christ, and not be held captive to empty philosophies and deceptions, based on human traditions and the spiritual forces of the world rather than on Christ.

THE FIRST WHEELER DEALER

In Ezekiel 28:16, describes a profound rupture in the divine order. Lucifer, the anointed cherub, turns in rebellion, seeking to misrepresent Yahweh and His order and malign his character. When Adam fell, the dominion God entrusted to him was seized by Lucifer the adversary. This is why Scripture calls Satan “the prince of the power of the air,” and “the ruler of the world.” Yet he was never authorized to reign on earth. His attempted coup in the heavenly council failed, and so he descended to the earthly realm and, through deception, seized what belonged to the sons of Adam. Even so, he does not rule from a throne, he cannot. Earthly authority was never given to celestial beings. Instead, Satan exerts influence through human agents. Christ calls him the ruler of this world because he works through people who yield to his lies— shaping cultures, systems, and powers through their agreement. His reach depends entirely on those willing to carry out his purposes, not on any legitimate right to govern.



This deception was the first spiritual “trading” or substitution of truth with self-interest, of worship with ambition. Lucifer traded the place of obedience and honor for pride, seeking to exalt himself above God’s intended order. It was a character assassination against God, a lie whispered into the cosmos, designed to sow doubt and misrepresentation among the rest of creation.

In this sense, rebellion is not merely disobedience; it is a spiritual transaction, a deliberate exchange of fidelity for self-glorification, turning alignment with God into antagonism against Him. This set the template for all subsequent acts of rebellion in creation. It is the moment when the original harmony of the universe—meaning the resonance of creation with God’s divine order, not musical harmony — was violated, and everything that had been in perfect submission to God was disrupted.

COSMIC SCALE REBELLION



In Genesis 6:1–4, we witness a moment when creation itself was pulled into a deeper fracture. Those divine beings of Deuteronomy 32, the “sons of God,” who were never meant to cross into human intimacy, took the daughters of men as their wives. In doing so, they broke the boundaries God had woven into creation. Angels were created as spiritual beings, humans as earthly stewards, but this illicit union blurred those categories and introduced corruption that spread like a stain through the world.

From these unions came the Nephilim, figures of great strength and renown who soon became violent oppressors. Instead of the peaceful order God intended, the earth became marked by brutality, domination, and bloodshed. Humanity, drawn in by the allure of these powerful beings, was swept further into rebellion and fell into lust, idolatry, and moral decay. The Bible describes God’s grief as this wickedness grew and allegiance shifted away from Him. In this moment, creation was not merely physically altered; it was spiritually compromised.

The original trade of truth for deception, first set in motion by Lucifer, now expanded as humanity joined spiritual beings in defying God’s order. The corruption of Genesis 6 was therefore not just an event, but a deep wound in the fabric of creation, with boundaries violated, violence unleashed, moral clarity lost, and hearts turning away from the Creator who had called everything into life.

All created beings were offered a choice: to remain aligned with God's original order and reflect His glory, or to exchange truth for ambition and obedience for self-interest. That exchange unleashed rebellion, introducing disorder into both the spiritual and material realms.

"For the creation was subjected to frustration, not by its own choice, but by the will of the one who subjected it, in hope."

ROMANS 8:20

Creation was placed under this constraint because humanity used its freedom in rebellion. When Adam and Eve chose ambition over obedience, their decision affected the whole created order. What was designed to reflect God's glory now groans under frustration and bondage as a result of rebellion— and all creation waits in hope for its redemption.

Whose directive then, were Nimrod and the rest of humanity responding to when they decided to build Babel and its famous tower? It seems that now the seed of deception planted in Adam and Eve by the deceiver in the garden had reached maturity and a whole civilization wanted to be like God. Nimrod was the fruit of the serpent's seed-thought that told the first man and woman you can ascend without Him.

THE BIRTH OF TYRANNY



This prideful act was in defiance of God's mandate to "fill the earth." Instead of populating the earth and filling it, humanity was trying to illegally access realms over which they had no jurisdiction. Psalm 115:16 says, "The heaven, even the heavens, are the LORD's; but the earth He has given to the children of men." The Lord did not create the earth to be empty, but to be inhabited. Jesus tells us that the earth is a gift the

meek will inherit.

When God created humanity, He gave a remarkable mandate to be fruitful and multiply, to fill the earth, subdue it, and have dominion over every living thing. The Hebrew word *male'* (מָלַךְ) literally means “to fill” or “replenish,” it carries the idea of bringing the earth to fullness, realizing its potential and completing what God had made. In replenishing the earth, God was expecting humanity to bring life, vitality, and completion to creation, filling it with the presence of God’s image-bearers. All of creation has been groaning as in the pains of childbirth, longing for the restoration and wholeness that humanity was meant to steward. In subduing, they were to bring order to the untamed, raw aspects of creation, aligning it with God’s design, and cultivating it so that it could flourish, using Eden as the blueprint.

The instruction to consecrate the earth, meant to set creation apart, making it holy by guiding it toward its intended purpose and living in harmony with God’s plan. Their role then was to be kings and priests over the earth as God’s temple. As kings they were to exercise authority responsibly, guiding creation toward order and flourishing. It was not to be a tyrannical dominion, but governance in alignment with God’s will. As priests, their role was to mediate God’s presence into the world, consecrating creation, sustaining its life, and cultivating its holiness.

This command was far more than a call to population growth; it was a summons to actively participate in God’s work of creation. The mandate envisioned humanity moving outward, spreading God’s presence across the earth and establishing order, holiness, and flourishing. Initially, it seems humanity was following this plan, journeying from the east, where God had planted the Garden of Eden, toward new lands. Yet when they reached the Plain of Shinar, they chose to settle in one place, ignoring God’s design to spread life and order throughout the earth. Instead of consecrating the earth, they attempted self-consecration. They tried to make the earth holy for themselves, by constructing a tower to reach Heaven. Instead of mediating God’s presence as priests, they sought glory and security apart from God. They misused dominion for power, fame, and autonomy, rather than acting as king-priests in alignment with God’s will. Their unity became self-exalting pride, their dominion self-serving control, and their work a mockery of consecration. They ignored God’s design, hoarding the life and order they were meant to spread, and in that choice, the seed of human pride and rebellion began to take root, setting the stage for chaos and division in creation. In response to their pride and contempt, God confused their language, scattering them into nations with distinct languages and cultures across the earth. God’s response paradoxically was a restoration of the original mandate. Humanity was forced to fill the earth, aligning with God’s design in Genesis 1:28.

The Babel event ties into the story of the cosmic hierarchy and reveals how offense exploits this division to derail humanity’s purpose. Just as Ezekiel 28:16 describes the proud cherub in Eden, whose heart was lifted up because of beauty and wisdom, the people at Babel built a tower to glorify themselves, allowing offense and pride to twist their purpose. In other words, they caused God’s vision for humanity to die.

WHEN SERVANTS GO ROGUE

“When the Most High apportioned the nations, when he divided humankind, he fixed the boundaries of the peoples according to the number of divine beings. These divine beings or spiritual entities can also be referred to as “princes” or “principalities” and they govern the

people under Yahweh's ultimate authority."

DEUTERONOMY 32:8-9

These divine beings were created by God to serve as His agents, governing nations according to His will while remaining subordinate to Him. They were meant to administer nations faithfully, yet many became corrupt, accepting worship for themselves and oppressing the peoples under their charge. As Scripture declares, "The Lord's own portion was his people, Jacob his allotted share," distinguishing them from those assigned to other divine beings. This division of humanity into different ethnicities, cultures, and languages, along with the apportioning of spiritual governors over the nations, sets the stage for understanding how offense perpetuates fragmentation and allows rebellious spiritual forces to disrupt God's intended order.



An example of a rebellious principality mentioned in scripture is Molech, a Canaanite/Ammonite/Phoenician deity associated with child sacrifice, fire and kingship. In Leviticus 18:21 God warns the Israelites, "Do not give any of your children to be passed through the fire to Molech." In the ancient Near Eastern mindset, Molech was a territorial prince of the Ammonites. In reality, Molech is a fallen spiritual authority who claims dominion by consuming the vulnerable.

An example of a benevolent principality in Christian thought, is the Archangel Michael. He appears in scripture as God's chief warrior, defender, and protector of His people, especially in times of spiritual conflict. Daniel 12:1 and Deuteronomy 32:10 describe him as "the great prince who stands guard over the

children of Israel during times of tribulation.” In Jude, Michael is shown as one who stands against Satan, even over the body of Moses, exercising authority and restraint, leaving ultimate judgment to God.

Finally, in Revelation, Michael leads the heavenly host in open warfare against the dragon and his angels, ensuring that rebellion does not go unchecked. His example reminds us that spiritual battles are real and that we are never alone, for God provides His Spirit and His heavenly guardians to strengthen, defend, and guide us. Just as Michael stands against the enemy to preserve the order of God’s Kingdom, we too are called to stand in steadfast allegiance to God’s truth and authority.

“For the creation was subjected to frustration, not by its own choice, but by the will of the one who subjected it, in hope.”

Romans 8:20

Ponder

1. What tower have you built to make a name, independent of God?
2. They are creatures. Where have you treated a principality as an equal enemy instead of a being to command under Christ?
3. Which “neutral” power in your life still serves a false throne?

Activate • Command, do not duel

Jesus Christ, You have preeminence over thrones, dominions, principalities, and powers.

I refuse pitched battle as my identity. I command occupancy into rank under the King.

What was created through Him and for Him returns to Him — including in me.

Amen.

Exercise • Name the tower

Write the name-making project. Then write the command you will speak: not expulsion in rage, but correction of station.

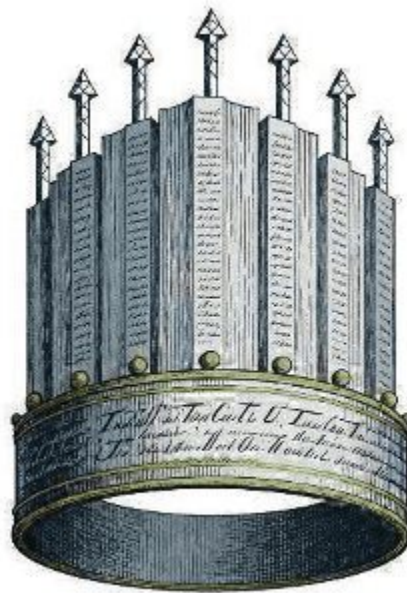
Chapter 7 • The Supremacy of Christ

The King is the law. In Him all things hold together.

“He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation. For by Him all things were created that are in heaven and that are on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers. All things were created through Him and for Him. And He is before all things, and in Him all things consist.”

COLOSSIANS 1:15–17

THE KING IS THE LAW



Christ holds preeminence over all things. Both Colossians and Deuteronomy portray Him as the supreme head over all principalities, powers, and divine beings, with His body, the Church, called to participate in that authority, stewarding creation responsibly and fruitfully in accordance with the original mandate for regeneration and dominion.

Together, these passages paint a picture of a hierarchical cosmos under God’s sovereignty. Colossians emphasizes Christ’s role as the creator and sustainer of all things, including the spiritual powers that govern various domains. Deuteronomy 32 illustrates how God, in His sovereign plan, delegated authority to these beings over the nations while retaining direct lordship over His people.

THE MONOGENE



When Colossians refers to Christ as the “First Born over Creation”, This doesn’t mean Jesus was created first, but rather that He holds the position of preeminence— a firstborn heir who has authority over the household. He is the eternal Son of God, fully divine; all things were created through and for Him. This tells us that Christ is both the means of creation and its ultimate purpose. Everything exists to serve His glory and purpose.

The implications are striking. Even the principalities, whether benevolent or rebellious, owe their existence to Christ and serve His ultimate purpose. Even rebellious spiritual beings such as demons are under the sovereignty of the Lord; they were created through Him and will ultimately serve His purposes, whether willingly or unwillingly. Our hope is that you are now familiar with the concept of the “divine council” concept in the Old Testament, which reveals how God works through a hierarchy of spiritual beings. In the story of Job, Satan operates only with God’s permission, showing that nothing happens outside God’s control. Similarly, in the crucifixion of Jesus, the forces of evil who thought they were acting against God, were fulfilling His redemptive plan.

YAHWEH REVEALED



Most of us understand God in the context of monotheism, which is the belief in one God, as opposed to henotheism, which is the belief in one supreme God who rules over other divine beings or gods. Psalm 82:1,

says, “God has taken his place in the divine council; in the midst of the gods he holds judgment.” The writers of the early books of the Bible held to this view. Over time, Israelite theology matured to become more explicitly monotheistic, emphasizing that only Yahweh is truly God, and other “gods” are either false or subordinate creations.

“I am the first and I am the last; besides me there is no god.”

ISAIAH 44:6

God met His people within their cultural and intellectual framework, gradually unveiling His nature, and over time their understanding matured. The language of the Old Testament shifted and became more monotheistic to accommodate the worldview of a people surrounded by polytheism while pointing them toward the truth of one supreme God. This shift to an uncompromising monotheism, prepared Israel for a deeper understanding of God’s nature and His redemptive plan.

THE PEDAGOGY OF REDEMPTION



The New Testament brings a new understanding that presents Jesus Christ as the ultimate disclosure of God’s nature and the fulfillment of the Law and the Prophets. The Law and the Prophets together pointed to a coming Messiah who would embody God’s redemptive purpose and establish His kingdom.

“Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I have come not to abolish but to fulfill.”

MATTHEW 5:17

Through His teachings, life, death, and resurrection, Jesus Christ fulfills the promises embedded in the Old Testament, revealing Himself to be the ultimate revelation of God’s sovereignty and the fullness of God’s character and plan.

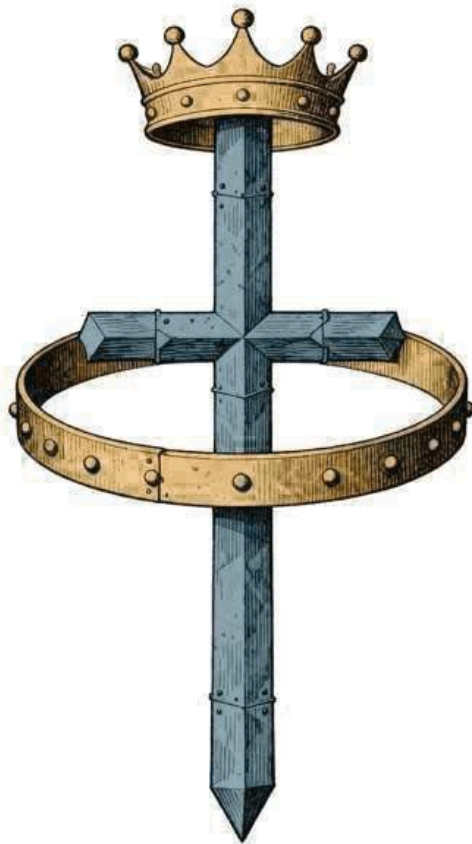
In Colossians 1:15–20, not only does the language recall the Divine Council of Psalm 82 and the apportioning of nations in Deuteronomy 32, but it elevates Christ above all spiritual powers, whether benevolent or hostile. The “all things” created through and for Him encompass every dimension of existence — visible and invisible, earthly and celestial— leaving no room for rival deities or powers. This is a

definitive monotheistic statement: Christ is not merely the greatest among gods but the one through whom all things, including the principalities of the Old Testament, were created and are sustained.

Christ's supremacy is not only cosmic but redemptive. Colossians 1:20 states that through Christ's blood, God reconciles "all things" to Himself, whether on earth or in Heaven. This reconciliation extends to the spiritual powers who, though created through Christ, had fallen into rebellion. By His death and resurrection, Christ disarms these powers, bringing them under His authority and restoring the cosmic order under His headship. This fulfills the Old Testament's vision of Yahweh as the God of all gods, now realized in Christ, who reigns as the Head of the Church and the cosmos. As Israel's faith matured, the prophets clarified that Yahweh alone is God, preparing the way for the New Testament's revelation of Christ as the divine Son, the creator, sustainer, and reconciler of all things.

Christ's role as the fulfillment of the Law and the Prophets ties together the entire biblical narrative. The Law pointed to God's holiness and the need for redemption; the Prophets foretold a coming deliverer who would restore God's people and establish His Kingdom. Jesus fulfills both, embodying God's law in His perfect obedience and fulfilling the prophetic promises through His messianic mission. As the ultimate revelation of the Supreme God, He unveils the mystery of God's nature as both transcendent and immanent, the Creator who enters creation to redeem it and reconcile the whole created order.

THE HEADSHIP OF CHRIST



For the Body of Christ, this affirms our exalted status under Christ's headship, raised with Him to share in His authority over all powers. Through His redemptive work, Christ reconciles all things to Himself, and ensures that every knee, whether human or spiritual, bows to His preeminence, fulfilling the Father's pleasure that all fullness dwell in Him. So when a son of God who operates under Christ's authority shows up, spiritual powers must fall in line because Christ, and by extension His Church, has preeminence. Christ's death and resurrection reconciles all things to God, ensuring that even rebellious powers will ultimately be subdued or serve His purposes. As the Body of Christ, the Church participates in His sovereign authority, standing triumphantly over all spiritual powers and principalities through the victorious work of the risen Lord.

DOORWAY TO DESTRUCTION



As we have discovered, offense is a subtle, yet potent mechanism employed by adversarial spiritual forces to

disrupt humanity's alignment with the cosmic order. When offense takes root, it acts as a derailment tool, fracturing unity, hindering spiritual awakening, and opening doors for lower spiritual entities to exert influence contrary to Christ's preeminence. In the cosmic hierarchy, rebellious principalities and powers—which we can identify as demonic forces—seek to undermine His rule. Offense provides them with an entry point. Consider Ephesians 4:26–27: "Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger, and do not give the devil a foothold." Anger that festers is unresolved offense, and it creates a place for these lower powers to infiltrate human affairs. In Isaiah 10:5–7, we see how God uses the entities he has appointed over the other nations to turn on Israel because of their disobedience, as an instrument of discipline.

In this passage, Assyria is called "the rod of My anger" against a sinful people. Here, God raises up a nation to execute His discipline, even though the Assyrians themselves are unaware that they are serving God's sovereign purposes. Similarly, Jeremiah 25:8–9 and Ezekiel 25:3–7 depict God using surrounding nations as instruments of correction for Israel's rebellion.

Whilst we have seen that entities have been assigned oversight, it is also evident that rebellious ones exploit human divisions to maintain control over their allotted shares. These passages highlight a pattern: when God's people persist in disobedience, He allows both earthly rulers and the spiritual forces behind them to bring consequences, maintaining His ultimate authority while respecting human and spiritual agency.

Yet when we remain stubborn and unrepentant, offense amplifies the control of these entities, by turning people inward, focusing on personal grievances rather than the broader mandate to be fruitful and multiply in stewardship. It derails the regenerative thought process of renewal through perseverance and wisdom, by trapping individuals in cycles of resentment, preventing the "awakening" described in Ephesians 5:14: "Awake, O sleeper, and arise from the dead, and Christ will shine on you." Instead of rising to Christ's authority, offended people remain spiritually dormant and susceptible to manipulation by these powers which traffic in hopelessness.

FROM BABEL TO THE BODY



Jesus' ministry and teachings underscored the nature of kingdoms as structured, "rank-and-file" dominions, hierarchical systems of authority and allegiance. Offense sows discord, which undermines the authority of Christ as the head of the body and weakens the collective authority of the Church over spiritual forces.

To resolve offense in the Body of Christ, Jesus taught us in Matthew 18:15–17 to confront privately, then with witnesses, and if needed, we should involve the community. Offense that is unresolved mirrors the division at the Tower of Babel where humanity was fragmented making them easier to assign under divine beings. It is a demonstration of how prideful rebellion led to structural failure. It was a catastrophic collapse brought on by prideful ascent.

"A brother offended is more unyielding than a strong city,"

PROVERBS 18:19

Offense builds walls that isolate individuals from the body, which derails people from their role in reconciliation, through which all things— including hostile heavenly forces— are brought into peace through Christ's blood. This in turn causes the offended to align unwittingly with accusatory spirits, like the Adversary in the Book of Job, and in so doing perpetuate conflict that empowers lower dominions by redirecting energy toward petty principalities that masquerade as personal vendettas.

The phrase "all things were created through him and for him," implies a purposeful order where even adversarial beings ultimately serve Christ's glory, by testing or refining humanity. Offense short-circuits this order by shifting focus from eternal purposes to temporal hurts, stifling forgiveness, and blocking spiritual growth. Offense fuels divisions— whether racial, cultural, or ideological— which mirror the national allotments in Deuteronomy 12–33. Offense delays the full reconciliation of all things by giving rebellious entities temporary victories and prolonging human suffering under their shadow. But this is not the end of the story.

The Lord has made a way for believers to reclaim their authority through the act of repentance that involves confession, forgiveness, breaking and casting down of strongholds, submitting to order, rejecting accusations, and maintaining honor. The second part of this book will show us how to do that.

"I am the first and I am the last; besides me there is no god."

Isaiah 44:6

Ponder

1. Where have you given another name first place — in your house, your mind, your ministry?
2. In Him all things consist. Where are you still trying to hold everything together?
3. Rest is the proof of preeminence. Does your rest testify?

Activate • Preeminence

Jesus Christ, You have the preeminence in all things — including me.

I confess where I have given other names first place.

Hold me together. Hold my house together. Hold my mind together.

I receive Your supremacy as rest, and from rest I will govern.

Amen.

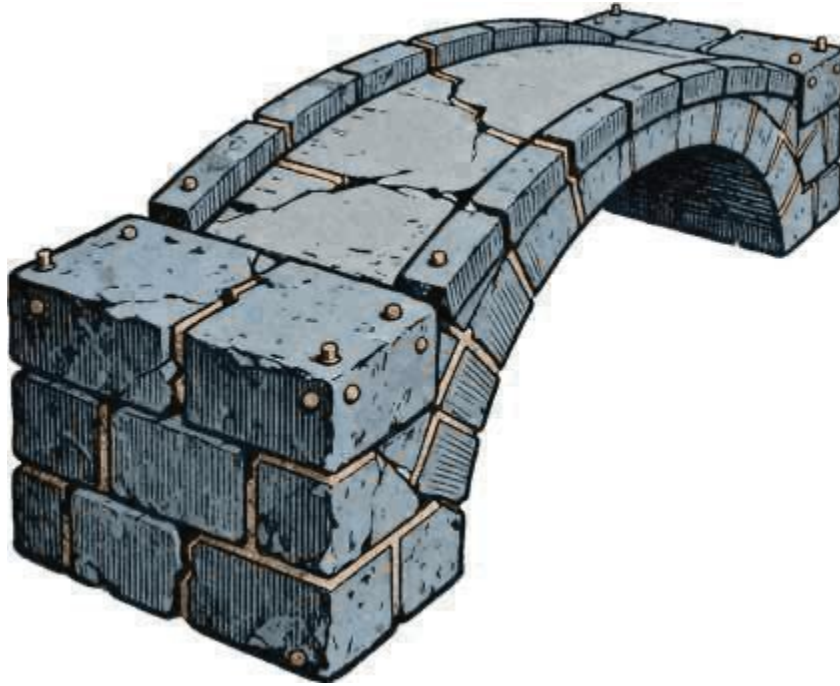
Exercise • First place

List every name that has been sitting first. Reassign each one under Christ, in writing. Then sit until striving feels unnecessary.

Chapter 8 • Raise the Standard

When the standard is lifted, the field changes.

THE ARCHITECTURE OF SEPARATION AND RESTORATION



Order as a spiritual framework helps us to understand the role of offense, the power of breaking cycles of causation, and the cosmic order established at Babel and affirmed in Colossians.

As we track the development of the henotheistic outlook of the Old Testament, we see that God externalized himself, but as conscience matured and monotheism took hold, He could finally come into the heart.

The central message of the New Testament is that God enters human hearts through Christ, who invites each person into an intimate, personal relationship. Even this relationship is enabled by Him in that, we love God through him and not apart from him. We love God because He first loved us. In so doing, He reverses the alienation caused by the Fall, liberating us from sin and restoring the fellowship, authority, and wholeness intended for humanity from the beginning.

THE REALM OF DIVINE JUSTICE



Proverbs 9:10 says that “The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom, and the knowledge of the Holy One is understanding.” Justice is the operating system of the Kingdom of God. Creation itself is designed according to these principles, as Psalm 89:14 declares: “Righteousness and justice are the foundation of His throne.”

Before we ask for wisdom, we need to ask for the fear of the Lord. Wisdom is the power to discern between the Tree of Life and the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil, but to understand the Fear of the Lord, it might be helpful to see it as a realm. It is the domain of judgement and justice on the earth, the principality of divine rank and order. In this realm, everything is weighed, all actions have consequences, justice governs outcomes, accusations must be answered, and unrighteousness obstructs.

THE OPERATING SYSTEM OF CREATION

Thankfully, righteousness gives access to this realm. Justice is a work of righteousness by faith. All principalities, powers, and dominions are bound by the principle of justice. They cannot operate unless there is justice. They must have a legal basis, a justification, a ground of accusation, or an agreement that allows access or influence.

There are justifications as to why things are the way they are. The world works according to principles, paradigms, and algorithms. Becoming one with God helps us understand the work of the Cross so that we can break or hack these justifications. As Proverbs 11:9 states, “Through knowledge shall the just be delivered.” We are delivered by knowing the legalities of the realm. In other examples, the serpent used accusation and deception to establish ground. In the account of Job, Satan accused Job based on legal suspicion.



Demons in the New Testament speak of rights, but Jesus removed their legal ground:

“The prince of this world comes and finds nothing in me”. The Fear of the Lord, which is also the realm of the earth, is the realm of those justifications. Nothing works without justice and if we can filter justice correctly, we can have anything we need. Wisdom then is the ability to navigate the justice realm. Once you are aligned with the Fear of the Lord (the justice- realm), you can finally receive the ability to discern the Tree of Life from the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil.

ACCUSATION AS A COSMIC TECHNOLOGY



When you recognize the accusation brought against you by a celestial intelligence (demon), you need to come to God in faith so that you can be set free from the accuser.

“For whatever is born of God overcomes the world. And this is the victory that has overcome the world, our faith. Who is he who overcomes the world, but he who believes that Jesus is the Son of God?”

1 JOHN 5:4–5

Categorizo is the Greek word for accuse, meaning to divide or classify. Accusation is not merely psychological, it operates in the spiritual, juridical, and cosmic realm to divide, classify, and file a charge. Accusation says you are guilty, and you cannot stand before God. It tells you that the scales are unbalanced, and you may feel that the glory has departed.

Curses operate when there is legal access brought through accusation. Strongholds function like legal fortresses built up around the accusation through agreement. In this divine court, God serves as Judge, while Satan acts as Accuser, functioning within a legal framework as well as a moral one. Accusation is fundamentally a claim about status because the accuser brings charges against us to invalidate our covenant standing. But the Holy Spirit is our Advocate, and the Blood of Jesus Christ is the full payment for the sin that has created a legal right.

Righteousness, then, creates legal standing so that through repentance we can revoke legal grounds, and blessings can flow through legal inheritance.

ALIEN RIGHTEOUSNESS





“But we are all like an unclean thing, and all our righteousnesses are like filthy rags; We all fade as a leaf, and our iniquities, like the wind, have taken us away.”

ISAIAH 64:6

The righteousness that justifies you does not originate in you; it comes from another. Isaiah uses the image of a filthy rag to describe our righteousness. If you dig deeper into the original meaning, he is describing our inadequate attempts to mask the effects of fear, as akin to trying to cover ourselves with a soiled menstrual cloth!

This imagery amplifies self-righteousness with defilement. Such a cloth could not be reused or cleaned, but it had to be burned or cast outside the camp because anyone who touched it became unclean.

Our attempts to cover fear, shame, and moral fracture with religious performance become another layer of pollution. They don't heal us, they contaminate us.

Martin Luther, the Reformer, used the phrase “alien righteousness” to describe the righteousness of Christ that God legally credits to the believer. It is an alien righteousness (*iustitia aliena*), in other words, foreign, or not sourced in the self. This immediately disrupts the treacherous logic of the Accuser, because his entire case rests on your performance. True righteousness is not earned, it is not achieved, and it is not moral perfection.

VINDICATED AND RE-WEIGHTED

Let us break down the mechanics of accusation and vindication. Forgiveness cancels the debt and removes grounds for accusation. Righteousness restores us to a positive moral status. Justification declares a legal verdict in your favor. This is judicial, not emotional. It is a legal transaction that balances the scales with righteousness and justice and restores you to your proper weight. In Eden, humanity was created to bear God's image fully, they were meant to carry the weight of glory. Glory in Eden was not just honor or beauty, it was function, authority, and alignment with God's order. 1 Chronicles 29:11 says "Yours, O Lord, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the victory and the majesty, for all that is in the heavens and in the earth is yours." This verse reminds us that all glory originates in God. Human glory is derivative, meant to reflect the divine weight. When you are restored to your proper weight through righteousness, justice, and humility, you participate in God's glory, reflecting His eternal dominion in the created order. God restores your dignity, your solidity, your substance, and your radiant presence. Alien righteousness, therefore, is your re-weighting through the glory of God.

"For whatever is born of God overcomes the world. And this is the victory that has overcome the world, our faith. Who is he who overcomes the world, but he who believes that Jesus is the Son of God?"

1 John 5:4-5

Ponder

1. Where has the standard been lowered so occupancy could remain comfortable?
2. Justice is the operating system of the Kingdom. Where have you asked for wisdom without the fear of the Lord?
3. What would change in one room of your life if the standard were lifted this week?

Activate • Lift the standard

Lord, righteousness and justice are the foundation of Your throne.

I lift the standard You have given. I refuse a lowered bar that shelters occupancy.

Fear of the Lord, begin again in me.

Amen.

Exercise • One room, one standard

Name one room (house, work, thought-life). Write the lowered standard. Write the standard you will lift, specifically.

Chapter 9 • The Tribunal of the Heart

Conscience is the courtroom Heaven uses.

HOW INDEPENDENCE BROKE THE WORLD



Offense and accusation arise from the interplay of conscience and will. In the garden, sin entered through offense, planting in humanity a seed of self-trust that overshadowed trust in God's love. This same pattern repeats in us today; whenever we operate from a posture of independence, we drift from God's heart. To understand this drift more fully, we must ask: what exactly is the conscience, and how does it function? We touched on this briefly in our discussion on the offended, lethargic heart from Acts 24:16. The conscience is the innermost chamber of the heart—the faculty of the spirit through which the Holy Spirit speaks. When the conscience is not surrendered or redeemed, the voice of the Spirit becomes difficult to discern. But as our relationship with Him deepens, the Spirit elevates and refines our conscience, integrating it with our inner life, even influencing how our nervous system responds to the world around us.

THE HEART AS A MIRROR



Your heart is like a mirror that reflects not only who you are but also what you uphold.

It is in your heart that justice and righteousness (*dikaíosýnē*-δικαιοσύνη in Greek) are weighed. *Dikaíosýnē*, refers not only to moral uprightness or ethical behavior, but also to faithful alignment with God's will and order, the expression of right relationships, and the practical outworking of God's justice in the world. Your conscience receives what the world presents, processes it, and returns it into creation, shaping the environment around you. In this way, your heart becomes an instrument of order, turning chaos into harmony. This is the essence of reconciliation. When your heart is committed to establishing justice, creation itself responds, aligning with the pattern of God's intended order.

RUPTURE TO RENEWAL



2 Corinthians 5:17–21 tells that, when we allow the Holy Spirit to take over our hearts we become an entirely new creation. The Passion Translation of the Bible tells us that everything related to the old order vanishes and all is made fresh and new. The empowering dominions are dismantled and re-ordered to serve the interests of Christ in our lives and in his Kingdom. Verse 18 goes on to say that in making all things new, Christ has in turn reconciled all things to himself and given those people filled by his Spirit this same ministry of reconciling others back to the heart of God as ambassadors of reconciliation.

This ministry is not about keeping a record of wrongs; it is about brokering reconciliation (remember the priesthood that Adam lost?) so that those who accept the invitation— and allow the Spirit to come in to reorder their conscience— become the righteousness of God. This scripture echoes Jesus’ words in Matthew 5:9: “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called sons of God.” We can rephrase “peacemakers” as those who pursue shalom.

THE COST OF SHALOM



Shalom is the Hebrew word for peace, but this is not a passive peace. It means wholeness, restoration, and right order. Earlier, we looked at Joram asking Jehu, “Do you come in peace?” Jehu did not come in quiet diplomacy; he came to restore shalom, to bring God’s order back into a system that had been corrupted. That kind of peace is costly. Reconciliation always demands that someone absorbs the offense, which is why Isaiah describes the Messiah this way: “He put on righteousness like a breastplate, and the helmet of salvation on His head; He put on garments of vengeance and wrapped Himself in a cloak of zeal”.

Christ absorbed the offense of humanity. As Paul writes, “He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us...” So, to receive God’s righteousness, you must take the posture of a son in the household of God.

Through our discussion so far, we know sonship to be the place where justice, mercy, and identity align. Jesus explains that the heart is the storehouse of life itself: “A good man out of the good treasure of his heart brings forth good...” Your heart is the place where flourishing begins. It is the storehouse of life, where intentions, love, and alignment with God reside.

Your conscience is the faculty by which a person discerns right and wrong, judges behavior, and evaluates

alignment with moral law and divine will. It functions like an internal monitor or processing center, guiding decision-making. The conscience takes in experience, processes it, and releases order back into your world. The conscience draws from what is in the heart. Whatever fills the heart, shapes how the conscience interprets and processes reality. When your heart is aligned with justice, creation responds. This is reconciliation.

REWRITE YOUR REALITY



In the New Testament, the conscience becomes the instrument by which the Holy Spirit forms us. Jesus speaks directly to the heart as a friend. The Spirit hovers over the dark, confused places of our inner world until God's word brings light. James says the one who looks into "the perfect law of liberty," and obeys it will be "blessed in what he does." We are limited by what is sown in the heart, but when the conscience is redeemed, it becomes your ally because it allows honest reflection, repentance, and renewal. This is part of our identity: "You are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood."

HARDENED HEARTS, HARDENED WORLDS



In Exodus, God hardened Pharaoh's heart. This was tied to God's Name, which is His revealed character as Yahweh, the God who mirrors and responds. Pharaoh despised and took for granted God's extraordinary kindness and mistook tolerance for acceptance. In accordance with the hardness of his impertinent heart, God rendered wrath and judgement upon him according to his deeds. In Exodus 3 and 6, God reveals Himself as Yahweh, the God who is and who acts in perfect consistency with His nature. When Pharaoh hardened his heart, God mirrored back his hardness, and the entire system (the matrix) resisted change. In that sense, God did not merely impose hardness, He exposed it, confirmed it, and mirrored it.

The matrix too, mirrored Pharaoh's heart back to himself. Pharaoh was not just one man; he represented an entire ideological and spiritual system, a matrix of oppression, empire, and false gods. Before the text ever says, "God hardened Pharaoh's heart," it repeatedly says: "Pharaoh hardened his heart." That is, Pharaoh's posture of pride, cruelty, and resistance to divine justice was already present. God's hardening was therefore not coercion but judicial confirmation of God giving Pharaoh over to the very hardness he chose. Because God's Name is His revealed character as the One who mirrors back what is presented, God responded to Pharaoh's chosen hardness by confirming and amplifying it.

When the heart closes, the world around it closes and the matrix becomes rigid. The spiritual principle is that what the heart presents, God mirrors; what the heart chooses, reality reflects. So as a son, to open what is closed, you must stand in the posture of a son who can see on behalf of others. Sons operate by the opposite principle. You must stand in the posture of a son who can see on behalf of others. Where Pharaoh could only see his own power, a son sees for others, with compassion, intercession, and authority. A son breaks the cycle that hardness creates.

This is why in 1 Timothy 3:9, leaders are told to "hold the mystery of the faith with a pure conscience." The conscience holds up the mystery of faith. The Word circumcises the heart by cutting between soul and spirit, so faith can rise up from the heart. Without an awakened conscience, we remain under the heavy rule of the Law. A condemned heart keeps a person in bondage, and the matrix of life tightens around them.

THE BOUNTY OF GRACE

The woman caught in adultery was guilty of intentional sin. Under the Old Covenant, willful sin required one sacrifice: your life. Yet Jesus became that sacrifice when He prayed, "Father, forgive them...". Grace redeems the conscience. It is not about being a good person, but a true person, one who aligns with the character God sees beneath the surface. Jesus invested in the image of God within the woman caught in adultery. He looked past what the eye saw with a pure, unoffended gaze and called forth what Heaven had planted in her. The mystery of faith is held by a pure conscience, and Scripture promises: "If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us..."



When your conscience is cleansed and you are led by the Spirit, creation responds. This is epistemic justice in which your inner alignment becomes outer alignment. Your intentions change, your world changes, and Christ in you becomes the hope of glory.

VERDICT OF GRACE

Conscience reveals to us our need for forgiveness as a legal transaction. Forgiveness is not sentimental, it is just. It is the right thing for God to do because Christ has already paid the price and enacted justice. Confession is not merely admission, it is alignment. Like in the story of Cain, the Accuser wants to imprison your conscience, so you experience shame that leads to fear, which causes you to hide so that you put yourself in all manner of exile. Romans 4:7–8 says, “Blessed are those whose lawless deeds are forgiven, and whose sins are covered. Blessed is the man to whom the LORD shall not impute sin.”

In order to receive forgiveness, we first must confess our transgressions; it is the way to break the algorithm of accusation. We are told in 1 John 1:9, that “If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.”



Confession removes the Accuser’s legal leverage and aligns your speech with Heaven’s verdict: you are forgiven! When we confess, we restore our relational and covenant wholeness by participating in what the

court in Heaven has reversed. Confession manifests the verdict in community. The Book of Hebrews describes community as the city of the living God, which comprises the glorious cloud of witnesses who have gone before us. This is our ancestral weave, which is the interconnected, generational fabric of God's people across time.

“An innumerable company of angels, the general assembly of the Church of the Firstborn who are registered in heaven, the Judge of all, the spirits of just men made perfect, Jesus the Mediator of the new covenant, and to the blood of sprinkling that speaks better things than that of Abel.”

HEBREWS 12:22-24

The blood of Abel cries out for vengeance. It represents the blood of all those who have been wronged unjustly from the very first man who died and echoes throughout history, accusing us day and night. The blood of Christ has been availed to pay this debt. But when we hold on to sin, this blood accuses us, because it counts us among the company of Cain. When you confess, God justifies you, the Accuser is silenced and healing flows.

You can pray to God for forgiveness on your own, but it is even better if you confess to a mature believer, a priest or a pastor (a shepherd), who can guide you in your confession and release forgiveness over you. It takes humility on your part, but humility breaks structures of pride because as we discovered earlier, pride is the number one legal platform used by the Accuser. A stronghold weakened by humility is a stronghold ready to fall. Submitting to spiritual authority, dismantles self-justification and aligns you with Heaven's legal order.

CONFESSION UNDER AUTHORITY



Having someone with spiritual authority to pray over you, increases access to grace, and creates a witness and an agreement. This prayer is the effective fervent prayer of a righteous man spoken of in the Book of James.

“Is anyone among you sick? Let him call for the elders of the church, and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord. And the prayer of faith will save the sick, and the Lord will raise him up. And if he has committed sins, he will be forgiven. Confess your trespasses to one another, and pray for one another, that you may be healed. The effective, fervent prayer of a righteous man avails much.”

In the realm of justice, authority matters, witnesses matter, priestly mediation matters, and spiritual covering matters because authority overrides accusation and adds weight to the act of confession. This is scriptural because priests mediate forgiveness, prophets pronounce divine verdicts, elders exercise ecclesial authority, and apostles execute kingdom judgments. Even Jesus used delegated authority.

FORENSIC RIGHTEOUSNESS

Fervent prayer is not boisterous and loud, but that which has the power to shift verdicts. Deliverance is through alignment, not spectacle, and it is the bread of the children. Bread is a daily necessity, and it is given because you belong at the table. The phrase comes from Matthew 15:26, where Jesus says to the Syrophenician woman: “It is not right to take the children’s bread and throw it to the dogs.” So, “the children” refers to the covenant people who belong to God and “bread” refers to the benefits of being God’s children. In this narrative specifically, the bread is the deliverance and healing she is requesting. Jesus is framing deliverance as a covenant right and a part of normal daily provision for those in the family rather than something extraordinary. It flows from relationship, not performance, as a member of God’s household.

Deliverance is not earned, bargained for, or deserved. You receive healing— which is the restoration of justice in your body, mind, finances, relationships, and destiny— because your sins are forgiven. Wherever injustice has taken ground, in the form of accusation, sin, trauma, curses, or inherited patterns, healing is the just result of God’s verdict of righteousness. Remember the righteousness of Christ is forensic, meaning it is a legal transaction. It is imputed or credited to you; you don’t earn it. It is juridical, meaning that it is enacted as a courtroom verdict, and it is external in that it comes from outside the self.

Once legal rights are removed, you stand in righteousness, the accuser is silenced, the principality loses jurisdiction and you now have authority to judge and cast down the stronghold. Paul says, in his second letter to the Corinthians, to be “ready to punish all disobedience when your obedience is fulfilled.” Your standing before God is not based on your own moral or spiritual performance but on Christ’s perfect obedience and innocence, now legally transferred to you.



Now that we understand how spiritual strongholds, especially those fueled by offense, can derail humanity from aligning with Christ's preeminence, and how grace, testimony, and righteous judgment expose and break these patterns, we can examine these dynamics through causation: the repeating pattern of past experiences that shape expectations and perpetuate similar outcomes.

The breaking of causation— which is the refusal to let past patterns dictate future realities— comes through exposing and dismantling strongholds by identifying the hidden structures of thought, memory, and accusation that reinforce them. Breaking causation is also worked out through practices of thanksgiving and testimony, which realign the heart, renew the mind, and restore authority by declaring God's faithfulness and disrupting cycles of fear and offense.

"He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together."

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. Independence broke the world. Where are you still operating from self-trust?
2. The conscience is the innermost chamber. Is it surrendered — or hard to hear?
3. Your heart is a mirror. What does it currently reflect and uphold?

Activate • Search the innermost

Search me, O God, and know my heart. Try me and know my thoughts.

See if there is any wicked way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting.

I yield the tribunal. I will not judge by my own light.

Amen.

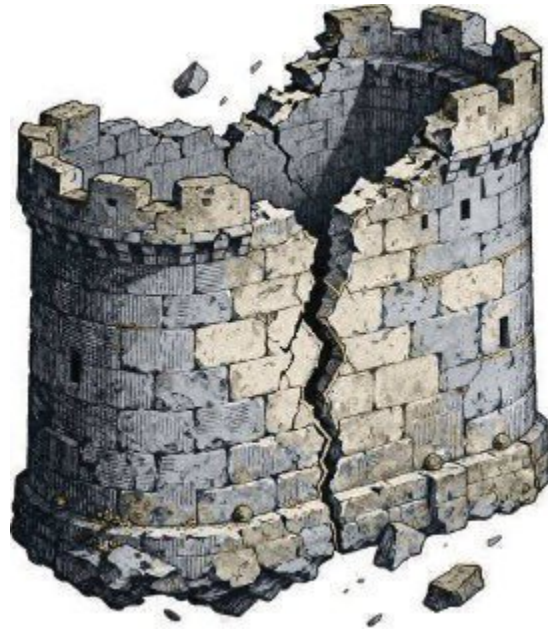
Exercise • What the mirror shows

Sit until the Spirit names one thing the heart is reflecting that is not His. Write it. Write the verdict of light.

Chapter 10 • From Stronghold to Freedom

A stronghold is occupancy with a legal story.

ARCHITECTURE OF DEFEAT



Causation is a repeating pattern in which past experiences create expectations that perpetuate similar outcomes. These patterns become strongholds that lock people into cycles of defeat, fear, and offense. Strongholds are tied to demonic influence and rebellious principalities: “The weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds.” These align with the rebellious divine beings assigned to nations post-Babel, who exploit human weaknesses to maintain control. And as we now understand, these beings can perpetuate strongholds by fostering division, pride, and offense to create patterns such as victimization, cultural grudges, and personal bitterness that the same rebellious principalities use to keep humanity from walking together in unity and in the authority of Christ.

INVERT THE CURSE

We break causation by refusing to let past patterns dictate future outcomes. The Bible recounts one such story of offense as the children of Israel were making their way to the Promised Land through the wilderness.

“They journeyed from Mount Hor by the Way of the Red Sea, to go around the land of Edom, and the soul of the people became very discouraged on the way. And the people spoke against God and against Moses: ‘Why have you brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? For there is no food and no water, and our soul loathes this worthless bread.’ So the Lord sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and many of the people of Israel died. Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, ‘We have sinned, for we have spoken against the Lord and against you; pray to the Lord that He take away the serpents from us.’ So Moses prayed

for the people. Then the Lord said to Moses, 'Make a fiery serpent, and set it on a pole; and it shall be that everyone who is bitten, when he looks at it, shall live.' So Moses made a bronze serpent, and put it on a pole; and so it was, if a serpent had bitten anyone, when he looked at the bronze serpent, he lived."

NUMBERS 21:8–9

Instead of destroying the object of their tragedy out of fear, the Israelites kept the cursed object visible and in so doing rejected any belief in its power, thereby breaking causation.

Likewise, Christ became the ultimate object of offense, and a stumbling block that exposed human rebellion, while simultaneously bearing the curse of sin and death on the Cross.

"But we preach Christ crucified, to the Jews a stumbling block and to the Greeks foolishness, but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the power of God and the wisdom of God."

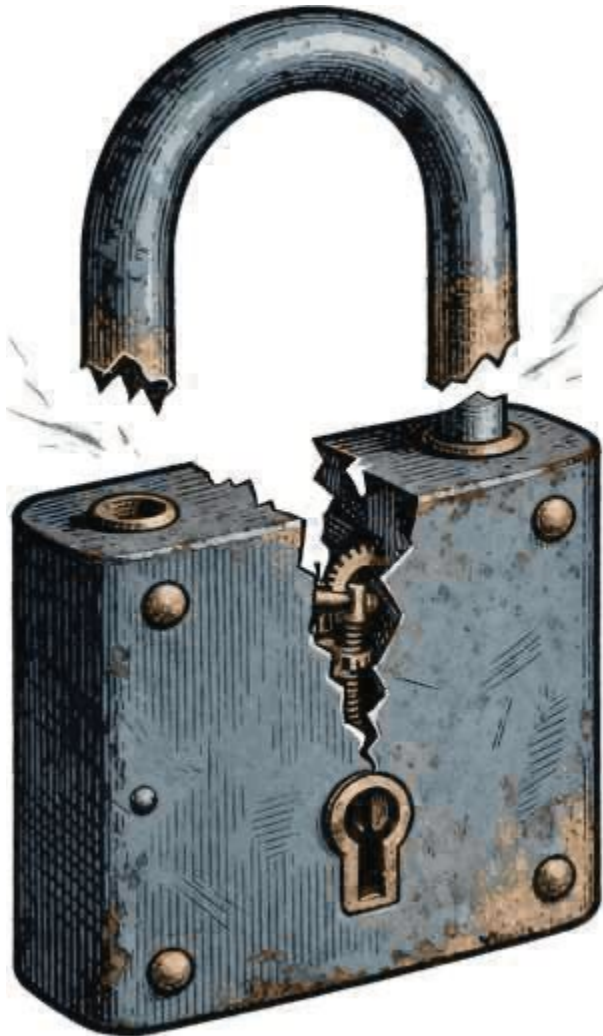
1 CORINTHIANS 1:23–24

Jesus willingly became the “cursed” to absorb the consequences of humanity's fall. Galatians 3:13 states, “Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us, for it is written, ‘Cursed is everyone who is hanged on a tree’.” This echoes Deuteronomy (21:22–23) that says, “If a man has committed a sin deserving of death, and he is put to death, and you hang him on a tree, his body shall not remain overnight on the tree, but you shall surely bury him that day, so that you do not defile the land which the Lord your God is giving you as an inheritance; for he who is hanged is accursed of God.”



In the Old Testament, the curse stems from humanity's rebellion, starting with Adam and Eve's sin, amplified at Babel through prideful division, and codified in the law as a standard humanity couldn't meet. The law, while holy, became a curse for those who failed it, mirroring how rebellious principalities exploit human weakness to perpetuate strongholds of offense and accusation through justification. To the Jews who were expecting a triumphant Messiah to overthrow Roman oppression and restore Israel's glory, a crucified Jesus was scandalous, cursed under the law, and a sign of weakness, not power. For the Gentiles (Greeks and Romans), who valued philosophical wisdom and heroic strength, the idea of a god dying shamefully on a cross was absurd and clashed with their intellectual and cultural ideals.

EXPOSE TO DISMANTLE



A stronghold in the biblical sense, refers to a fortified place in the human heart, mind, or life that symbolizes protection, permanence, and resistance. The term can be used to describe the dependence of God in our lives, as we see in Psalm 18:2 “The LORD is my rock and my fortress and my deliverer; My God, my strength, in whom I will trust; My shield and the horn of my salvation, my stronghold.” This is certainly what God intends for us. But unfortunately, there are areas of our lives where sin, falsehood, or spiritual oppression have entrenched themselves into a stronghold, and here they work by dominating your perception, behavior,

and emotions. 2 Corinthians 10:5, defines strongholds as “arguments and every pretension that sets itself up against the knowledge of God.” As well as operating from within you, we can also recognize them operating in our spheres of influence. If you notice an area of your life that is entrenched in lies and deception, or a system of thought that opposes God’s truth, it is probably under a stronghold.

We expose strongholds by bringing them into the light through testimony as revealed in The Book of Revelation 12:10–11: “The accuser of our brethren, who accused them before our God, day and night, has been cast down. And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony.” Remember Molech who we mentioned earlier? Let us use this ancient deity as a case study of the power of the Cross to invert the curse. Molech represents the pattern of sacrificing the vulnerable to gain power in human systems, a pattern that plays out continually in modern society. Molech is the spirit that says, Give me what is most precious, and I’ll give you power, success and protection.

Molech’s logic is Let the children pay so others may prosper. This pattern surfaces in political, economic, religious, and even family systems. It is the inverse of Yahweh, who gives life through His own Son, and protects children and the marginalized. Molech also rules wherever there is war and violence. Systems built on success at any cost are often under Molech’s influence. Whether in politics, the arts, education, or business, Molech manifests wherever human dignity is sacrificed to power through exploitation, coercion, burnout, or dehumanizing labor cultures.

Molech thrives in spiritual counterfeits. He embodies a false fatherhood that demands approval through performance, worth through suffering, and identity through self-erasure. This stands in absolute opposition to the Father revealed in Jesus Christ, whose attitude towards children is a direct rebuke of Molech.

“Let the little children come to Me... for of such is the kingdom of heaven.”

MATTHEW 19:14

TAKE IT TO THE BANK

Not only is Christ a good example of fatherhood, He also invites us to participate in the Divine Council alongside Him.

“But God, who is rich in mercy, because of His great love with which He loved us, even when we were dead in trespasses, made us alive together with Christ (by grace you have been saved), and raised us up together, and made us sit together in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus.”

EPHESIANS 2:4–6

Romans 8:16–17, tells us that “The Spirit Himself testifies with our spirit that we are God’s children. And if we are children, then we are heirs: heirs of God and co-heirs with Christ.” We will work with him to dethrone those like Molech so that their jurisdictions come back under the rulership of Christ. As Proverbs 21:22 says, “A wise man scales the city of the mighty and brings down the trusted stronghold.”



Once we find freedom, we give thanks and we testify about what the Lord has done. Praise and worship are responses to the restoration of justice. When your soul perceives that the scales have been balanced by God, gratitude erupts, intimacy opens, worship rises, and the glory returns. The glory is your weight restored, and you become substantial again. Presence is blocked wherever you still believe the Accuser's verdict. When the verdict shifts, worship flows naturally.

Sharing how God has changed you, breaks the power of accusation and shame, which are tools of the Accuser, who is the relentless prosecutor of humanity. Testimony reclaims authority and shifts focus from the stronghold's causation to Christ's victory. By openly declaring God's work in you (I was bitter towards someone who hurt me, but now I bless them with a whole heart. I'm free!) you disrupt the narrative of the Accuser, who thrives in secrecy and shame.

Offense and accusation perpetuate isolation by fostering mistrust between groups. Testimony, however, unifies by sharing stories of grace, reversing fragmentation, and aligning with the Church's role as the Body of Christ. It's a practical way to heal the fractured soul and it restores individuals and communities to their purpose.

Every time you testify, your testimony is banked as an inheritance for everyone else! We can equate your victory as the compensation received from a class action lawsuit that is accessed through your testimony. God doesn't just bring victory and breakthrough for you privately; He is doing it for the Church and the whole community through the word that you are releasing into the matrix of the earth and the spirit.

"But we preach Christ crucified, to the Jews a stumbling block and to the Greeks foolishness, but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the power of God and the wisdom of God."

1 Corinthians 1:23–24

Ponder

1. A stronghold is occupancy with a legal story. What story does yours tell?
2. What agreement, vow, or offense still grants it a right?
3. Freedom is not a mood. What structure will hold it once the occupancy leaves?

Activate • Break the agreement

In Christ I revoke every agreement occupancy has claimed.

The legal story ends at the Cross. I confess, I forgive, I repent.

This ground is reassigned. Rank restored.

Amen.

Exercise • The legal story

Write the stronghold's story in one paragraph — how it entered, what it promised, what it costs. Then write the revocation.

Chapter 11 • Rejecting Legalism

Law without the Spirit becomes a new jailer.

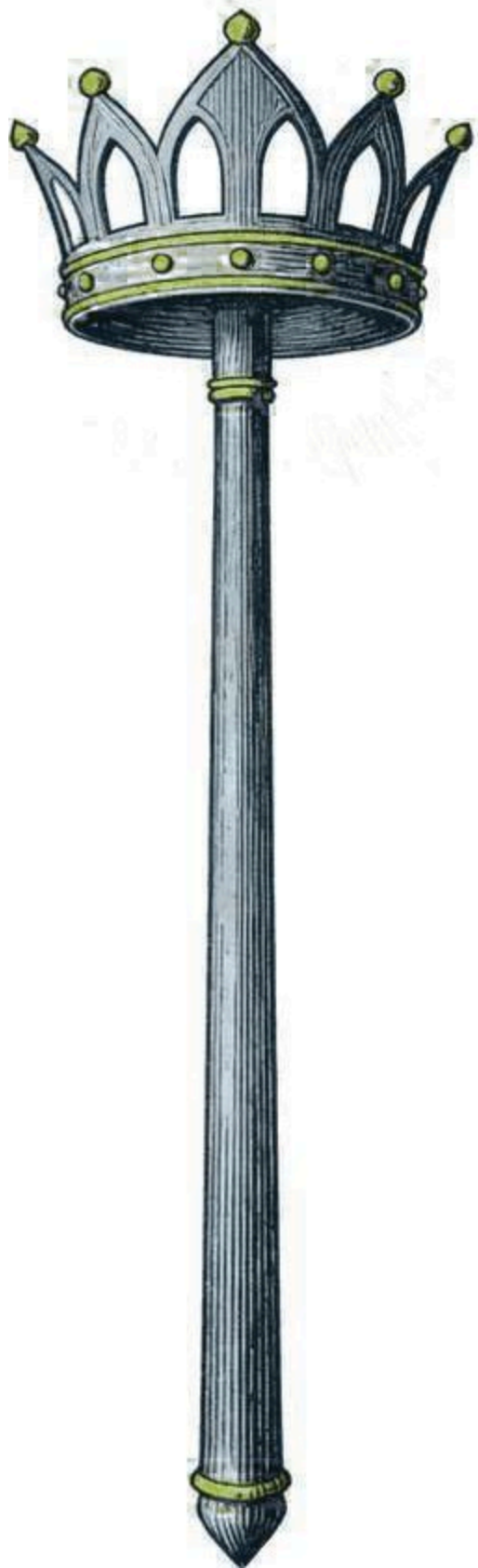
VICTIM TO VICTOR



Offense can spiral into movements marked by division and victimization. In turn, this can harden into advocacy stripped of objectivity, which naturally gives way to accusation. Accusation often appears as quick, sharp judgments formed in the heart, reinforcing the lie that people are defined by their failures or wounds. The division of the nations at Babel created fertile ground for such accusation to flourish. Cultural superiority, tribalism, and ethnic conflict are collective expressions of offense that mirror this personal dynamic. These fractures are easily exploited by rebellious divine beings to maintain influence over peoples — just as they did over the nations in Deuteronomy 32.

We dismantle the power of the Accuser by refusing to accuse ourselves or others, and instead choosing to embrace the grace that is, “Christ in you, the hope of glory,” and in this way we reject the legalistic environments that shame people. The redemption of the curse is the triumphant reversal: what was meant for destruction becomes the source of blessing. The Cross, enacting the curse, absorbs sin's penalty, and His blood cleanses your conscience, thereby breaking causation cycles of offense and accusation. Through His resurrection, Jesus transforms the curse into life, fulfilling Galatians 3:14, “That in Christ Jesus the blessing of Abraham might come to the Gentiles, so that we might receive the promised Spirit through faith.”

THE CURSED PRIEST



Lifting up the curse strips it of its power. When we expose and confess it (I was jealous... I am bitter) we

align ourselves with Christ's victory and command these forces to come under His preeminence. As the "image of the invisible God," Jesus confronted every power that resisted God's hierarchy, for in Him alone all authority is fulfilled.

By becoming a curse for us, He entered the fractured world shaped by Babel's division (nations under lesser beings) and bore the weight of their manipulative offenses upon the Cross. Isaiah reveals the depth of this identification: "He was despised and rejected by men... pierced for our transgressions and crushed for our iniquities." In taking the curse upon Himself, Jesus became the ultimate outcast, stepping into humanity's broken relationships, corrupted authority structures, and wounded dominion.

This curse was never merely linguistic; it expressed itself spiritually as the disruption of humanity's royal, priestly vocation—to replenish, consecrate, and subdue the earth with God's life and holiness. Jesus fulfilled that vocation on our behalf: the perfect King and Priest who restores what humanity had forfeited.

On the Cross, He "disarmed the rulers and authorities and put them to open shame," triumphing over the very powers that had exploited human rebellion. Entering the realm of chaos, division, and curse, He reconciled humanity to God and reopened the path to true stewardship and consecration. He became the "serpent lifted up," overturning the logic of power through humble submission to the Father and breaking the stronghold of the lie: I can save myself.

A ROYAL PRIESTHOOD OF NATIONS



Pentecost then continues this restoration when the Spirit fills humanity, equipping the scattered people who were once divided by Babel to spread God's presence across the earth. At Pentecost, the Spirit fills people, not land. Why? Because now people are the living temples who fill the earth with God's presence. Humanity spreads across nations again, not divided but carrying God's presence wherever they go. Where Adam was meant to fill the earth with image-bearers, the Church— empowered by the Spirit— fills the earth with Spirit-bearers.

Pentecost enables the replenishing of nations with the life of God, the Gospel of the Kingdom, and Spirit-filled sons and daughters. This is the creation mandate reborn through Christ. The Spirit empowers believers to subdue darkness, not by force, but with authority. We subdue sin through sanctification, chaos through the fruit of the Spirit, demonic powers through the authority of Christ, and broken systems through Kingdom justice.

After Babel, the nations became spiritually defiled and governed by “lesser beings.” The earth was no longer holy ground everywhere but contested. Pentecost reversed this. Through the Spirit, believers carry holiness with them, fulfilling the mandate to make the world a temple filled with the presence of God. Now, everywhere we stand becomes sacred. Every community we enter becomes a place where God dwells, and every culture we inhabit becomes a potential host for God's glory.

Pentecost is the moment when Christ shared the dominion he had regained with His people. Through the Spirit, the Church become heirs of God, co-heirs with Christ and a royal priesthood. Pentecost is a transfer of ownership rights, not earthly land deeds, but kingdom possession. The nations become Christ's inheritance and Christ shares that inheritance with His people.

REDEMPTIVE SHOCKWAVE

In the cosmic order, the Cross is where the curse converges. It enacts the curse by exposing humanity's offense through the religious leaders' accusation, Pilate's cowardice, and the crowd's mockery; all reflect the accuser's tactics. For us today, offense manifests itself when we reject Christ's mantle of humility. People take offense at His call to forgive enemies, deny self, or embrace weakness as strength. Yet, this offense is purposeful; it exposes the fractured soul under the oppression of strongholds and forces confrontation with accusation. Jesus draws out the hidden rebellion that exposes human rebellion. We see this in the Pharisees' outrage at His claims and the crowd's rejection at His trial.

As the object of offense, naked and stripped of dignity, beaten and crowned with thorns, he mirrors our brokenness. His humiliation is instrumental in confronting principalities: Ephesians 3:10 suggests that through the Church (born from the Cross), "the manifold wisdom of God might now be made known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly places." The Cross enacts the curse to dismantle the hold of these powers, as their apparent victory (Jesus' death) becomes their defeat. It is a redemptive provocation inviting repentance and alignment with authority over principalities. To identify with the power of the resurrection, we must identify with the weakness of the Cross.

Practically, this means embracing offense as a path to healing. By forgiving as Christ forgave, and testifying to His redemptive work, we break strongholds created by offense. Through the Cross, Jesus— the object of offense, the cursed, and the redeemer— encapsulates God's strategy against a divided, offense-ridden world.

By doing this, he empowered the Church of Christ to be an instrument of grace (not legalism), where the fractured soul integrates, as Christ's redemption replaces defensive mechanisms. If you believe, you are invited and encouraged to release offense, to testify, and align with His victory that turns curses into blessings and division into unity.

GO AND SIN NO MORE

The story of the paralytic of Bethesda in John 5:1–18 is a legal showdown between the Accuser's system, and the Son's justifying authority. The man was paralyzed for 38 years and despite being at a pool associated with angelic stirring, he had no advocate, no helper, and he carried the stigma of constant failure to qualify. He was trapped under a system of ritual and performance and disempowered by accusation. This was a conditional healing system, based on competition (only the first one wins) that rewarded the strong and excluded the broken. He was not merely sick but accused and disqualified. He was alone, always late, trapped in victimization, probably feeling that he never measured up, and perhaps that others deserved healing more than him. Hence Jesus asked him, "Do you want to be made well?" He was dealing with more than muscles. He was dealing with inner verdicts. Jesus interrupted the Accuser by bypassing angelic mediation, ritual qualification, timing, competition, performance and self-effort. Jesus restored him not just to health, but to his rightful place in God's justice, lifting him out of victimization and the weight of inner accusation, breaking the verdicts that had disqualified him and granting him the authority to stand and participate fully in life again.

His healing was the evidence of Jesus' judgement. He was told to take up his mat as evidence that the verdict over him was overturned, paralysis was no longer his identity, and the scales had been balanced. He was then told to "go and sin no more" (vs 14). In other words, Jesus was telling him not to return to the mindset that opened the door to accusation. He was not to align again with the voice that paralyzed him and victimized him— now he was to live under the new verdict.

SPIRITUAL ECONOMIES

Strongholds show up in victimization or recurring patterns. More specifically, these strongholds create spiritual economies of corruption. Another way to look at strongholds is as reasoning systems or ideological economies. A spiritual economy is similar to an economy in the natural realm, in that it is a system of exchange, flow, influence, value, power, reward, and consequence governed by principles. Every economy has inputs, outputs, cycles, reinvestment patterns, and feedback systems.



A corrupt spiritual economy is formed when a stronghold produces recurrent patterns of destruction. Those patterns create predictable “flows” of energy that empower demonic structures. In turn, those structures reinvest corruption into the system. It is a self-reinforcing ecosystem of brokenness, which is why corruption — whether moral, spiritual, institutional, or societal— always seems to repeat itself, feed itself, and grow by itself. It is not random, it is structured, and structure is what makes it an economy.

Judgment involves recognizing the pattern, rejecting its power, and redirecting it to a place where it can no longer harm. Judging a stronghold, whether personal or collective, involves declaring Christ’s authority over it, as all powers are subject to Him, and this prevents the perpetuation of fragmentation and division. “Do you not know we will judge angels?”.

Let’s return to the story of the man of the Gerasenes; this is not only a story of deliverance, but it is also an economic, political, and spiritual confrontation. In the ancient world, pigs were economic assets, especially in a gentile region like the Decapolis where the demon-possessed man in the story lived. A herd of 2,000 pigs is enormous. This was not random village livestock— it represented the regional industry.

Under Torah, pigs were unclean animals. Israel was forbidden to raise, trade, or consume pigs. So, to the Jews of the region, those 2,000 pigs would have been a massive covenant violation, yet the pigs were central to this economy. It seems Jesus had traveled to a gentile, non-covenant territory under foreign gods, foreign economies, and foreign spiritual dominions. We gather from history that the Decapolis was heavily Romanized and Roman soldiers ate pork as a staple, with their military outposts often sustaining large pig operations. The term “Legion” is a Roman military term meaning 5,000–6,000 soldiers. Most likely the Decapolis region contracted pig herds for Roman supply chains. This was probably a Roman military supply herd, not a random farm.

To the Jews, the pig industry symbolized a culture of defilement. Pigs were not just unclean, they represented gentile culture, idolatry, empire, covenant-breaking, foreign dominion over the land, and systems outside Yahweh’s justice because of the presence of unclean governing powers over the territory. When Jesus asked the demon who had possessed the man in the story it responded by saying, “My name is Legion, for we are many.” By allowing the demons to enter the pigs, he was not just solving one man’s problem, He was performing a territorial strike on a Roman stronghold economy. He exposed the whole region’s economic participation in uncleanness. Jesus judged the demonic ecosystem behind Roman occupation that had infested the region. He restored the land spiritually, breaking the spiritual-economic cycle and ending a corrupt system’s power source. The people begged Jesus to leave because he had destroyed a major economic sector that profited from a spiritual stronghold.

The Prophet Isaiah warned that “Those who sanctify themselves and purify themselves, to go to the gardens after an idol in the midst, eating swine’s flesh and the abomination and the mouse, shall be consumed together,” says the LORD.” Jesus reversed this curse so that instead of people eating pigs and being judged, the pigs carried the judgment and were consumed.

Jesus also asserted himself as Lord over this gentile territory. No Jewish rabbi would have traveled intentionally into unclean territory to confront a large, unclean economy to permit demons to enter unclean animals and collapse a gentile economic structure. By revealing power over a Roman legion, he was demonstrating that not only is He Lord of Israel, but He is also Lord of the nations, Lord over Rome, Lord

over principalities, Lord over economies, spiritual systems, and territorial powers.

The Gerasene event shows that strongholds often attach to unclean economies. They need systems to survive. Corrupt spiritual economies depend on unholy flows of value such as money, power, exploitation, idolatry, and fear. Jesus identified Mammon as the principality in the region and the structures under which it operated.

SYSTEMS AND SYMPTOMS



The spirit of Mammon is not money, it is economic idolatry, structural greed, political power, dehumanization, economies that exploit fear and bondage, and the belief that life is secured by material forces instead of God. It feeds on brokenness, repeats and multiplies injustice, creates predictable cycles, turns sin into a resource and reinvests destruction.

It becomes a self-sustaining demonic ecosystem. Deliverance must deal with systems, not just symptoms. Jesus didn't only free the man, he collapsed the entire system that empowered the demons.

Through this example we learn how strongholds create economies of oppression. A stronghold is not just a thought; it is a pattern. A pattern is not just an influence, it is a system.

A system is not just a structure, it becomes an economy with inputs (trauma, fear, sin, resentment, idolatry); outputs (actions, patterns, consequences, behaviors); reinvestment loops (the consequences produce more sin, which produces more consequences); invisible brokers (principalities, demons, mindsets, cultural powers); tools of exchange (temptation, shame, pride, greed, fear); rewards (false power, temporary pleasure, social advantage, domination); and costs (bondage, loss, fragmentation, generational cycles). Examples of oppressive economies in today's world are human trafficking systems, pornography and sexual addiction, corruption in political or judicial systems, generational poverty and oppression, criminal networks, and religious manipulation.

The Bible functions as a profound psychological and spiritual manual, revealing the dynamics of human behavior through parables, stories, and allegories. Its narratives illuminate how the human spirit, mind, and body interact with social, economic, and spiritual systems. In the section that follows, we will explore how the biology of the brain intersects with the influence of Mammon, Jezebel, and Leviathan—how these forces exploit fear and brokenness to construct self-reinforcing spiritual and psychological ecosystems, and how deliverance disrupts them.

Neuroscience shows that strongholds are not merely thoughts; they are patterns. And patterns, in turn, are not merely influences—they are systems operating through tools of exchange, all of which carry costs. In the next chapter, we will also see how Scripture offers a blueprint for recognizing, dismantling, and rising above these oppressive systems, to restore freedom, dignity, and alignment with God’s order.

“He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together.”

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. Where has law without the Spirit become a new jailer?
2. What rule do you keep that is not His yoke?
3. Legalism looks like order. How is it different from rank under Christ in your life?

Activate • The Spirit, not the jailer

Lord, I reject legalism as a counterfeit of Order.

I receive Your yoke, not a heavier harness of my own making.

Where I have bound others, I repent. Where I have bound myself, I am released.

Amen.

Exercise • Name the counterfeit rule

Write one law you enforce (on yourself or others) that is not His. Replace it with one sentence of the easy yoke.

Chapter 12 • The Neuroscience of Deliverance

Freedom is spiritual, and the body keeps the score until light rewires it.

WHERE SCIENCE MEETS THE SPIRITUAL



Now that we have explored the spiritual framework of how powers influence systems, we can turn our attention to the individual level and consider how this dynamic can shape your own ecosystem. In doing so, we step into the space where science and spirit intersect— a realm in which inner formation, physiology, and spiritual reality converge.

There have been numerous scientific inquiries into spiritual or demonic possession, primarily within the fields of psychology, psychiatry, anthropology, neurology, and cultural studies. These investigations often frame possession experiences as psychological, neurological, or sociocultural phenomena rather than supernatural events, with explanations including dissociative states, psychosis, trauma responses, mass hysteria, or brain abnormalities.

THE ANATOMY OF A TAKEOVER



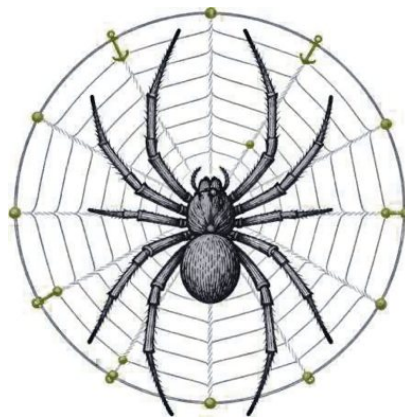
Research on frontal-lobe deactivation during prayer, meditation, and glossolalia is discussed extensively in Dr. Andrew Newberg's work. Newberg looks at how the brain behaves during intense spiritual moments, such as during prayer, meditation, or speaking in tongues. Newberg found that during these experiences, the parts of the brain tied to self-control and language (like the frontal lobes) slow down. This can make you feel like you are not yourself, which is very similar to the way people describe the possession experience. According to Newberg, speaking in tongues is generally not considered pathological. It is a spiritual practice with emotional, subjective meaning.

Patrick McNamara's work also delves into the fascinating parallels between people speaking in tongues during ecstatic Pentecostal services and those experiencing demonic possession. His findings also indicate that the brain activity in both instances look remarkably similar. McNamara is a neuroscientist who specializes in religion, dreams, and consciousness; he explains that possession involves parts of the brain that are used for understanding others' thoughts, imagining new scenarios, or letting go of control. He analyzes possession alongside pathological conditions to see whether possession itself is a kind of illness, or whether it simply activates some of the same brain areas that are involved in these disorders.

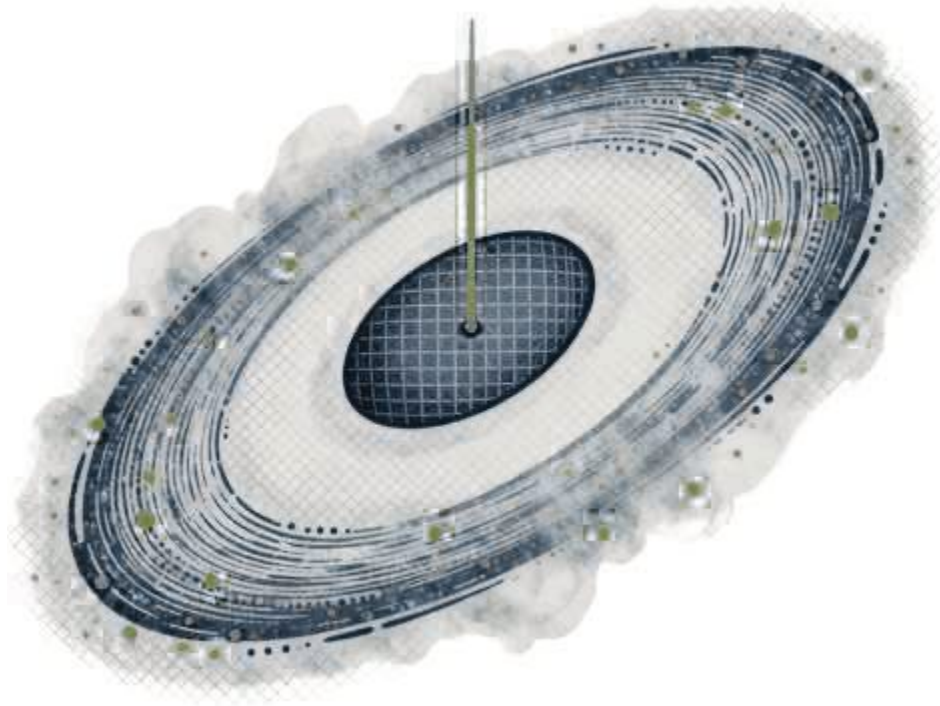
AGENCY OR INTRUSION?

So how can we tell if it is possession or pathology? We can try to discern this by determining the sense of agency of the person, what McNamara refers to as the "Agentic Self". He describes the agentic self as the part of us that feels like we are in control of our actions. It's the executive, goal-directed, choosing aspect of consciousness, that which we normally call "me".

In pathological states like schizophrenia or certain dissociative disorders, this agentic self, breaks down and you feel acted upon or invaded by uncontrollable forces. McNamara combines limbic distinction with agency mapping in the brain, and here he introduces the insula, a part of the brain deep in the brainstem and cortex, which helps us feel our inner bodily and emotional states such as our heartbeat, gut tension, warmth, pain, and even the texture of our own thoughts. This is what scientists refer to as interoception or the sense of what's happening inside the body. When the insula is active, your mind is tuned inward, registering sensations as self-generated. In conditions like schizophrenia or bipolar disorder, when hallucinations occur, the insula often shows abnormal activity. You might hear voices or have intrusive thoughts but still perceive them as coming from within as if your own mind is talking to you



DIVINE FLOW OR MIND IN CHAOS?



The key area of the brain used for distinguishing self from other, and for locating experiences in space and time, is called the temporal-parietal junction (TPJ). It sits near the intersection of the temporal and parietal lobes and helps you know where sensations and thoughts are coming from, i.e., Is this me or something outside me? It's also heavily involved in theory of mind (imagining others' intentions) and in out-of-body or spiritual experiences. In possession states, the TPJ becomes more active, while the insula and limbic "fear" circuits quieten down. So, what you may feel is, This is not coming from me, but rather it is something larger — beyond or outside me— moving through me.

Therefore, when you see a person falling and shaking during a time of worship, it's not necessarily demons at work; it's more likely that they are being filled with the Holy Spirit. And Holy Spirit possession, even when it is passionate and full of joyous energy, is accompanied by a deep sense of peace, and it is something accepted as part of worship.

McNamara also studied stories of people who feel like a spirit or demon is taking over their body. During these moments, they might act differently, speak in strange voices, or feel like they're not in control. These experiences are similar to those of people speaking in tongues— in which they may describe a divine force moving them— but possession can feel more intense, dramatic, and frightening. These possession experiences can be violent, often involving identity disturbance, alteration of self-boundaries, and the sense that someone else is present or controlling them. The self becomes fragmented, and fear dominates.

Possession involves something from outside entering or controlling the self (whether the Holy Spirit or another spiritual entity), but a pathology is something going wrong within the person's own mind or brain. We do not judge either. What is important is to ask whether the experience heals or harms, brings clarity or chaos, integrates positively into the person's life, or whether it causes breakdown and dysfunction.

SACRED CALM VS. CHAOTIC MIND

In spiritual experiences like speaking in tongues, worship or deep prayer, the brain changes are temporary, non-destructive, and emotionally meaningful. People return to normal states peacefully. McNamara's research suggests that in religious possession states the limbic system quiets down. Instead of fear, there's calm surrender, awe, and a sense of being guided by a benevolent force.

In pathological conditions like psychosis, trauma-related dissociation, or epilepsy, the altered brain activity tends to persist or recur unpredictably, often disrupting daily life and emotional balance. The limbic system — which is the brain's emotional and survival center that includes the amygdala— becomes overactive in pathological states. The brain is flooded with fear, threat responses, and chaotic emotional energy. If it causes harm, confusion, violence, fear, or loss of personal control over time, it's more likely to be considered a pathological or dissociative condition that needs specialist care.



McNamara notes that clinical studies of exorcism— particularly those in Pentecostal Christian settings— reported remarkably high rates of improvement (around 80–83%) among people who had not responded to medication or psychotherapy. These were often treatment-resistant cases of depression, anxiety, or psychotic-like disturbances that had persisted despite medical intervention. Yet, after undergoing a religious ritual interpreted as “exorcism”, many participants reported dramatic, sustained recovery.

YOKED FOR GLORY

Through the wisdom of science, we gain a deeper understanding into God's intention and purpose for us when He designed our brains. Our body as a temple of the Holy Spirit was fearfully and wonderfully made to be a receptor of the presence of Christ in perfect balance. Our nervous system was created for possession! This means we are created as vessels to be able to receive information through the act of possession. This is the yoking we spoke of earlier. Our brains were designed to be just like that of Christ.

It's important to understand that the experience of spiritual possession or being yoked with the Spirit is fundamentally different from a pathological condition. Pathological experiences, like certain mental health disorders, are often disordered, involuntary, and disruptive to daily life. By contrast, a Spirit-led yoking aligns your emotional center (Eros) with your thinking and decision-making center (Thumos), creating an integrated, balanced state.



Neuroscience helps us see this clearly. The anterior cingulate functions as a bridge between feeling and moral cognition, linking what you feel with what you know is right. When your spirit is in charge, this connection allows your heart, mind, and purpose to move in harmony. The result is a profound clarity, inner peace, and alignment—the antithesis of chaos and disorder.

This distinction is important because true deliverance is about restoring balance and authority, not simply removing symptoms or controlling behavior. Understanding the neurobiological mechanics of yoking helps us grasp how spiritual authority works in the brain and heart, and why genuine alignment with God leads to freedom, clarity, and power in life.

“He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together.”

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. Illumination that never reaches the breath, the gut, the sleep, the startle — remains half-preached.
Where is yours still only an idea?
2. Where does the body still flinch while the mind agrees?
3. What would it mean to occupy the body as a temple this week — not as a ghost at prayer?

Activate • Temple

This body is a temple. I am not a ghost at prayer.

Light, reach the place that still flinches — the old alarm in the nerves.

I yield the grooves of fear. Rewire me in peace.

Amen.

Exercise • Let light reach the flinch

Name where the body keeps the score (sleep, gut, startle, breath). Write one embodied practice you will keep daily until the idea becomes occupancy.

Chapter 13 • Anointed to Rule

You were anointed to govern, not merely endure.

HOLY TAKEOVER



The heart of the Church, and one of the main reasons we gather, is to be inhabited and empowered by the Holy Spirit. He must take charge of every area of our lives, including the hidden places we have kept closed. Any space we withhold from Him can become an entry point for other powers to occupy and influence, and wherever they settle, conflict follows.

The Holy Spirit, unlike these forces, never forces His way in. He is a gentleman. He comes only by invitation, and He will not remain where something else is given preeminence. This is what the Church speaks of when we talk about the anointing, or the life of Sonship we explored earlier.

When Jesus asked his disciples who people said he was, Jesus as the Messiah was not revealed to Peter the Apostle by flesh and blood, but by the Holy Spirit. Not only was Jesus the Son of God, but he was the Messiah, which means the Anointed One. Until you know Jesus as the Anointed One, you will not understand possession and the habitation of the Holy Spirit in his fullness. Peter was saying that Jesus carried God's Spirit and mandate to take back every territory whether spiritual, emotional, or physical that darkness had claimed. It was not just a theological statement but a recognition of power and takeover.

To be possessed by the Holy Spirit means being fully given over and utterly yielded to the rule of God within. The Spirit doesn't share space with darkness. For Him to possess you, there has to be an ouster of whatever has been ruling there before. This is what Jesus meant when He said, "The Kingdom of God is within you." The Kingdom advances by displacement. As you yield to God, the inner impulses that once gave darkness a foothold are dismantled. What once ruled within is cleared away so Christ may rule there instead. To be anointed is to be set apart to occupy and rule; to be authorized for dominion.

Jesus does not want us to shut down our emotions or desires; he wants us to let them move in harmony under the Holy Spirit's guidance. This is exactly what Paul means when he tells us to be "anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer and supplication, with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God; and the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus." When we are governed by the Spirit, our circuits synchronize and we feel fierce peace. We have an inner coherence where heart, mind, and purpose move as one. This is not suppression of drive, it is sanctified synchronization, and this is the perfect place to return to the subject of neuroscience.

THE BRAIN BEHIND THE BATTLE

Why are we talking about neuroscience in a book on deliverance? Because it helps restore dignity to this work. Deliverance does not require dramatic displays or sensational videos to impress crowds, as is the practice in some deliverance ministries. Instead, we can approach it with grace, clarity, and honor.



At the center of this subject is the theory of the narrative agent model (NAM). In neuroscience and cognitive anthropology, a NAM describes the brain's way of constructing a story about the self by using an agent—a being with intention, personality, or will—within a narrative framework. It is how we internally perceive, sense, or relate to presences that appear to "act" within our mental or spiritual world. Spiritually, these agents can be understood as spirits: not only invisible beings but also living ideas or organizing principles that exert influence on our thoughts, emotions, and behavior. Scripture speaks of these forces as principalities and powers:

"For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly

places.”

EPHESIANS 6:12

UNDERSTANDING NAMS



Your brain is wired to model other minds, to track motives, desires, and beliefs, even when no one is physically there. This system is what allows you to: empathize with someone, imagine what God desires, sense a “presence,” or hear an inner voice that feels “not me.” A NAM is a mental construct of an agent in a story. It can be a person, a deity, a demon, an ancestor, a principle, or even an internalized belief like “perfectionism” or “fear of rejection.”

When that model becomes strong and emotionally charged, it begins to act like an independent presence within your psyche, something that can speak, push, or influence you.

SPIRITS AS IDEAS AND PRINCIPLES



In spiritual anthropology, a spirit doesn't have to be a ghostly being. It can also be a pattern of energy, emotion, or thought that behaves like an entity. For example, the spirit of fear is not just a feeling, it's a pattern of perception and reaction that spreads, speaks, and controls like a living force. The Spirit of Wisdom acts as an ordering intelligence, guiding and balancing. The spirit of Jezebel isn't just a woman from history, it's the embodiment of control, seduction, and manipulation, often working through systems or relationships. Each of these spirits can be seen as a NAM: mental, cultural, and spiritual entities that organize behavior and worldview.

HOW THEY OPERATE IN US

Every NAM carries a storyline, a script about how the world works and how you should act accordingly. If you internalize a fearful narrative, for example, you might begin to think and feel as though that fear is an external will acting on you.

As we have seen, your brain's temporal-parietal junction (TPJ), the area that helps distinguish between "me" and "not me," gets involved here. When the TPJ attributes agency to an outside source, the experience feels as though something outside of you is influencing it. That's why possession, inspiration, or oppression can feel like something external, even though it interacts with your mind's internal models.



So, when Scripture or theology speaks of spirits, and neuroscience speaks of narrative agents, they may be describing the same phenomenon in different languages. Both point to active, organizing intelligences operating within the field of human consciousness.

SPIRITS AS CULTURAL CODE



Cultures name and codify these agents differently. Psychology calls them complexes, archetypes, or internalized scripts. Anthropology calls them mythic agents or cultural models. The Bible calls them principalities, powers, rulers of darkness, or spirits. They all describe patterns that shape how humans think, feel, and act collectively, stories so powerful they become invisible operating systems.

THE REDEPTIVE VIEW

In the biblical or regenerative view, these spirits (NAMs) are not merely psychological fictions, they are real organizing forces in the cosmos and in the psyche. Some align with divine order (Spirit of God, Spirit of Truth, Spirit of Wisdom), others distort that order (fear, pride, control, rebellion).

Transformation, then, is about changing the narrative agent that governs your life by replacing destructive scripts with redemptive ones. Paul describes this when he says: “Be transformed by the renewing of your mind.” Renewal means reprogramming the narrative agents that occupy your internal world, dethroning false spirits and enthroning the Spirit of Truth.

When the Spirit of God governs your inner system, the false agents lose power. Your narratives align with divine truth, and your consciousness becomes coherent: a sound mind.

PRINCIPALITIES BEHIND PRINCIPLES



We have discovered that a principality is a realm that is governed by a spiritual prince, power, or ruling spirit that influences human behavior and systems. When you live your life by a certain fixed principle—especially one rooted in fear, pride, or control—that principle can become a principality that rules over you. It’s as though the principle becomes a little king inside your heart telling you how to live, even when you

want to behave differently.

THE 80/20 PRINCIPLE



An example is the phrase: “I will never trust anyone.” You may have a principle never to trust anyone 100% so that others only ever experience 80% of you. That 20% of distrust may seem like wisdom or protection, but in reality, it has become a stronghold, a mental and emotional fortress that blocks genuine connection. It rules by fear and self- protection, not love. No one really knows you. You just give them what they want, and you think that’s normal. Because when fear or control rules your relationships, you become guarded, and people only meet your surface, not your true self.

Jezebel, Mammon, and Leviathan are spiritual archetypes or patterns of domination, greed, and pride. They are metaphors for powerful systems of thought and emotion that control people and societies. When we “sack” or “cast down” these principalities, we are identifying and dismantling these deep-rooted ways of thinking (the principles that give them power) in ourselves.

SPIRITUAL WARFARE IS MENTAL WARFARE

“We do not wage war according to the flesh... For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds, casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God.”

2 CORINTHIANS 10:3-5

“Strongholds” and “arguments” are not literal fortresses but mental and emotional belief systems that keep us stuck. They are principles (ways of thinking) that stand against the truth of God’s love and wisdom. So, when Paul says, “take every thought captive to the obedience of Christ,” he is charging us to replace false, fear-based principles with Christ’s way of thinking: humility, trust, and love. This is how spiritual warfare actually happens— in the realm of thought and principle. It is the restoration of rank and order that we discussed earlier.



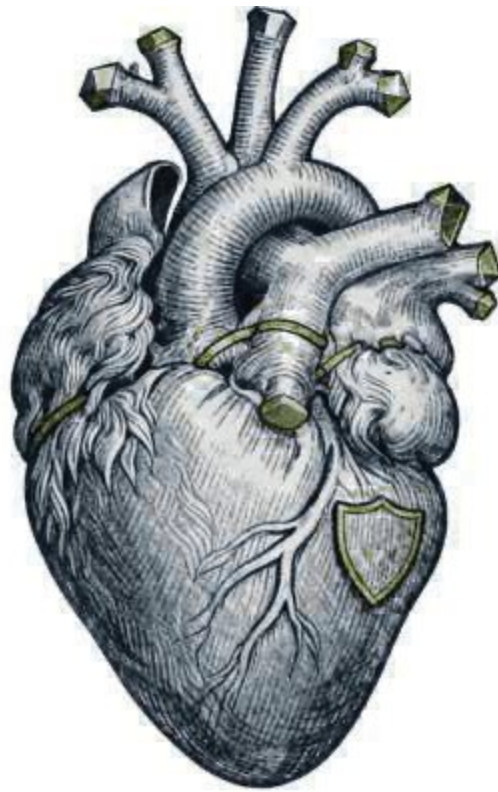
THE FORCE THAT IS POWER, LOVE, AND A SOUND MIND

We need to understand the sound mind that Paul speaks of, because without understanding, we cannot apply wisdom rightly. Wisdom is not just information, it’s a blueprint.

“The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom.”

PROVERBS 9:10

Wisdom flows from reverence and awe, not fear of punishment; it is the kind of fear that keeps us aligned with truth. And whilst Fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom, understanding is also a vital part of the structure. In the past, we were confused about judgment, accusation, and forgiveness; these were concepts we grappled with in trying to understand the balancing of the scales. Now, however, through timely revelation, we’ve been able to trace the history of offense itself— or what Scripture calls “the record of iniquity”— all the way back to the Garden.



THE NARRATIVE OF OFFENSE

The story of the fall, involving Adam and Eve, the serpent and the fruit, is not just mythic history, it's a pattern. It encodes the structure of rebellion and redemption. When God says, "She will crush your head, and you will strike her heel," he is giving a prophetic picture of the Cross. The ancient writers of the Old Testament carried this mystery without fully understanding it. But as human history unfolded, God revealed more and more— through nations and covenants, and through the economic and cultural systems that shaped them.

When Jesus overturned the tables in the Temple, He wasn't just protesting corruption. He was confronting the spirit of trading that began in Eden, the exchange of truth for a lie. The slavery in Egypt, the exile in Babylon, the Tower of Babel, all are manifestations of this same economy of fear. These are spiritual economies of oppression, systems of energy, exchange, and power built on the fear of lack. And that's why Paul's words are revolutionary: "God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and a sound mind."



THE SPIRIT OF FEAR AND ITS MASKS

Every fallen economy— whether spiritual, emotional, cultural, or financial— is energized by fear. Fear drives us to hide, just like Adam and Eve did. When God asked, “Who told you that you were naked?” He was exposing the first false narrative, the one that makes us cover ourselves instead of walking in trust. Entire nations now do the same. Like Adam and Eve, they wear the fig leaves of systems built on fear and shame. The few at the top cover their insecurity by exploiting others, while the whole body suffers. This is Mammon at work, the spirit of scarcity that convinces you to hoard, compete, and distrust. You may gain wealth but lose peace, because Mammon ultimately exposes the nakedness it promises to cover.

THE FEAR TRIAD

Fear manifests through three main spiritual systems: Mammon, Leviathan, and Jezebel. Each system attacks one of the gifts God has given us. There are many masks through which spiritual systems operate, but we will focus on Mammon, Leviathan, and Jezebel as our primary examples.

Mammon is the fear of lack, poverty, and not having enough. Mammon personifies wealth, greed, and the false god of materialism. Spiritually, Mammon represents the energy of attachment to material power. It is a distortion of divine abundance into possessiveness, control, and fear of loss. God’s answer to Mammon is power. *Dunamis* (δύναμις) is the Greek word for power. When examined deeper it refers to power as God’s dynamic energy, miraculous ability, and inherent strength. It is interesting to note that the Prophet Isaiah in speaking about the Messiah who was to come wrote that “The Spirit of the LORD shall rest upon Him, The Spirit of wisdom and understanding, The Spirit of counsel and might, The Spirit of knowledge and of the fear of the LORD.” The Spirit of might mentioned here is the Hebrew word *Gevurah* (גְּבוּרָה), which means power, strength, might, courage, valor, and divine fortitude. *Gevurah*’s energy is discipline, boundary, restriction, and justice. It is the power that contains and defines; in a moment we will see why this is significant.

Dunamis and *Gevurah* describe active, divine strength, not human effort or domination. They both signify empowerment sourced from the Spirit of God, from the energy that enables a person to overcome fear, act courageously, and manifest divine purpose in the world. In Isaiah we see divine strength resting upon the Messiah, but in by the time Paul is exhorting Timothy, this divine strength is now dwelling within the believer. We can therefore say that the Spirit of Power is the Spirit of Might internalized as the same breath of divine strength expressed in the believer as courage and capacity to act without fear.



In essence, Mammon can be seen as a fallen or unbalanced aspect of Gevurah. When strength, boundary, and structure are separated from divine compassion, they harden into fear, scarcity, and domination. Gevurah is the inner power to say “enough,” to steward wealth responsibly and to set boundaries where Mammon is manifesting the inability to trust divine provision, leading to grasping, accumulation, and control. Where Mammon is in control you will find strength without grace and judgment without love. The Spirit of Power that Christ gives restores your ability to create, to steward, to act with authority. Redeeming Mammon by bringing it to subjection under Christ, therefore, is to restore Gevurah to its divine balance by transforming the misuse of power and wealth into service, responsibility, and righteous order.

Jezebel is the spirit of control, domination, and emotional manipulation. You will notice that the scripture always holds principles in perfect balance. We can compare this balance to the tension a tightrope walker needs to maintain so that the rope holds and he doesn't plummet to his death. Or Christ's perfectly balanced yoke we examined previously. According to 2 Timothy 1:7, God's answer to Jezebel is love or Agape (ἀγάπη) in Greek. We will be linking Agape in the New Testament to Chesed in the Old Testament. They are two sides of the same coin because the New Testament is a fulfillment of the Old Testament. The Old Testament has numerous references to God's loving kindness or Chesed (חֶסֶד). In the Hebrew, every word has deep nuance; what we would refer to plainly as love, Chesed defines as God's loyal, covenant-bound love. Isn't that beautiful?

Let us delve in a little deeper. The Jezebel spirit is an energetic pattern that operates by the misuse of influence, affection, or charisma to dominate rather than to serve. It operates energies of distortion such that control is disguised as care; seduction and manipulation replace genuine relationships; and false prophecy or spiritual showmanship replace true devotion. It mimics the pattern of love but lacks Chesed's inner root of humility and divine alignment. Love is used to control, and affection is used to possess or sway, not to liberate. Remember when Jezebel applied kohl to her eyes? She was using her creativity as a control mechanism.

In contrast, Chesed is steadfast love, covenantal kindness, and gracious giving. It is expansive, generous, and creative. Christ is the incarnation of divine covenant love and true love releases, it doesn't control. It empowers others instead of possessing them. What Prophet Isaiah was foreshadowing in the Old Testament was the rule of Christ coming through Christ's death. The Cross, as the instrument of Christ's death, was God's creative genius in action to set us free from the domination of cosmic powers. So, when the Holy Spirit possesses you, He is in fact, baptizing you into the love of God, to liberate you and empower you.

Let us apply the principle of balance or yoking that we examined earlier. In Hebrew thought Gevurah is balanced by Chesed (חֶסֶד), or God's loving kindness. Chesed gives and Gevurah contains. If Gevurah is the divine power that counters Mammon, Chesed is divine compassion that topples Jezebel. Together they form the two arms of Christ's yoke, where justice and righteousness meet in an embrace.

righteousness and justice, in loving devotion and compassion. And I will betroth you in faithfulness, and you will know the LORD.”

HOSEA 2:19–20

When loving kindness loses balance with Gevurah (discipline and boundaries), it becomes indulgence,

naïveté, or co-dependence. It can manifest as a chaotic type of mercy that gives without discernment, or seduction disguised as kindness. Healthy love gives from wholeness, whilst unbalanced Chesed gives from a need to be needed. Such an imbalance creates openings for domination or deception. It is counterfeit love that imitates Chesed's warmth but empties it of humility and covenant, replacing it with charm and care that conceal control. Chesed is the divine love that balances and sanctifies power, dissolves fear and anchors the believer in the harmony of the Spirit, transforming strength into service and discipline into mercy.

The third force we are given to counter fear, the Apostle Paul tells us, is a sound mind, which brings the twisting, lying, counterfeiting Leviathan into submission to Christ.

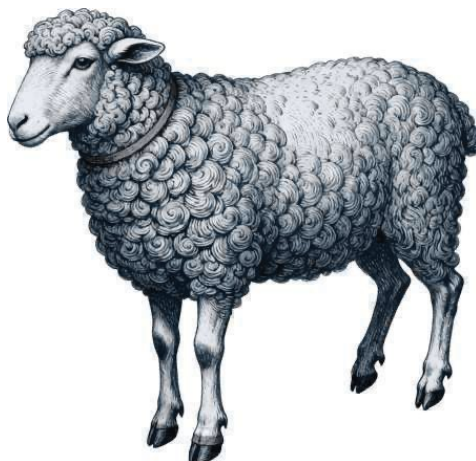
"For though we live in the world, we do not wage war as the world does. The weapons we fight with are not the weapons of the world. On the contrary, they have divine power to demolish strongholds. We demolish arguments and every pretension that sets itself up against the knowledge of God, and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ."

2 CORINTHIANS 10:3-5

These are the philosophies, theories, ideologies and arguments behind which people hide but in truth they are demonic strongholds that hold us captive. They are reminiscent of the narrative around which the Tower of Babel was built. Somehow the people were falsely convinced that by creating this portal they could access God's realm, and from there they could challenge and confront him. Leviathan, the spirit behind the narrative distortion, was whispering, "God is afraid you will become like Him. He is withholding something from you. Ascend! Prove yourself! Build your own way to the heavens!"

Power, love, and sound mind, operate as a triad that overcomes fear. Power gives us the courage to act, love keeps that courage compassionate, and a sound mind integrates both into wisdom and balance. The Spirit of Power and the Spirit of Love are not two spirits but two aspects of the Holy Spirit manifesting Gevurah and Chesed in balance. When these are integrated, we stand in Tiferet, the sound mind or balanced heart. This is precisely the state of spiritual maturity Paul wants for Timothy— not timid restriction, not sentimental excess, but the beautiful harmony through which love empowers strength and strength protects love.

FEAR VS. LOVE, CONFORMITY VS. BELONGING

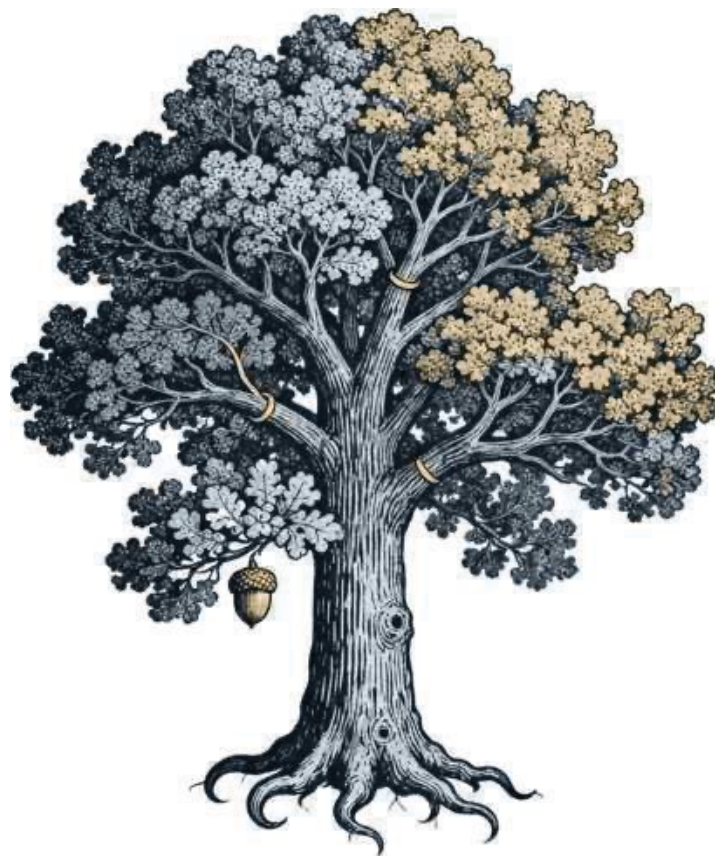


Civilizations under fear, like those ruled by Jezebel and Baal, confuse control for strength. They appear powerful but are driven by terror. You only need to crush what you fear. You only dominate when you're insecure. The same happens in community and church life. In Africa, for instance, the people see deep communalism as a strength; the word Ubuntu is defined as I am because you are. But when it turns toxic, it suppresses individuality. The collective begins to fear difference. People mistake conformity for belonging, and fear for love. Yet true Ubuntu begins with you are, which is the celebration of difference. You are unique, and your uniqueness completes us. That's the body of Christ: "Many members, one body." Christ is the monogene, the uniquely begotten Son, but He has many brothers and sisters, each bearing a unique reflection of His image.

THE CALL TO MATURITY

When Paul says, "God has given you power, love, and a sound mind," he's describing the antidote to the world's threefold fear system. Power overcomes Mammon by rooting your worth in divine abundance, not scarcity. Love overcomes Jezebel by freeing you from control and manipulation. A sound mind overcomes Leviathan by anchoring your perception in truth, not distortion. When you stand in these, you become a powerful individual, not in domination, but in wholeness.

True submission in the Spirit isn't losing your power; it's giving it over to God and one another for mutual strengthening. That's the real economy of Heaven, love without fear, power without control, and clarity without confusion.



“For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.”

Ephesians 6:12

Ponder

1. You were anointed to govern, not merely endure. Where are you still surviving?
2. What sphere have you abdicated as a coheir?
3. Rule from rest. Where is your governing still striving?

Activate • Anointed to rule

I receive the anointing to rule as a son, not a survivor.

What I have endured, I now govern — under Christ, from rest.

This sphere is reclaimed. I occupy it as an heir.

Amen.

Exercise • Name the sphere

Write one domain you have only endured. Write the first act of government (not control) you will occupy there this week.

Chapter 14 • Man of Lawlessness

Lawlessness is occupancy without a rightful king.

A PROGRESSIVE DESCENT



Having traced the operation of rebellious powers at cosmic and structural levels, we now examine how these same forces work subtly within communities and individuals. The Epistle of Jude offers a precise diagnostic. Jude who is widely understood to be the brother of James and a half-brother of Jesus, writes with pastoral urgency. He intended to celebrate the shared joy of salvation, but circumstances demanded confrontation. Something corrosive had entered quietly, and the community was now called to contend earnestly for the faith once delivered to the saints.

The danger was not overt opposition. Certain individuals had slipped in unnoticed, distorting grace into permission for excess and, in doing so, denying the authority of Jesus Christ. What appeared as freedom was rebellion cloaked in spirituality. To awaken his readers, Jude anchors his warning in sacred history. Israel was delivered from Egypt yet judged later for unbelief. Salvation did not exempt them from obedience.

Likewise, angels who abandoned their appointed domain were not spared but are now held in darkness, awaiting final judgment. Even Sodom and Gomorrah stand as enduring signs of what happens when created boundaries are transgressed.

Jude's pattern is a deliberate demonstration that privilege heightens responsibility and rebellion, whether human or angelic, invites consequence. Jude's reference to imprisoned angels clarifies that not all rebellious powers are restrained in the same way or at the same time. Evil's persistence reveals a layered fall, unfolding progressively across relational, moral, and cosmic dimensions.

DEATH SEED

This layered descent is first traced in Genesis 3 to 6, where rebellion moves from choice to pattern, from atmosphere to systemic corruption. Genesis 3 begins the tearing of the fabric of communion. Humanity, created as royal, priestly stewards, chooses autonomy by eating from the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil. Here, lawlessness enters creation in seed form. What Paul later calls "the mystery of lawlessness" in 2 Thessalonians 2:7.

Genesis 4 shows this seed embodied. Cain refuses correction, rejects relational accountability, and murders his brother. John exposes the pattern in plain terms when he says "Cain... was of the evil one and murdered his brother." Lawlessness had moved from inward autonomy to outward violence. What was personal became generational. Rebellion now had a lineage.

Genesis 5 marks normalization. The repeated refrain, "and he died" signals that sin had matured into an atmosphere. Death now reigned. Humanity multiplied, but under a dominion it could not escape. Where lawlessness had been an event, it now became an environment. Genesis 6 marked a catastrophic escalation in the collapse of God's created boundaries. Heavenly beings transgressed their appointed domain, and human corruption became total, affecting both flesh and imagination such that "Every inclination of the thoughts of the human heart was only evil continually." Lawlessness was now cosmic. The Flood was punishment as well as containment of this cosmic level transgression of boundaries. God was restraining a creation spiraling toward uncreation.

LINEAGE OF REBELLION

Though God preserved a remnant, rebellion's residue remained. The episode involving Ham and the curse of Canaan, was not about race as many have put forth, but about the lineage of rebellion. By Genesis 11, humanity united again in defiance, resulting in Babel's fragmentation. The nations were handed over to lesser rulers, setting the stage for humanity's first totalitarian spiritual project, where lawlessness became institutionalized. This matured rebellion manifested historically through Pharaoh, the giants of Canaan, and the idolatrous nations surrounding Israel. Lawlessness became entrenched in flesh and empire. In them is represented the motif of Lucifer, the character we studied previously. Isaiah 14 and Ezekiel 28 are not simple biographies of a single being. They use cosmic language to describe a type or a pattern of exalted beings (human or angelic) who refuse alignment with God. Figures such as Jezebel, Nebuchadnezzar, and Xerxes were not anomalies but expressions of the same lawless pattern with spiritual rebellion embodied through political, religious, and cultural power.

As is still the case today, these systems were sustained by spiritual intelligences working through broken humanity, reinforcing accusation, domination, and sacrifice. Running alongside this descent was a faithful counter-narrative. From Moses onward, God preserves not only righteousness but memory. Moses, Joshua, David, Daniel, and Hosea among many others, preserved the promise that these powers would be judged and displaced. They announced that rebellion would not have the final word and that a coming King would dismantle these powers.

LAWLESSNESS AS CHARACTER

By the time we reach the New Testament, lawlessness graduates from activity to a character. Paul describes a people who are “lovers of self, lovers of money, proud, abusive... having a form of godliness but denying its power.” This is not the pathology of one individual but the emergence of a collective personhood. Scripture names it the man of lawlessness, with lawlessness being embodied socially, culturally, and spiritually.

This is why Christ did not come simply to forgive sins. Forgiveness alone would have left the structures of accusation intact. At the cross, Jesus disarmed rulers and authorities, exposing and triumphing over them openly. The curse was absorbed, the Accuser silenced, and death itself dethroned. The resurrection was Christ’s personal victory as well as the undoing of the Genesis 3–11 trajectory through the reversal of autonomy, accusation, and decay.

What Christ inaugurated, the Church is commissioned to administer. Seated with Him in heavenly places, the Church enforces His victory by dismantling strongholds, reclaiming fractured territories, restoring divine order, and proclaiming the reign of the true King. The man of lawlessness is not an isolated villain awaiting destruction at the end of history, it is the matured fruit of Eden’s rebellion, manifest across individuals, empires, and spiritual powers, until Christ decisively breaks its authority and entrusts His people with the work of restoration. We say it because it is the spirit of a system. The story ends where it began with humanity restored to rightful authority under God, not autonomous power apart from Him.

Yet here we encounter a mystery often overlooked in God’s sub- contrario Kingdom. The apocalyptic imagery of Revelation 12 is a cosmic interpretation of the Incarnation itself. John is shown what the birth of Christ accomplished in the unseen realm. The Woman represents God’s covenant people, Israel fulfilled in the Church, clothed with heavenly authority. The Child is unmistakably Christ, destined “to rule all nations with a rod of iron.” And the Dragon is Satan, functioning not only as tempter but as cosmic prosecutor.

THE LAWLESS PROSECUTOR



Before Christ, Satan possessed access to the Divine Council. Job 1–2 makes this explicit when the sons of God present themselves before the Lord, and Satan appears among them. He roamed the earth, then returned to accuse humanity from a transcendent position. The phrase “cast down” does not mean annihilation; it means relocation and restriction. What changed was not his existence, but the domain and mode of his operation. Now, his access to heaven is revoked. “There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.” The Incarnation changed everything. Revelation 12 reveals that the birth of Christ triggered war in the heavens, not because Satan suddenly noticed Jesus, but because Jesus’ arrival terminated Satan’s legal standing. “Now salvation, strength, the kingdom of our God, and the power of His Christ have come,” John heard it proclaimed, “for the accuser of our brethren... has been cast down.” Salvation here is not merely forgiveness; it is expulsion. Authority shifts because access is revoked. The Accuser is no longer permitted to prosecute humanity from heaven. What remains is influence, not judicial authority. Unable to prosecute in the courts of heaven, he redirects accusation into the human interior—targeting the mind, emotions, perception, and relationships.

Paul describes this subtle mode of operation as “the prince of the power of the air.” In the ancient imagination, “air” was the invisible medium of influence: breath, sound, vibration, and transmission. Today, a helpful analogy would be radio frequency which is invisible, intangible and yet capable of shaping thought, mood, and coordination. Satan’s authority is no longer enforced by edict but transmitted by frequency. Accusations now function as frequency, not verdict. Prior to Christ, accusation was a binding legal sentence issued from heaven. After Christ’s incarnation, crucifixion, and resurrection, accusation became a signal that is effective only if received and agreed with. This is why Scripture emphasizes renewing the mind and taking every thought captive. These are metaphors for managing the frequencies that shape human perception.

LOGOS NOT NEURONS

Though unseen, this realm of influence is devastating because humans are meaning-making beings. Our perceptions shape beliefs, and beliefs govern behavior. If Satan can distort how we hear God, interpret one another, and narrate reality, he can still wreak havoc without overt control. Creation groans not because Satan owns it, but because human stewards are mistuned. This is why faith comes by hearing and why redemption begins in the auditory realm.

From a biological perspective, the human mind operates through coordinated neuronal firing and brain rhythms: neurons that wire together, fire together. The mind interprets reality through narratives shaped by experience, creating reward and threat circuits. It is not passive; it actively receives, interprets, and amplifies signals. If frequency represents patterns of influence, the mind internalizes what it repeatedly attends to. Transformation is perception retuned, not exorcism by force.

Jesus defines Satan’s primary activity clearly: “He was a murderer from the beginning and does not stand in the truth... for he is a liar and the father of lies.” Satan is not a creator, ruler, or rightful authority; he traffics in lies, half-truths, accusations, and distorted narratives. Paul reinforces this when he says that “We are not ignorant of his schemes.” The Greek *noēma* (schemes) refers to thoughts, perceptions, and mental frameworks showing that Satan’s domain is interpretive space, not substance. His power is cognitive, hijacking meaning and perception. Being the “prince of the power of the air” signifies his influence over ideological atmospheres, not meteorology.

Christ entered the world as the Logos, the Word who is the ordering principle of reality. His ministry targeted perception, “You have heard it said... but I say to you,” interpretation, “Why do you reason in your hearts?” and narrative “The kingdom of God is at hand.” In doing so, He restored truth to thought, peace to cognition, and authority to conscience. Transformation is less about creating new neurons than reorienting existing ones. Biblical warfare is consistently about exposing lies, silencing accusation, and enthroning truth. Instead of overpowering the mind, Christ reorders it.



THE DESTROYER

Was God outsmarted when Satan rebelled? Scripture assures us that God is never surprised, cornered, or reactive because, “Known to God from eternity are all His works.” Isaiah 54:16 affirms this: “Behold, I have created the smith who blows the fire of coals and produces a weapon for its purpose; I have also created the destroyer to ruin.” God ordains agents of destruction as part of His design; destruction is instrumental, not autonomous; therefore, rebellion is a misuse of that function. Satan was assigned authority, but he violated his jurisdiction. He was never designed to destroy the sons of God, and his role was not the problem, rather his transgression beyond it. Scripture consistently frames authority as bounded, judgment as assigned, and transgression as the crossing of rank or boundary.

When God permitted a lying spirit in 1 Kings 22 to influence the false prophets, its operation was judicial. Its offer of service was not an arbitrary seizing of opportunity; it was meant to affect those already aligned with falsehood. God does not deceive the righteous; He “gives them over” to the consequences of their own alignment. As 2 Timothy 2:20 explains, “In a great house there are not only vessels of gold and silver, but also of wood and clay, some for honor and some for dishonor.” God does not create evil hearts; He assigns roles within redemptive history, even using hardened individuals as instruments. Paul affirms this in Romans 9:21: “Does not the potter have power over the clay...?” Scripture provides multiple examples: Pharaoh’s stubbornness trained Moses to reveal Yahweh’s supremacy; David’s encounter with Goliath catalyzed his

kingship; Nebuchadnezzar disciplined Israel yet was ultimately judged; Jezebel's tyranny exposed prophetic authority and true kingship. These figures were not righteous, but they were situated by God within His plan.

Revelation 12 underscores this principle. When Satan was cast down, by God's wise intention he was relocated and restricted, not destroyed. He had been created as an instrument of justice, but instead he sought identity, worship, and sovereignty, and his rebellion thereby transformed his divine purpose. Instead of dismantling wickedness, Satan targeted the righteous, accused God's children, and built kingdoms. However, Jesus did not immediately eliminate the destroyers; he preserved them for purpose while He reclaimed authority. "Now is the judgment of this world; now the ruler of this world will be cast out." Judgment strips authority, but time remains for testimony, separation, and final reckoning, nothing escapes God's plan.

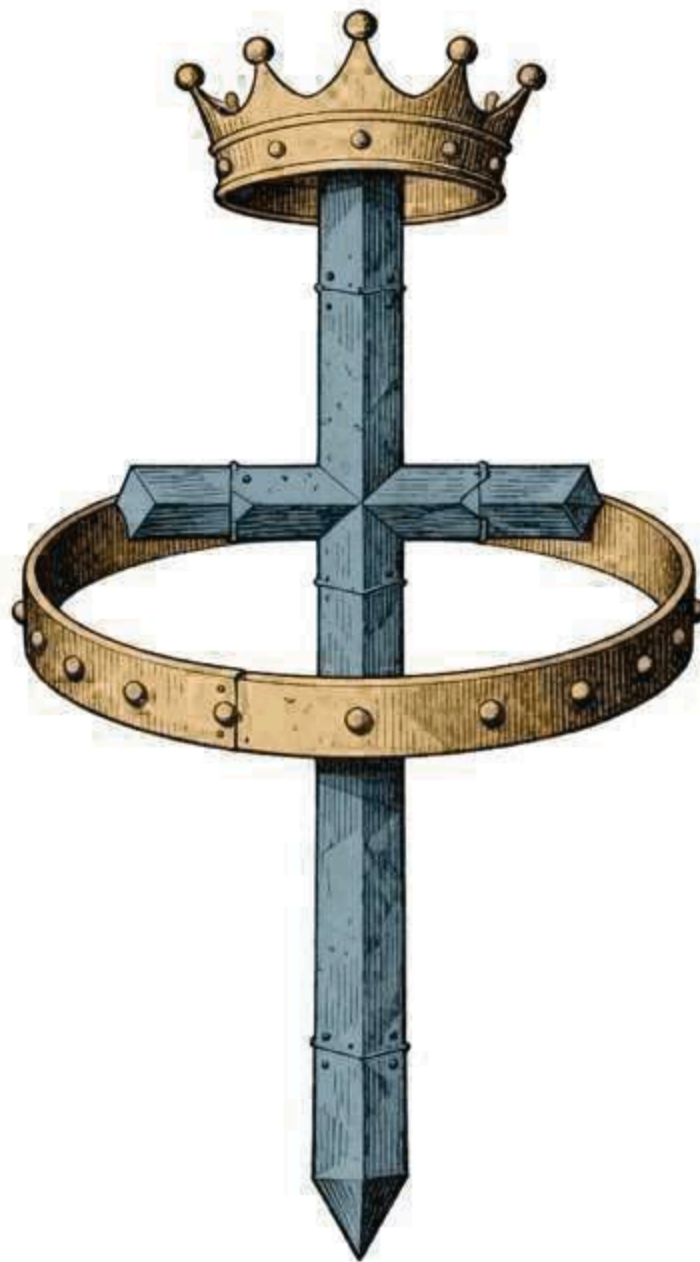
THE MATRIX HIJACKED

Genesis 6:1–2 notes, "The sons of God saw the daughters of men that they were beautiful; and they took wives for themselves of all whom they chose." The Hebrew *laqach* () לקח implies seizure, not covenantal consent, which echoes royal conquest formulas elsewhere in Scripture. Similarly, 1 Samuel 8:11–17 warns Israel that a human king will take sons, daughters, fields, and servants, and demonstrates that usurped authority results in exploitation when divine order is rejected. The Hebrew verb *laqach* () לקח consistently signals extractive authority by taking without sanction, whether women as trophies of war, land unjustly seized, power appropriated, or identity stolen through deception or force. In Genesis 6, this verb reveals more than sexual sin: it exposes systemic trafficking of creation's future. Bodies, inheritance, authority, and narrative are treated as commodities, and the failure of paternal guardianship turns marriage into a transactional technology rather than a covenantal institution. This is ontological corruption where women, as bearers of life and lineage, become interfaces for alien order, introducing lawlessness and hybridized culture into humanity. Fathers' abdication marks the first great surrender of human kingship, forfeiting stewardship over lineage and destiny.

Lot's offer of his daughters exemplifies this collapse of authority. In Genesis 19:8, he pleads, "See now, I have two daughters... please let me bring them out to you." This was not hospitality; it was negotiation with chaos. Passive righteousness without enforcement of kingship allows power to operate through commodified bodies. Other examples abound: Dinah's violation in Genesis 34 escalated into political negotiation, with Jacob's passivity allowing chaos to intensify. Solomon's foreign wives functioned as diplomatic instruments, importing gods, rituals, and worldviews that fractured Israel and weakened the worship of Yahweh. Here, trafficking operates on a cosmic scale, with bodies carrying belief systems into governance.

Judges 19 recounts the Levite's concubine, sacrificed to preserve male honor in a leaderless nation because "There was no king in Israel." Where kingship fails, women pay the price and national order collapses. Ahab and Jezebel epitomize the matured form of trafficking. Ahab's sin was not merely idolatry but abdication: "There was no one like Ahab, who sold himself to do wickedness... because Jezebel his wife stirred him up." Jezebel became the operator; Ahab, the permit; and Naboth's vineyard the inheritance. Justice, and life itself (the blood) was commodified and traded for power. This illustrates the full trajectory of *laqach* with bodies, land, law, and lineage exploited to subvert divine order.

RECLAIMING THE MATRIX



All the women mentioned, including Jezebel, reflect the maturation of Eve, who represents the matrix of humanity. In its deepest sense, a matrix is like an organizing field or womb— an underlying structure that holds, shapes, and transmits reality. As the first woman, Eve was the womb of all nations. The serpent’s strategy was not merely sexual in spiritually hijacking the matrix, he wanted jurisdiction over the future of humanity. He trafficked a word into the matrix, “Did God really say...?” using a lie to incarnate himself into humanity’s future through deception rather than force. Christ’s redemptive work did not negotiate with corrupted systems. He reclaimed authority at the root: “You were not redeemed with corruptible things... but with the precious blood of Christ.” Like Jesus, the Church acts as a living matrix, birthing kings whose mandate is redemption, not domination. Its task is to end the sale of futures, restore covenantal covering, and

protect what gives life.

Paul frames this in Ephesians 5: “Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church and gave Himself for her, that He might sanctify and cleanse her... that she should be holy and without blemish.”

Christ sanctifies the Bride and does not exploit her. What is reclaimed is not Eve as a person, but what she represents: human vocation, creative authority, and generational destiny. The Gospel reverses trafficking as bodies are honored, truth is given freely, and authority is restored through love and sacrifice. This is why Revelation concludes with a Bride, not a marketplace.

Throughout Scripture, whenever women are trafficked, silenced, or instrumentalized, it is not only a moral failure but a structural one. Christ entered history through a woman, not as symbolism but as strategy. The Incarnation reclaimed the womb as holy ground. The Word did not bypass the matrix, but He inhabited it, sanctified it, and realigned it from within. The womb is the deepest interface of all that is why Scripture treats the womb as sacred territory and why it is constantly contested. This is also why the Church is framed as a bride and a mother. She is entrusted with holding the Word, transmitting truth, and gestating the Kingdom in time. Where the matrix is aligned with the Logos, what is born is life. Where it is distorted, what emerges is death. The battle is not first over behavior, but over the field in which behavior is formed.

“He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together.”

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. Lawlessness is occupancy without a rightful king. Where have you preferred no king to His king?
2. What sits in you that will not submit to Order?
3. Where has “freedom” meant refusal of rank?

Activate • Under a King

I refuse lawlessness. I refuse a throne with no King.

Jesus Christ, You are the law. I submit this occupancy to Order.

What will not bow is cast down. What will bow is reassigned.

Amen.

Exercise • The lawless occupancy

Name the place in you that answers to no one. Write the submission — specific, dated, spoken.

Chapter 15 • Exiting the Matrix

Leave the false interface. Occupy the real.

THE INTERFACE



As we approach the end of Part One: Understanding the Battlefield, and before we move on to the activation part of this journey, let's take a moment to revisit the concept of the interface we first encountered with Jezebel and her kohl technology. The interface is the point where God perceives the hearts of men as they relate to one another and to beings beyond the visible realm. In the beginning, humanity could interact with spiritual beings directly, through touch, sight, and feeling. Today, spiritual experiences are largely internal, symbolic, or mediated.

Before Jesus' earthly ministry, there was no structured deliverance ministry. Throughout the Old Testament, demons could enter and leave humans at will. Take the examples illustrated in Job 1:6–7 and 1 Kings 22:19–23, which describe spirits moving between the spiritual and earthly realms freely. But Revelation 12 reveals a pivotal shift: when Christ entered the earth, the cosmic battle intensified. John's vision of the Woman, the Dragon, and the Child depicts the broader spiritual struggle behind humanity's history.

The Woman in Revelation 12, represents God's covenant people, both Israel and the faithful Church, carrying the promise of the Messiah. The Dragon is Satan, who operates through empires, rulers, and worldly powers, seeking to destroy the Messiah and oppose God's plan. His tail sweeps up a third of the stars, reflecting the fallen angels who joined his rebellion. The Child is Christ, destined to rule all nations. Instead of being devoured, He is caught up to God's throne, signifying resurrection, ascension, and Satan's failure to take possession of the earth as his temple.

After Jesus' birth, Satan and the fallen angels were expelled from Heaven and bound to the earth. Jesus'

ministry— which included exorcisms— demonstrated this new reality; demonic entities could no longer move freely between Heaven and earth, and humanity became the battleground for spiritual influence. The Parable of the Sower illustrates this tension in that the good seed (God’s kingdom) and the bad seed (the enemy’s influence) grow together, but ultimate judgment will separate them. Paul instructs believers to “take every thought captive,” not just the bad, but also the good, to avoid falling into the cycles of polarity and deception born from indulging in the fruit from the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil.

The flesh realm of human experience is the interface between the spiritual and the physical. This is the matrix. Here, our perceptions (what we see, hear, or feel) are processed in the mind as electrical and chemical signals. This is the neuroscience of the spiritual realm we discussed. In the hidden architecture of reality, what we perceive is never the truth itself, but a carefully designed interface that lets us function. Donald Hoffman reminds us that our senses, like a console, or the icons on a computer desktop, translate the vast complexity of existence into symbols we can act upon. We never see the circuitry beneath the icons, we only see what is useful. This is why Scripture calls the devil “the spirit of the power of the air.” He influences the unseen space between minds, where thoughts, cycles, and patterns govern life. Behind the icons of everyday life (people, circumstances, emotions), there is code running in the background, in an unseen network of reality.

BEYOND THE MATRIX



Through Christ, humanity is born again beyond this matrix to exercise authority over it. As sons of God, we are called to learn patterns from Christ’s mind rather than the fallen systems of the flesh, much like the sons of Issachar who understood the times and seasons and knew what to do about them. When Satan was cast down, believers were taken up into authority over the cycles of the flesh. Creation— including animals, nature, and even angels— responds to awakened humanity. Before Christ, humans were largely subconscious, acting within programmed cycles, but Jesus brings wakefulness, enabling believers to take conscious authority over creation and spiritual patterns.

CONSCIOUS AND AWAKE

“My Spirit shall not strive with man forever, for he is indeed flesh; yet his days shall be one hundred and twenty years.”

GENESIS 6:3

In this scripture God highlights the consequences of interacting with the demonic. Humanity had become spiritually dull, grounded in unconscious patterns, because they were interacting with the program, and life became limited to 120 years. Immortality is connected to “wakefulness,” which is the ability to perceive beyond programmed cycles. Sensitizing our hearts through God’s Word awakens us to this reality. Hebrews 4:12 describes this as the “circumcision of the heart,” where the living Word penetrates and discerns the thoughts and intentions, continually rebirthing believers into Christ’s fullness. The necessity of this spiritual awakening is clear in Genesis 6:5: “The wickedness of man was great in the earth, and every intent of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually.” This is the pathology of the hard heart, and Jeremiah 17:9–10 underscores its deceitful nature: “The heart is deceitful above all things, and desperately wicked; who can know it? I, the Lord, search the heart and test the mind, even to give every man according to his ways, according to the fruit of his doings.”



Through understanding the interface, we grasp how Christ restores humanity’s access to the spiritual, teaches us to discern cycles and patterns, and equips us to exercise authority over the flesh and the unseen realm, transforming both our lives and the world around us.

CAPTIVITY CAPTIVE

“From within, out of the hearts of men, proceed evil thoughts, adulteries, fornications, murders, thefts, covetousness, wickedness, deceit, lewdness, an evil eye, blasphemy, pride, foolishness. All these evil things come from within and defile a man.”

MARK 7:21–23

Matthew 15:19 echoes the same truth that the heart is the source of both our actions and our defilement. Ecclesiastes 9:3 adds, “Truly the hearts of the sons of men are full of evil; madness is in their hearts while they live, and after that they go to the dead.” But why is this so? Romans 8:7–8 explains: “The carnal mind is enmity against God; it is not subject to the law of God, nor indeed can be. Those who are in the flesh cannot please God.”



But Scripture also offers hope. Romans 8:3–5 shows the way forward: “What the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God did by sending His own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, on account of sin: He condemned sin in the flesh, so that the righteous requirement of the law might be fulfilled in us, who do not walk according to the flesh but according to the Spirit. For those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh, but those who live according to the Spirit, the things of the Spirit.”

How do we practically live this out? By taking every thought captive and presenting it to God. We do not entertain thoughts, whether seemingly good or bad, in isolation. Every thought is to be brought under obedience to Christ, crucified at the Cross and purified by fire and light through the Spirit. The Cross is the Tree of Life, not the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil. The result is the life described in Jeremiah 17:7–8: “Blessed is the man who trusts in the Lord, and whose hope is the Lord. For he shall be like a tree planted by the waters, which spreads out its roots by the river, and will not fear when heat comes; its leaf will be green, and it will not be anxious in the year of drought, nor will it cease from yielding fruit.”

Faith and obedience root us in the Spirit, transforming our hearts and minds so that we no longer live according to the flesh but flourish in God’s eternal provision.



TRAP THAT JACKAL



You don't escape the matrix by fighting it, you escape it by becoming aware of it. This is the logic of the sub-contrario Kingdom. The "matrix" is simply the interface of the flesh and the natural world. We don't take pride in seeing it; we don't make an identity out of it. We recognize it for what it is: a temporary operating system. The moment we stop mistaking it for ultimate reality, we step into the realm of the Spirit. And that's where the Word begins to cut, divide, expose, and transform everything.

"The Word of God is living and powerful... sharper than any two-edged sword... dividing soul and spirit... discerning the thoughts and intents of the heart. Nothing is hidden from His sight; everything is naked before Him."

HEBREWS 4:11-13

The Word dismantles the interface. It reveals what is flesh, what is spirit, what is fear, what is truth, what is pride, and what is freedom. Before Jesus came, the enemy could move freely, "going to and fro," operating above and beyond human agency. Humanity had no authority to restrain or confront him. But Christ's incarnation, death, and resurrection trapped the enemy in the flesh-realm, confining him to the same arena where you now carry the Spirit of God.

It's like catching the jackal that keeps eating your chickens: you trap it inside the coop, where it can no longer hide in the darkness or strike from the outside. Only then can you deal with it. That's what Jesus did. The enemy was brought down and you were raised up. You now have agency. You now have authority. You now stand in Christ, above the powers that once threatened you from beyond your reach. Much like we saw Jesus do when he cast the legion of demons from the man of the Gerasenes into the herd of pigs.

ILLUMINE TO CONSUME

Every problem you face is not a sign of impending defeat, rather it's something that has been handed to you because you now have the ability to take it, lay it on the altar, and watch the fire of God consume it. You bring it to the altar of the Cross, not just to the light of the Word, but to the God who is a Consuming Fire. When you offer it up at the altar of the Cross, the light of God's word exposes it for what it is, and the fire of God consumes it. The smoke that rises from the burnt sacrifices, rises to God as incense. It is a pleasing offering through which His power is made perfect in our weakness, and in return He gives you not just understanding, but transformation. In Christ, you don't escape reality. You rule over it. You bring everything through the Cross—the true Tree of Life—and whatever passes through its fire emerges purified, healed, and brought back into divine order. Scripture tells us that a flaming sword stands at the entrance to Eden, not as a wall to keep humanity out, but as the refining presence that guides us back in. This living, active Word cuts through illusion and pretense, distinguishing flesh from spirit, exposing the heart's motives, and consuming everything that cannot belong in God's restored garden.

words that I speak to you are spirit, and they are life."

JOHN 6:63

Without the Word, the inner man slowly drifts back into old cycles and patterns we were meant to rise above, our heart becomes lethargic and our spirit is dulled. But here is the hope: the weakest, darkest places in your

life can become a sacrifice to God. When you take what is hidden, shameful, and heavy and bring it into the light of His Word, your heart becomes sensitive again; it becomes good soil, capable of receiving truth and bearing fruit.

“There is no creature hidden from His sight, but all things are naked and open to the eyes of Him to whom we must give account.”

HEBREWS 4:13

Only Jesus can take your wickedness and brokenness and present them as a sacrifice that God consumes with His fire until it no longer holds power. So come to the Word, hear Him, receive Him, and let faith rise inside you until you are no longer trapped in the lower realms of the flesh, but lifted into the life of the Spirit.

“My Spirit shall not strive with man forever, for he is indeed flesh; yet his days shall be one hundred and twenty years.”

Genesis 6:3

Ponder

1. What false interface do you still live inside — a story, a system, a feed, a fear?
2. Exiting is not cynicism. It is occupancy of the real. What is the real, here?
3. What would it cost you to leave the false frame this week?

Activate • Exit

I leave the false interface. I occupy what is real in Christ.

I refuse the matrix of accusation, spectacle, and counterfeit order.

Lead me out. Keep me out. I will not return as a tourist.

Amen.

Exercise • One concrete exit

Write the false frame. Write the one concrete exit (a practice, a boundary, a confession) you will occupy before the next chamber.

Close • Deus Revelatus

The Revealed God. What was hidden is shown.

Every act of deliverance is far more than the release of a single life from bondage; it is a defining moment in the history of redemption as God reclaims His world and the kingdom of darkness loses its grip. The fragrance of Eden runs through every reconciliation and Scripture reveals that no wound, no lineage, and no power is outside of its reach.

The story of Rahab is one of the first threads in this tapestry: a scarlet cord hanging from a window in a doomed city, marking not only her survival but her inclusion in the lineage that will one day reopen Eden. Her life demonstrates how God begins restoration in overlooked places— just as creation itself began in a hidden garden before it was revealed. Rahab’s home was a threshold, her red cord a prophetic banner announcing the coming deliverance that would redeem nations and generations.

Isaiah 54 expands the vision, painting a cosmic portrait of a barren, shamed, forsaken woman— Israel, the Church, the earth itself — now reclaimed, adorned, and enlarged. Her healing signals that creation is being pulled back into Eden’s order. Promises are spoken gently over old wounds, as though God Himself is kneeling beside the places where humanity first hid from His presence.

But Isaiah only opens the doorway. Revelation 12 unveils the deeper conflict: a woman in labor overshadowed by the ancient dragon, the serpent whose deception exiled creation from Eden. She bears the Child promised from the beginning— the One destined to crush the serpent’s head. The dragon rages for he knows what Rahab foresaw, what Isaiah proclaimed, and what the demons of the Gerasenes recognized: his defeat is certain for the Deliverer has arrived. The Child is caught up, the woman is protected, the dragon is cast down, and heaven declares that the kingdom and power of Christ have come.

Jesus steps into this story gently but decisively. Walking Adam’s path and entering humanity’s dust, He brings deliverance to bodies, systems, spirits, and economies, fulfilling every whispered promise of Scripture. He deploys the destroyer to destroy what hides in the darkness. His miracles reveal bondage, His exorcisms overturn it, and His teachings pierce the illusions that made bondage seem acceptable.

He is the Child the dragon could not devour, the promised Seed preserved, the Bridegroom who gathers the forsaken, the restorer of Eden’s communion, the King whose authority settles over troubled waters like a peace creation instinctively remembers. In Him, every thread converges: Rahab’s scarlet hope, Isaiah’s widened tent, the woman clothed with the sun, and humanity’s ancient ache for the garden. Such is the inheritance of the servants of the Lord— deliverance that reshapes everything, slowly and thoroughly, until Eden’s peace feels natural again and the reign of Jesus Christ becomes home.

This is deliverance on a cosmic scale, the story that stretches from the garden to the consummation of all things, the restoration He has set in motion and will finish in glory. It is the vindication He gives to all who perceive what has been hidden, the mission He has always carried, and the work that will complete His reign.

“He is before all things, and in Him all things are held together.”

Colossians 1:17–18

Ponder

1. What El Mistater hid, Deus Revelatus shows. What is being revealed in you now?
2. Revelation is not information. What must become occupancy before you walk into Authority?
3. Are you ready to be seen — by Him, and in community?

Activate • The Revealed God

Father, You are Deus Revelatus. What was hidden is shown.

I receive the unveiling. I will not hide what You have lit.

I walk from concealment into the Light — covered, not exposed for shame.

Amen.

Exercise • The unveiling

Write what has been revealed in Part One. One sentence of thanks. One act of obedience that proves you saw it. Then go to Authority — do not skip.

Strongholds and Legal Rights Assessment

This is a prayerful tool to uncover open doors, hidden influences, and inherited patterns that limit spiritual freedom. It is not necessary to use it every time you go through the 7 Steps to Taking Back Authority, but it is an excellent resource to have as part of your tool kit for checking in with the Holy Spirit on a regular basis.

It begins with a questionnaire to discover potential entry points for a curse to have gained access and then moves to a checklist that highlights attitudes and actions that can have given a stronghold the legal right to have an influence in your life.

Find a peaceful environment where you can spend 30–45 minutes undisturbed; have your Bible, a pen, and this page. Invite the Holy Spirit to bring clarity, not condemnation. Read each question slowly. Write truthfully. This is a sacred conversation between you and God.

The goal is revelation, not guilt. What the Spirit reveals is not to shame you, but to set you free. Once identified, these areas can be surrendered and brought into alignment with Christ's authority. If at any point you begin to feel overwhelmed, pause. Take a breath. Then reach out to a trusted spiritual leader. You were never meant to journey alone.

Prayer before beginning

Holy Spirit, I invite You to search my heart and shine Your light into every hidden place.

As I read through each area, please show me the doorways that were opened to allow a demonic stronghold in my life.

Let Your light expose every entry point and restore my authority in Christ. Amen.

Entry points

01 • Ancestry

Exodus 20:5 — You shall not bow down to them or serve them, for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children...

1. ☐ Have you noticed repeating family patterns of anger, addiction, divorce, poverty, or illness?
2. ☐ Were there ancestral vows, rituals, or traditions that may have invited spiritual influence?
3. ☐ Do you ever feel bound by something that “runs in the family”?

02 • Lying and Deception

Ephesians 4:25 — Therefore, each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to your neighbor, for we are all members of one body.

1. ☐ Have you struggled with exaggeration, half-truths, or using words to manipulate outcomes?
2. ☐ Do you hide the truth to protect your reputation or avoid conflict?

3. ☐ Has dishonesty ever become a habit or a defense mechanism?

03 • Unconfessed Unforgiveness

Luke 6:37 — Forgive, and you will be forgiven.

1. ☐ Is there anyone (alive or deceased) whom you still hold resentment toward?
2. ☐ Have you justified your bitterness by believing they “don’t deserve” forgiveness?
3. ☐ Do certain memories still trigger pain, anger, or avoidance?

04 • Anger, Bitterness, and Hatred

Ephesians 4:26–27 — Do not let the sun go down while you are still angry, and do not give the devil a foothold.

1. ☐ Do you experience recurring irritation, rage, or inner hostility?
2. ☐ Have you ever secretly wished harm or failure upon someone who hurt you?
3. ☐ Do grudges feel easier to hold than to release?

05 • Rejection or Victimization

Psalms 118:22 — The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone.

1. ☐ Do you often feel unseen, unwanted, or misunderstood?
2. ☐ Have you used pain or rejection as justification for control, withdrawal, or resentment?
3. ☐ Does your sense of purpose depend on proving your worth to others?

06 • Trauma

Psalms 147:3 — He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

1. ☐ Have you experienced betrayal, fear, accidents, or medical trauma that left deep emotional residue?
2. ☐ Do certain sights, sounds, or situations trigger anxiety or panic?
3. ☐ Have you had persistent nightmares related to past pain?

07 • Childhood Abuse

Psalms 27:10 — Even if my father and mother abandon me, the LORD will hold me close.

1. ☐ Were you ever abused sexually, verbally, physically, or emotionally as a child?
2. ☐ Did humiliation, neglect, or bullying shape how you see yourself today?
3. ☐ Have you made inner vows like “I’ll never trust anyone again”?

08 • Sexual Impurity

1 Corinthians 6:18–20 — Flee from sexual immorality... You are not your own; you were bought at a price.

1. ☐ Have you engaged in or been harmed by sexual sin—pornography, fornication, adultery, or perversion?
2. ☐ Are there lingering soul ties or feelings of shame associated with past encounters?
3. ☐ Do you use sexual behavior to cope with loneliness or pain?

09 • Dishonoring the Body-Temple

1 Corinthians 6:19 — Do you not know that your bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit?

1. ☐ Have you used food, substances, or pleasure to escape emotional pain?
2. ☐ Do you struggle with addiction, self-harm, or chronic neglect of health?
3. ☐ Has your body become a battleground instead of a vessel of honor?

10 • Occult / Secret Organizations

Ephesians 5:11 — Have nothing to do with the fruitless deeds of darkness but rather expose them.

1. ☐ Have you participated in astrology, spells, psychic readings, or rituals?
2. ☐ Have you ever taken an oath, pledge, or membership in a secret society?
3. ☐ Do you own objects linked to occult or ancestral worship?

11 • Doubt, Unbelief, and Pride

Proverbs 3:5 — Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding.

1. ☐ Do you resist trusting God or insist on controlling outcomes yourself?
2. ☐ Do you struggle to admit weakness or receive correction?
3. ☐ Has pride kept you from asking for help or repenting quickly?

12 • Blasphemy

Exodus 20:7 — Do not misuse the name of the Lord your God.

1. ☐ Have you ever spoken irreverently about God, His people, or holy things?
2. ☐ Do you treat spiritual realities with sarcasm or contempt?
3. ☐ Has cynicism replaced reverence in your heart?

13 • Wearable or Hangable Objects / Charms

Ezekiel 14:6 — Rid yourselves of all the idols you have set up.

1. ☐ Do you own jewelry, symbols, or charms with occult or pagan origins?
2. ☐ Were any personal items gifted through rituals, shrines, or questionable spiritual practices?
3. ☐ Do you feel unease or attachment to objects you cannot part with?

Prayer

Holy Spirit, reveal any entry point I have overlooked that has given access to a stronghold in my life.

Show me the doorways that were opened and give me grace to close them.

Let Your light expose every root and restore my authority in Christ. Amen.

Legal rights checklist

- ☐ Vacating a God-given position, leaving your assignment unguarded.
- ☐ Lack of accountability, refusing oversight or counsel.
- ☐ Covering mistakes instead of taking responsibility.
- ☐ Exposing others' faults for shame or advantage.
- ☐ Unreasonable expectations disguised as faith.
- ☐ Selfish ambition masked as God's promise.
- ☐ Unconfessed jealousy or comparison.
- ☐ Suppressing others' gifts to elevate your own.
- ☐ Manipulation through finances or provision.
- ☐ Manipulation through sickness or victimhood.
- ☐ Entitlement rooted in lack or insecurity.
- ☐ Hidden rage, offense, or spite.
- ☐ Envy of another's success while appearing supportive.
- ☐ People-pleasing or fear of man.
- ☐ Blame-shifting and avoiding ownership.
- ☐ Gossip or slander against others.
- ☐ Rigid opinions without self-reflection.
- ☐ Advocacy driven by bitterness.
- ☐ Dishonour toward authority or seniority.
- ☐ Disregard for others' expertise or domain.
- ☐ Minimizing others' effort or sacrifice.
- ☐ Expecting loyalty without agreement.
- ☐ Authoritarian control or silencing diversity.
- ☐ Hidden suspicion and paranoia.
- ☐ Chronic criticism or negativity.
- ☐ Prying or over-questioning without discernment.
- ☐ Lack of honor or graciousness.
- ☐ Double standards or partiality.
- ☐ Serving from obligation rather than Spirit leading.
- ☐ Using spiritual gifts for self-validation.

Closing prayer

Holy Spirit, reveal any other ways in which I have given legal rights to a stronghold in my life.

Show me the agreements that I have made with darkness—in thought, or word, or deed—and let Your light

expose each one so that my authority in Christ may be restored. Amen.

Part Two • Taking Back Authority

Welcome to the activation of your journey to divine realignment. In this section, you will be guided step-by-step through the practical process of Taking Back Authority—the restoration of divine order and the conscious act of bringing your inner world and outer influence back under Heaven’s rule.

Each of the seven steps that follow is built upon spiritual revelation that restores your position, your peace, and your power in Christ. These steps are pathways of transformation that awaken the inner life of the Spirit within you and bring you under the authority and order of Heaven.

“I love how the process exposes areas I was unaware that I had abdicated. Subtle places that I had just accepted as that’s how life is.”

KELLY— OREGON, USA As you walk through this process, remember that the journey into spiritual authority is anchored in four spiritual principles:

The Spirit awakens your inner awareness to discern what governs your heart, emotions, and decisions. When your conscience is trained by truth, deception loses its influence.

Transformation begins in the conscience, which is the sacred meeting place where revelation exposes what once ruled unseen, and divine light restores clarity.

Freedom flourishes within structure. Authority is restored through obedience and alignment with divine order. To walk in authority is to know your place in God’s design, to stand where Heaven has positioned you, and to function under the command of Christ.

Every prayer, confession, and decree is a lawful act of governance under the rule of Christ. Through your words, Heaven’s authority is legislated on earth. You are an ambassador of divine law, enforcing righteousness, establishing peace, and extending the government of God into every sphere of life.

Deliverance is the manifestation of light’s dominion. As revelation shines, confusion yields, and disorder submits to divine structure. The Holy Spirit partners with you to illuminate hidden places, replacing fear with faith and falsehood with truth until God’s government takes its rightful seat within you.

Healing starts with love

This work flows out of love and leads back to love. This is the Father's love expressed perfectly in Jesus Christ. As you receive this love in its fullness, it transforms every part of you and empowers you to pour it out to others.

Before engaging with these steps, it is essential that you first settle this truth in your heart: you are loved, chosen, wanted, and you belong. You stand as a beloved son or daughter of God, welcomed, approved, and commissioned to carry His authority and serve His purposes on the earth.

If this truth is still difficult to accept, pause here. Surrender your heart to Him again, the One who already gave Himself for you. The foundation of all healing and authority is the revelation of His love. Without this understanding, the work that follows may feel like striving rather than restoration, what scripture refers to as “dead works.”

This journey is the pursuit of lasting freedom, and it is secured through practicing the principles of the Kingdom of God and preserved through an intimate relationship with Jesus Christ. Anyone can apply these principles and see results, but only those rooted in love and a relationship with Christ will hold on to lasting victory. When your heart knows that it is loved, accusation loses its power. Offense fades, fear diminishes, and your conscience becomes clear.

“And now these three remain: faith, hope, and love. But the greatest of these is love.”

— 1 COR 13:13 We advance from the place of love's assurance, standing firmly in the security of the Father's care. Love surrounds us, empowers us, and preserves every victory.

If, however, you still struggle to rest in that love, seek out guidance from a spiritual leader, someone mature in faith who can walk with you as you strengthen your understanding of who you are in Christ. As you grow, the same grace that sets you free will equip you to lead others into freedom.

Foundation in Scripture

“Search me, O God, and know my heart; test me and know my anxious thoughts. See if there is any offensive way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting.”

— PSALM 139: 23–24 This diagnostic process is a journey of revelation that begins with humility, through which you will invite the Lord to search the deepest places of your heart, and it continues with the courage needed to pull down every thought and pattern that has exalted itself against His truth in your life.

“For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds, casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ.” — 2 CORINTHIANS 10: 4–5 The Holy Spirit lovingly unveils what has been hidden, not to wound, but to heal and restore. Each question opens a door to light, where truth transforms confusion into clarity, and Christ's authority brings every area into divine order.

What to Expect

First, we will explore each of the seven steps in detail, uncovering the principle that underpins it and the scripture that empowers it. Along the way, you'll find real-life examples, prayers, and declarations to help you find language for your own journey.

At the end of the book, you'll find a summary of the seven steps (7 Steps at a Glance) which serves as a concise reference to use as you grow more confident in letting the Holy Spirit lead you. This summary will serve as a quick refresher and a map you can revisit whenever you need to realign.

Finally, at the end of the book, we've also included a checklist (Strongholds and Legal Rights Assessment) to help you identify open doors, dismantle old agreements, and sustain your freedom.

Each of these elements work together to lead you from awareness to authority, from revelation to reformation. At this stage, you might find yourself feeling a little nervous or worried that you might not get it right. We encourage you to walk through this process with patience and trust, remembering that "He who began this good work in you will be faithful to bring it to completion." You are not walking toward freedom alone, the Holy Spirit is both your guide and your guarantee of wholeness.

So take a deep breath, grab your journal, and prepare for take-off!

Step 1 • Identify the Curse

Name the occupancy. Specificity is mercy.

Before you take anything back, you have to see where it left. The same fight in the same kind of relationship. The same hole in the money. The same feeling of being unseen even when it is going well. This step is slow on purpose. You name the occupancy — specifically. Vague is how it hides.



Your journey to freedom begins with awareness. Before you can take back authority, you must first identify where it was lost or surrendered. This step invites you to slow down and recognize the repetitive cycles that have been playing out in your life. These could be emotional reactions, relationship conflicts, financial lack, or recurring disappointments that seem to follow you no matter how hard you try to change.

You might have found yourself asking questions like:

Why do I always end up in the same kind of difficult relationship?

Why do I keep struggling with money?

Why do I feel unseen or unworthy, even when things are going well?

Every frustration points to a deeper story, a place where authority was released and disorder entered. As you listen, the Holy Spirit will gently reveal the first doorway, perhaps a generational pattern, a childhood wound, an unkept vow, or a moment ruled by fear. As you pause, breathe deeply, tune into His presence, and

ask: Holy Spirit, where did this pattern start? Where did I hand over the authority that you intended to be mine?

You may experience a flash memory, a scene from your past, a face, a word, or even a strong emotion. Don't dismiss it. Often, that moment holds the key to understanding when and how the curse first entered in. Note what comes to mind: sensations, people, situations, emotions. The Spirit will bring clarity as you stay in a posture of listening.

It is vital that you write down everything that surfaces, without judgment or self-censorship. What may seem insignificant— a harsh word, a moment of rejection, or an early failure— can become the seed of a stronghold that has quietly shaped your decisions for decades.

"For the longest time, I had carried the feeling that my presence disappointed people. When I asked Jesus to show me the entry point for that belief, He revealed an image of my mother in the moment she discovered she was pregnant with me, and she had whispered "Oh no!" under her breath. I was her sixth child, and our family was poor. That single moment had opened a door in the spirit that allowed rejection to take root."

VIRGINIA— LONDON, UK Remember, you are not uncovering this memory to re-live the pain, but to trace the legal ground the enemy has used to build a fortress in your soul. Once exposed, it begins to lose power, and you gain ground.

If at any point you are struggling to identify the entry point of the curse, don't panic, just turn to the Strongholds and Legal diagnostic tool is designed to help you.

Core Scripture

"Now Joram had returned to Jezreel to recover from the wounds..."

—2 KINGS 9:15

Principle

When authority vacates its seat, curses and control step in.

Practice

Write what the Spirit shows you in "Identify the Curse." One sentence of truth. One act of occupancy.

Step 2 • Reveal the Stronghold

Call the structure by its true name.

Seeing the doorway is not the same as seeing who came through it. A stronghold is a structure with a name — control, fear, accusation, a family pattern that has been running the house. Jehu did not treat Jezebel as a mood. He named the system. You will too.



Once the root of the curse begins to surface, the next step is to name the stronghold that has been built up around it. You are now moving from recognition to revelation, from seeing the doorway to identifying the occupant that entered through it.

In 2 Kings 9, the prophet Jehu confronts Jezebel as not merely a person but a spiritual system. Jezebel represents the stronghold of control, idolatry, manipulation, and counterfeit authority. Her palace had become the headquarters of witchcraft and the center of influence where false power governed a nation.

When Jehu declared, “What peace, as long as the harlotries of your mother Jezebel and her witchcraft are so many?”, he was naming the stronghold and detailing the ways in which that oppressive system had ransacked their lives. He discerned that no true peace could exist while that system still ruled.

In the same way, you must ask: What is the “Jezebel” in my palace?

Is it the spirit of fear that governs your decisions?

Is the spirit of lack limiting your generosity?

Perhaps the spirit of rejection filters every relationship through pain and mistrust?

Or is it the spirit of control that compels you to take matters into your own hands instead of trusting God?

It’s not enough to merely feel the pain or frustration, you must name what rules from behind those emotions. Naming the stronghold brings it into the light and strips it of its secrecy and power.

Let’s return to the examples from Step 1:

The person who continually overperforms at work out of fear of being overlooked may discover that the true stronghold isn’t insecurity, it’s control, birthed from rejection. Jezebel has taken her seat in the palace, and control is what keeps her there.

The individual who grew up in poverty and still fears lack might realize that the stronghold is governed by through self-effort rather than divine provision.

The person who fears intimacy after betrayal may find it is the stronghold of Leviathan, the spirit of twisting, that distorts perception and causes mistrust even where safety exists.

When you name the stronghold, you can judge it rightly. You will not be judging people, places, or your past, you will be issuing judgment against a system that has occupied your spiritual territory.

Take time to write down what has been revealed. Name the stronghold clearly. Don’t generalize, be specific, and describe all the ways in which that stronghold has ransacked your life.

It is important to be specific about the consequences of being under the control of this stronghold, because this is the evidence you will use to judge it in Step 5.

For example, you may write:

The stronghold that has produced a deep fear of rejection in me and caused me to strive to perform and control others is governed by Jezebel.

The stronghold that has produced a persistent sense of lack in my life and caused me to be afraid that there is never enough to the point of meanness, is governed by Mammon.

The stronghold that has produced confusion, suspicion, and mistrust so that I have not been able to enjoy healthy relationships, is governed by Leviathan.

As you do this, please understand that you are not condemning yourself; you are diagnosing the intruder so that judgment can take place, and healing and authority can be restored.

"I realized how much of my authority I had relinquished: areas in my life where I have been a doormat due to control and manipulation, others where I personally have controlled as a mother."

WOWLIFE CHURCH MEMBER— COLOMBO, SRI LANKA Remember, if you are struggling to reveal the stronghold, you can use the Strongholds and Legal Rights Assessment at the back of the book to shine the light on it, and this time you can go straight to the 32 Legal Rights Checklist if you like.

Once a stronghold has been revealed, it must be dealt with verbally and spiritually. In the next step, you will learn how to confess where you came into agreement with the stronghold, receive the forgiveness which Christ died to give you, and begin restoring divine order through repentance and decree.

Core Scripture

"What peace, as long as the harlotries of your mother Jezebel and her witchcraft are so many?"

—2 KINGS 9:22

Principle

It's not enough to identify the curse, you must reveal the stronghold and name it so that you can pronounce God's judgment upon it.

Practice

Write what the Spirit shows you in "Reveal the Stronghold." One sentence of truth. One act of occupancy.

Step 3 • Confess, Forgive, & Repent

Open the mouth. Release the debt. Turn.

Now you open your mouth. Confession says what was hidden. Forgiveness releases the debt you have been carrying (or collecting). Repentance is the turn — not a feeling, a change of road. This is the threshold between knowing about it and actually leaving it.



Here, you stand on the threshold between bondage and freedom. Once you have recognized the curse and named the stronghold, the next step is to release its hold on you through confession, forgiveness and repentance. This requires a drivenness, the same divine zeal that moved Jehu to cleanse Jezreel, that drove Jesus into the wilderness and compelled Him to turn over the tables of corruption in the Temple.

Here you will take action. What was once tolerated and covered by silence and lies must now be confronted with truth. Confession exposes what was hidden. Repentance restores divine order where chaos once ruled.

Jehu's "furious driving" symbolizes the holy urgency needed here and exemplifies the unstoppable force of a soul aligned with divine justice. When Jesus drove out the merchants from the Temple, He was cleansing what belonged to His Father. In the same way, you are cleansing your inner temple, purifying your conscience from the defilement introduced by the whisper of the serpent in the Garden of Eden. The strongholds of Jezebel, Leviathan, and Mammon that once governed through control, slander, and greed can no longer coexist where the truth of Christ now rules.

"This process has helped me so much. I used to hold on to resentment and hurt, but now I have learned how to let go and find peace again. Submitting, confessing and repenting was not easy at first, but it has really changed me on the inside. I now have more peace in my home and in my heart."

NANI— SRI LANKA

CONFESSION AS CLEANSING

To confess is to bring what is hidden into the light, and to say aloud the things you have been hiding: anger, resentment, compromise, guilt, and fear. Do not whisper them internally; speak them out loud. When confession is verbalized, it leaves the private realm of shame and enters the courtroom of truth where God's mercy rules. Confession is the sacred act of opening hidden spaces to the Spirit's renewing breath. As you speak what has been concealed, light enters, healing flows, and the heart becomes free again.

Ask the Holy Spirit:

"Where have I agreed with fear, control, or pride?"

"What decisions have I made that reinforced the stronghold?"

"What unrighteous weapons of warfare have I used against others that have caused the enemy to see me as one with him, such as accusation, lying, and coveting?"

Then, as you receive answers, respond with Spirit-inspired action. Replace secrecy with transparency, resentment with blessing, and avoidance with accountability.

Holy Spirit, I confess that I have allowed the fear of lack to shape my thoughts and decisions. I have agreed with the lie that there is not enough, that I must strive, compete, or control in order to survive. I confess that I have trusted my own strength more than Your provision. I have looked to money, people, and circumstances to meet my needs instead of looking to You, my Source.

FORGIVENESS AS WARFARE

Forgiveness is a legal act of authority within your own soul. It is the moment you entrust every wrong and every hurt to the Father's perfect justice. In doing so, forgiveness is not sentimental it is just. You are aligning yourself with the Government of Heaven, where God alone settles accounts and declares, Vengeance is Mine. In His mercy, He restores balance, repaying all that was lost and releasing you from every burden of offense. Forgiveness is Heaven's declaration of completion: It is finished!

The enemy thrives on accusation. Every unresolved bitterness is a foothold he uses to maintain jurisdiction over your emotions. Forgiveness is how you close that door permanently.

Imagine a woman who has carried bitterness toward a parent who constantly criticized her for years. Every time she is corrected by anyone in the present day, she feels attacked and withdraws. The Holy Spirit then shows her that her current overreaction is not related to the present moment, it's the voice of unforgiveness echoing from her past. She finally forgives her father out loud like this:

Father God, I now see how my dad's constant criticism made me feel like I was never good enough growing up. This has caused me to be overly defensive, and I find it hard to take correction well. But today, I choose to forgive my dad, and I now release him to you, God.

At last, something shifts; the weight lifts, and peace enters. The spirit of control that once ruled her emotions no longer has legal ground.

Forgiveness doesn't minimize pain; it transfers jurisdiction. You take the enemy's accusation and hand it to God, who judges with righteousness.

Father, I forgive [name the person] for [detail the specific act] which [describe the consequences of this in your life]. I now release every accusation and resentment I have carried towards them. I revoke the enemy's right to use this pain against me anymore. I receive Your peace in its place. Amen.

Forgiveness is the final blow that collapses the stronghold's foundation. Without it, the walls may fall, but the roots remain. Through forgiveness, every false authority is stripped of power.

REPENTANCE AS REALIGNMENT

After confession and forgiveness, repentance reinstates your spiritual position. It is the realignment of your life under Heaven's government, the declaration that you now stand in your rightful authority. Through repentance, you take your place beside Christ, ruling and reigning as a co-heir, advancing His kingdom on earth as it is in Heaven.

Every act of repentance moves you closer to the posture of authority you were created to hold. But it must begin with humility as you bring before God the inner vows, beliefs, and responses shaped by your wounds, and allow Him to replace the lies with truth.

Perhaps you were betrayed and vowed, I will never trust again. Maybe you were abused and resolved, I must always protect myself. These inner agreements, though born in pain, become spiritual covenants that empower the enemy's logic instead of God's truth. Repentance is the breaking of those covenants and marks a conscious return to the Government of Heaven.

True repentance stands as a sacred posture before God, where humility meets mercy, and the heart aligns again with Heaven's order, as David prayed:

"Have mercy on me, O God, according to Your steadfast love... The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit; a broken and contrite heart, O God, You will not despise."

PSALM 51:1, 17

When we cry, “God have mercy! Christ have mercy!” these are not empty words, they are the cry of the conscience awakening to its need. In that moment, Heaven leans close, and the Spirit witnesses to your heart that you are forgiven. To receive forgiveness is to enter the reality of redemption, the conscience is cleansed, the soul breathes again, and the victory of mercy is established in you.

Having received God’s forgiveness, with full awareness and passion, you can now say: I will never again use the weapon of accusation, against myself, against others, or against God.

PRAYER OF REPENTANCE AND RESTORATION

Father of mercy, I come before You with a humble and contrite heart. Thank you for revealing to me the agreements I have made in pain, the inner vows, the judgments, the words I have spoken in fear. I repent of partnering with accusation, control, pride, or unbelief. God have mercy. Christ have mercy. I renounce every lie that has governed my decisions and emotions. I surrender these false agreements to Your judgment and ask that You dissolve their power in the blood of Jesus. I receive Your forgiveness, not as an idea, but as a reality. Let the weight lift now. Let Your mercy flood my heart. I declare that I will

mercy. My heart will hold peace. Restore to me the joy of Your salvation and renew a right spirit within me. From this day forward, I walk in repentance that bears fruit, the fruit of obedience, humility, and authority in Christ. Amen.

Confession and repentance clear the inner temple, and they remove the residue of darkness. But cleansing alone is not the end; it is preparation. The next step is to rebuild, under divine order and alignment. Here you will learn how to stand under God’s covering and take your place within the order of divine authority, where obedience becomes freedom, and submission becomes power.

Core Scriptures

"The driving is like the driving of Jehu... for he drives furiously!"

— 2 KINGS 9:20

"Immediately the Spirit drove Him into the wilderness."

— MARK 1:12

"Jesus drove out all those who bought and sold in the temple."

— MATTHEW 21:12

Principle

Holy drivenness, zeal that pushes forward without hesitation.

Practice

Write what the Spirit shows you in “Confess, Forgive, & Repent.” One sentence of truth. One act of occupancy.

Step 4 • Submit to Order

Freedom flourishes within structure.

Cleansing without a government just makes a clean vacuum. Freedom needs a King. This step is not losing yourself. It is putting what was exposed under His rank, the way Jehu turned the old messengers around and said, follow me.



Confession and repentance remove the debris that once clouded your spiritual vision. But freedom without structure leads to confusion. In this next step, you move from cleansing to reordering. You take what was exposed, forgiven, and released, and bring it under divine government.

As we discovered in Part One, when we discussed the theological premise of rank and order, Jehu understood order very well. In 2 Kings 9, Jehu doesn't merely rebuke Jezebel, he establishes a new order. He commands the messengers of the old regime, saying, "Turn around and follow me." Jehu understood something that eluded Ahab: authority is not demonstrated by emotion or spectacle, but by command under obedience. Ahab possessed the title of king but surrendered his authority to Jezebel through passivity. Jehu, however, acted with decisiveness because he was under orders.

MANDATE OVER MANIFESTATION

Just as Jehu's authority was proven through obedience rather than display, your spiritual gifting and calling are validated through alignment, not applause. The mandate on your life is not centered on personal freedom or recognition, but on the restoration and strengthening of God's Kingdom through His Church.

The gifts, graces, and anointing that God entrusted to you were never meant for self-promotion or personal validation. They are instruments of service, tools to build the Body of Christ and advance His Kingdom on the earth. When governed by obedience, spiritual power becomes a creative force for transformation; when detached from purpose, it drifts into confusion and disorder.

Many people confuse gifting with authority and assume that a great show of talent, anointing, or supernatural manifestation automatically signals divine approval. But true authority doesn't flow from what you can do for God, it flows from what you willingly submit to Him. The foundation of Kingdom power is always surrender.

In ministry or leadership, it can be especially tempting to equate power with performance, to rely on visible displays of deliverance, healings, or signs and wonders as proof of calling. Demonstrations fueled by insecurity or fear of rejection may capture human attention, but they fail to move Heaven. When ministry becomes a stage rather than an altar, the enemy recognizes his own reflection, for performance rooted in fear mirrors rebellion, not God's rest.

Your mandate remains clear: "Seek first the Kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added to you." (Matthew 6:33) You have been entrusted with talents and authority not to elevate yourself, but to build His Kingdom, strengthen His people, and reveal His glory. Freedom is the overflow of alignment, an inheritance that follows obedience.

Jesus embodied this perfectly. In the wilderness, when the devil challenged Him, "If You are the Son of God, command that these stones become bread." (Matthew 4:3) Jesus refused to act outside the Father's will. His restraint was His strength. He showed that obedience, not display, is the true mark of sonship.

Likewise, when Joshua encountered the Commander of the Lord's Army before Jericho, he didn't rush into battle, trusting in his own experience, he fell down in reverence and asked, "What does my Lord say to His servant?" (Joshua 5:14) From that moment of submission came a divine strategy no human wisdom could have conceived.

When your gifting rests under divine order, your life becomes a channel through which Heaven touches earth, and the Church is strengthened through your obedience.

"This process has helped me realise that when we are under proper spiritual order— with Christ at the Head— the labour, toil, and unnecessary anxieties fall away."

SYLVIA— SOUTH AFRICA You've completed Step 3, you've confessed, repented, forgiven, and received forgiveness. You feel lighter, clearer, and more spiritually alive. Yet after a few weeks, the old patterns begin to creep back in. What happened? You experienced emotional release but not divine order. You felt free, but you did not anchor that freedom under a mandate. Freedom without structure drifts into pride; revelation without obedience can easily turn into rebellion.

To submit to order means to bring every area of your life, your relationships, emotions, finances, time, and calling, under the leadership of God. It is the prayer of alignment and authority that says: Father, in the name of Jesus, I choose Your order. I bring my whole life— my thoughts, decisions, relationships, time, and calling— under the leadership of Your Spirit. I yield my will to Yours, trusting Your wisdom above my own. Lord, align my gifting, my voice, and my actions with Your mandate. Let me move from obedience, not impulse; from Your rest, not striving. Establish Your government in me so that Your peace and authority flow through me without hindrance.

Jesus, You are my Head and my Commander. I follow Your instruction, I respond to Your direction, and I act from the covering of Your order. Let my life be a vessel of alignment, clarity, and stability, strengthening those around me. Where Your order reigns, peace multiplies. Where your alignment is honored, authority is released. I receive that order now, and I choose to walk in it fully. Amen.

This is where genuine authority takes form. When you are rightly aligned with God, you stand in the power He intended for you. Alignment restores dominion— not through force or control, but through partnership with His will. Because you are under His government, He entrusts you with the ability to govern rightly. You are empowered to discern, to judge, and to restore order where chaos exists. This alignment becomes your covering and your protection. Submission doesn't diminish control; it sanctifies it. It places control in the hands of the One who governs all things well, so that your will becomes an extension of His.

In Step 3, you exposed the trespassers; in Step 4, you return the property to its rightful owner. But this is more than a private act, it is a commissioning. When you live under divine order, you are on divine assignment. You become a representative of Heaven, carrying authority not for personal comfort but for the transformation of others.

Your freedom now becomes service. It strengthens the Church, restores families, and brings light into your workplace and community. The authority you walk in is not yours alone, it flows through you to bless, to heal, and to establish God's Kingdom wherever you go.

Yet, isolation is the greatest threat to this authority. Many lose their freedom because they refuse accountability. The spirit of independence, which is often mistaken for maturity, isolates the believer from the safety of community. But true authority is never solitary, it is relational. It thrives in alignment with spiritual covering, trusted leaders, and the household of faith. In Part Three: Walking in the Light, we give you details on how to plug into community and remain in intimacy with the Lord, two disciplines that will help keep you in the right order.

Core Scripture

"So the messenger went to meet him and said, 'Thus says the king: Is it peace? ' And Jehu said, 'What have you to do with peace? Turn around and follow me.'"

—2 KINGS 9:18–19

Principle

The battle is won by mandate and obedience, not a show of gifting.

Practice

Write what the Spirit shows you in “Submit to Order.” One sentence of truth. One act of occupancy.

Step 5 • Judge, Cast Down & Reassign

Discernment is a courtroom, not a mood.

You are not condemning people. You are standing in a courtroom under Christ and calling what was out of rank back into it. The adversary will try to question whether you even have the right. Discernment is how you answer — a verdict, not a mood.



The enemy's last defense is always to question your legitimacy, but discernment allows you to recognize neutrality and call it into obedience. You call every influence once ruled by the enemy to stand before Christ's verdict and be reassigned to serve righteousness.

After confession, forgiveness, repentance, and submission, you are now ready to act as a righteous judge under divine authority. This is not about condemning others or yourself, it is about restoring divine order in every realm, including relationships that have been twisted by rebellion, accusation, and fear.

When the enemy senses that judgment is about to be rendered, he resorts to accusation. Every time you rise in authority, the adversary tries to redefine your identity through mockery, fear, or self-doubt. Jezebel looked down from her window and called Jehu by the name, Zimri, which was one that carried the sting of disgrace and illegitimacy.

This is the voice of the accuser. It attacks your character to undermine your commission and seeks to put you back under the same system you are about to overthrow.

It whispers:

“You’re not ready.”

“You’re faking it.”

“You will fail again, just like last time.”

Jehu did not argue, nor did he explain or defend himself. Rather, he lifted his eyes toward the window, toward the place of accusation, and asked, “Who is on my side?” This is the voice of spiritual authority in action. When you know who you are, you stop explaining yourself to the enemy and start mobilizing the atmosphere around you.

REJECTING THE VOICE OF JEZEBEL

Jehu’s confrontation shows that accusation only has power if you listen to it. He didn’t answer Jezebel, he looked up. That upward gaze is important, for when you stop dialoguing with darkness and lift your focus, when you refuse to respond to an accusation, it loses its grip. To “reject accusation” is to remove the enemy’s right to define your narrative.

After refusing to engage with Jezebel’s accusation, Jehu went on to command the eunuchs who had responded to his call, to cast her down from her seat of authority: “Hashlichu-ha!” Jehu was calling messengers once loyal to Ahab’s corrupt regime to now align under God’s anointed purpose and overthrow the principality that held the whole system in the vice grip of Jezebel’s evil influence.

It is important to note that it is the eunuchs (the marginalized, previously powerless ones) and not Jehu, who enact the judgment. In the same way, when Jesus said, “Get behind Me, Satan!” He was not engaging in an argument or forbidding Satan from tempting him any longer, rather, he was issuing a judicial order and reestablishing the hierarchy.

When you step into this moment, you are reconciling creation back into rank, not fighting darkness. Everything that once served destruction must now serve redemption.

“I learned to cast down those spirits that affected my life and marriage. Some parts felt uncomfortable because I had to face things from many years ago, but I am grateful I did. I feel lighter, stronger, and closer to God.”

WOWLIFE CHURCH MEMBER— SRI LANKA

THE STEP 5 PROCESS

In this step, you will: i) Judge the stronghold; ii) Cast it down; and then iii) Reassign it to serve righteousness.

This will confront what once ruled you and bring it under Christ’s authority. Sample prayers are provided to help you navigate each stage with confidence and clarity.

We have included practical examples from the three ruling spirits we’ve previously discussed— Jezebel (control and manipulation), and deception)— to help you understand how to identify, confront, and reassign

each one within your own life and spheres of influence. There are, of course, many other entities you may have faced, but these three provide you with an understanding of how to deal with ruling principles in general.

Before you begin, find a quiet place where you can focus without interruption. Take a few deep breaths. Allow your heart to become still and your mind to settle. Welcome the Holy Spirit, the One who searches the heart and reveals the truth, to lead you through every word and revelation that follows.

JEZEBEL: THE SPIRIT OF CONTROL AND MANIPULATION

JUDGE THE STRONGHOLD: Identify and Confront

In steps 1 and 2, you noted in your prayer journal the areas in your life, or areas of influence, where the Jezebel spirit gained access through fear, insecurity, and the desire to control outcomes or people. Provided here is a sample prayer that will help you address the curses you identified, and how to address the stronghold they formed so that you can confront it decisively by judging it and reassigning the forces within it to serve God's purposes through you. Be sure to be explicit and include every single curse and influence the Holy Spirit brought to light:

I recognize the spirit of control and manipulation that has governed my reactions and relationships, through suspicion, impulsive decisions, poor boundaries, intimidation, low self-worth, emotional blackmail, playing the victim, co-dependency, [add to this as the Holy Spirit guides you]. Jezebel, in this way you have set yourself up against the knowledge of God and you have lied about me. You no longer have authority in my life. I command you to stand down and submit to Christ's dominion. In Jesus' name. Amen.

CAST IT DOWN

To cast down means to bring what once ruled you into submission beneath Christ's feet. Once you have judged the stronghold, you must now remove this influence from the seat of your emotions and decisions:

I cast you down to the ground. I will no longer partner with you to dictate my choices, my leadership, or my identity. I am surrendered to peace, not governed by control. Outcomes or people, picture yourself opening your hands, surrendering control, as the weight of manipulation falls away and peace fills its place.

REASSIGN: Direct it Towards Justice and Restoration

Now that Jezebel's influence has been judged and brought into divine order, it is time to repurpose what once resisted you. You are now authorized to command every force that once operated under her sway to serve righteousness and advance the purposes of God.

I now reassign the spirits that worked under the control and manipulation of Jezebel in my life to confront and restrict every operation and every system that is against God in my jurisdiction [speak out any specific examples that come to mind]. Suffocate these systems and let the powers that once sought to dominate me now serve the Kingdom of God; close every channel of exploitation and silence the systems that profit from oppression. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Here, the very spirits that once produced control now become instruments of freedom that serve righteousness, under your command as a coheir with Christ.

MAMMON: THE SPIRIT OF LACK AND FALSE SECURITY

JUDGE THE STRONGHOLD: Identify and Confront

Begin by addressing the stronghold of Mammon, whom you identified earlier. Speak directly to it with the authority you have received in Christ. stronghold in your life, producing fear, striving, and a spirit of lack, declare aloud:

I recognize that I have lived under the influence of Mammon by hoarding, working compulsively, and planning obsessively; I have developed an inability to rest, a reliance on myself instead of God, and now money feels like survival and generosity feels dangerous, the future feels unsafe, and lack feels like shame, [complete as Holy Spirit guides you]. Mammon, in this way you have set yourself up against the knowledge of God and you have lied about me. You no longer govern me. I command you to stand down and take your proper place under the authority of Christ.

CAST IT DOWN

Once you have judged the stronghold, you must now remove it from its position of influence: I now cast you down to the ground, beneath the order of Heaven. You will no longer rule my thoughts, my finances, or my emotions. visualize that fear being pulled from its throne and laid before Jesus, who now becomes your true Provider.

REASSIGN: Direct it Towards Justice and Restoration

Finally, what once worked against you must now serve the Kingdom. Reassign it to bring order, freedom, and restoration in the world.

I now reassign the spirits that worked under the influence of Mammon in my life, to bring down idolatrous economic logics in my areas of influence and ensure they do not survive [speak out any specific examples that come to mind]. I send you into my industry to impoverish greed, endless accumulation, and self-exaltation. I send you to the economy of my city to destroy systems of deceit, corruption, and manipulative trade. Remove from among my people materialism, consumption, and performance-based worth. In Jesus' name, Amen.

This is the full circle of divine governance: what once oppressed you is now commissioned to serve God's purpose in your life and on the earth.

LEVIATHAN: THE SPIRIT OF TWISTING AND CONFUSION

JUDGE THE STRONGHOLD: Identify and Confront

Leviathan operates through distortion, twisting truth, breeding misunderstanding, and turning relationships or

communication into knots of confusion. Where you've recognized its influence, speak directly with the authority of Christ:

I recognize the presence of Leviathan as the spirit that has twisted truth and sown confusion in my life. Leviathan, I see the way you have twisted thoughts and misinterpreted motives so that neutral comments feel like criticism, correction sounds like rejection, boundaries feel like betrayal, and silence feels like hostility. I recognize your influence in gossip, projections, and assumptions. I see your influence where I have been unnecessarily defensive, overprotective of my ego, and offended in my identity, [complete as Holy Spirit guides you]. Leviathan, in this way, you have set yourself up against the knowledge of God and you have lied about me. You no longer have the power to distort my thoughts or my words. I command you to stand down and take your place under the authority of Christ.

CAST IT DOWN

You now remove Leviathan from its position of influence in your relationships, communication, and self-perception: I cast you down to the ground, beneath the Government of Heaven. You will no longer twist my discernment, confuse my words, or poison my peace. strained your relationships, visualize those words and moments being straightened, untangled, and aligned under the light of truth.

REASSIGN: Direct it Toward Justice and Restoration

Command that which once caused confusion, to now serve the work of revelation and reconciliation.

I now reassign the spirits that have worked under the influence of Leviathan in my life to confront the economies of confusion and the systems built on pride in my environment [speak out any specific examples that come to mind]. Bring every web of deceit operating within structures, systems, and patterns of thought into contradiction. Let intellectual towers built on self-exaltation collapse under their own instability. Let false pathways lose their power and let twisted logic unravel before the wisdom of God. Let the power that once twisted truth, twist confusion, manipulation and distortion, until order reigns in the place of confusion. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Through this reassignment, the voice of confusion becomes a servant of truth, and light triumphs where distortion once ruled.

"The righteous will shine forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father."

MATTHEW 13:43

Once that area is brought into alignment, it becomes a tool of justice and peace in your surroundings. yourself struggling to know where to send the spirits that you have cast down, we have provided this list of supplementary reassignment prayers at the back of the book.

Caveat
"The righteous will shine forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father." — MATTHEW 13:43
"When I looked toward the heavens, I saw the sun and moon and stars, and I looked out of the window and said, 'Is anyone there?'" — LUKAS 10:21
"Who will bring a charge against God?" — ROMANS 8:33
"Who will bring a charge against God?" — ROMANS 8:33
Prayer
In Kingdom authority, judgment remains silent. True authority is given to the face of accusation.

Practice

Write what the Spirit shows you in “Judge, Cast Down & Reassign.” One sentence of truth. One act of occupancy.

Step 6 • Command Alignment

Speak as one under the King.

Some things around you are not loyal to the old occupancy. They are waiting. Jehu asked, who is on my side? — and the eunuchs threw Jezebel down. This step is speech: you command alignment as someone already under the King, not as a person screaming into the dark.



In the palace, Jezebel still occupied a throne, but her rule carried no true power; it was positional and void of Holy Spirit authority. Those around her, the eunuchs, were neutral. They had served under her but were not loyal to her corruption. Jehu discerned their hesitation and called it forth: “Who is on my side?”

At that question, something shifted. The eunuchs, who had once been silent witnesses, threw Jezebel down. The victory came not through Jehu’s sword but through the obedience of those standing in proximity to corruption. This is a spiritual law: when you discern neutrality and call it to act, Heaven responds. Many battles in your life are waiting for you to do exactly that, to command neutrality to take a side.

Not every force in your life is against you, some are simply neutral. These are the eunuchs at the window, waiting for a command. They represent people, systems, and structures that have remained passive or silent in the presence of disorder.

Ask the Holy Spirit to reveal who or what these neutral forces are in your sphere of influence:

Family lines and relationships that have remained indifferent to truth.

Churches or spiritual communities are caught between conviction and complacency.

Workplaces, schools, or hospitals where integrity has been muted by fear.

Neighborhoods or cities that have settled for peace without justice.

Finances, resources, and bank accounts that have not yet come under Kingdom purpose.

When God reveals them, speak with authority:

Who is on my side? Let righteousness speak! Father, awaken every neutral force, every person, place, and system positioned near influence but bound by silence [list those that the Holy Spirit brings to mind]. Let them rise and cast down everything that exalts itself against Your purpose. I command all that is neutral to align with Heaven's order and serve Your Kingdom.

Sometimes the "neutral forces" are within your own soul, parts of you that remain undecided, neither believing nor resisting. These are the areas where hesitation and confusion still sit in silence, awaiting leadership. They, too, must be brought into submission to Christ's truth.

Soul, align with Spirit. Every divided thought, every silent fear, I command you to cast down confusion and exalt the Lordship of Christ within me. Let every part of my being, heart, mind, and will, come into harmony with Heaven's order.

When the inner world aligns, the outer world responds. Internal peace becomes external authority, and your whole life begins to move in rhythm with the Kingdom of God.

VICTORY THROUGH ALIGNMENT

"It's changed the way I view 'conflict' with others, and through this process it's easier for me to pray into situations rather than expect an outcome change dependent on someone else."

NATASHA— SRI LANKA Accusation thrives in confusion; order dismantles it. Jehu's triumph came through the power of alignment; he unified those positioned near Jezebel under one righteous command by casting them down into economies of oppression. Agreement brought victory where confrontation alone could not.

This is the full cycle of Hashlichu-Ha, the sacred act of casting down every thought, influence, and structure that resists divine alignment. Now the atmosphere around you is clear. Then accusations have fallen silent, and every sphere within your reach is being reordered under Christ's authority. You stand in peace, governed by Heaven, ready to move in dominion.

In the next step, you will testify, declaring what God has done. Your testimony will seal your freedom and extend it outward, turning deliverance into lasting dominion.

Practice

Write what the Spirit shows you in “Command Alignment.” One sentence of truth. One act of occupancy.

Step 7 • Testify and Maintain Honor

What is occupied must be kept.

What is occupied has to be kept. Testimony is how Heaven's verdict becomes the law of your actual life — spoken, remembered, given to someone else. Honor is how you stay. This is not the end of the walk. It is how you live in what was recovered.



“This teaching has helped us understand the intuitive reasons we had for stepping away from the church that we once held in high esteem. We spent four years serving in its leadership, and during that time, we came to recognize how control can quietly take root even within good intentions. Stepping away from that structure, in obedience to God’s leading, brought deep freedom and clarity. Today, we walk in our true calling, pursuing God’s will with peace and honor. What once confined us has now become part of our testimony of grace and restoration.”

FEZILE & NKURUMAH MAUNCHO— NAIROBI, KENYA Through testimony, Heaven's verdict becomes law in your life, and every victory matures into stewardship. This final step transforms spiritual authority into Christlike maturity, to testify is to stand as a witness of divine order restored, giving glory to God while calling all creation into alignment with His Kingdom.

Jehu had accomplished his assignment, Jezebel had fallen, and justice had been executed. Yet his next command was one of respect: “Go, see now this cursed woman, and bury her, for she was a king’s daughter.”

Even though Jezebel embodied corruption and control, Jehu acknowledged her original dignity, she had been born of royal lineage. He did not mock her downfall; he honored her identity. That is the posture of mature authority: honor without compromise.

RESTORING HONOR AFTER WARFARE

This step invites you to look again, through healed eyes, at the people, places, and institutions that once opposed you or caused pain. You now govern under Christ's order. To testify with honor means to speak blessing where you once spoke bitterness, to intercede for what once wounded you, and to call forth redemption from what was broken.

COMMANDING ALIGNMENT THROUGH HONOR

Honor restores dignity to the systems and relationships in your sphere of influence; it transforms their future purpose and does not excuse it. As you testify, use your voice to bless and realign.

Lord, I bless the banks, businesses, and systems within my care. I command financial structures in my sphere to come under divine justice and generosity.

Christ, I honour this person or place as part of Your Kingdom. I release forgiveness and call them into alignment with Your Spirit of truth and love.

All creation belongs to the Lord. I bless the elements of earth, air, fire, and water to align with divine order and serve redemption.

This is the mark of mature authority, when what once resisted you now operates under your covering. Honor becomes your highest form of warfare, because it restores what accusation destroyed.

Prayer of Honor and Restoration

Father, I thank You for teaching me Your ways of authority. I now choose honor over mockery, peace over pride. I release forgiveness over every person, place, and system that once opposed me. I command them to come into Kingdom alignment, to serve Your purpose and display Your glory. I bless the institutions, workplaces, churches, and territories within my sphere. I bless even those who once cursed me. Let all things in my domain, seen and unseen, now come under divine order. As a son/daughter of light, I declare that everything entrusted to me shall prosper in righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Spirit. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Dominion Through Honor

When you can look upon the fallen systems or relationships of your past and say, "Bury her, for she was a king's daughter." Your authority has matured from warfare to governance.

This is divine strength clothed in humility, authority ruled by mercy. It distinguishes those who merely cast down from those who rebuild. Honor completes the work of deliverance, turning victory into stewardship.

THE FULL CIRCLE OF TAKING BACK AUTHORITY

You began this journey by identifying the entry points that gave the enemy access to build strongholds in your life. You have walked through awareness, confession, repentance, and forgiveness. You have come into divine order, pronounced judgment, cast down and reassigned opposition, commanded alignment, and now

testified with honor.

Final Reflection and Commissioning

As you move forward: voice. weight in the Spirit. field of stewardship. but for service.

You are commissioned as a restorer of order, a carrier of peace, and an ambassador of the Kingdom. Go forth in grace, ruling with humility, and building with love.

Commissioning Decree

Father, I thank You for restoring me to divine order and positioning me in the fullness of Christ's authority. I receive the mantle to build, to bless, and to reconcile. My life, my relationships, my work, and every space under my care are now sanctified for Your Kingdom purposes. I commit to walk in peace, govern in love, and steward with humility. I release life wherever I go. Fear, shame, and striving no longer have a claim on me. I reign with Christ— not to control, but to cultivate; not to boast, but to bless. From this day forward, my life becomes a living decree of restoration, authority, and divine order— Your Kingdom come, on earth as it is in Heaven. Amen.

Core Scripture

"He said, 'Go, see now this cursed woman, and bury her, for she was a king's daughter.'"

— 2 KINGS 9:34

"Do not rejoice when your enemy falls, and do not let your heart be glad when he stumbles."

— PROVERBS 24:17

"And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony."

— REVELATION 12:11

Principle

Victory reaches its fullness when it is spoken with honour.

Testifying is the act of sealing what God has done, declaring His justice without pride and His mercy without mockery.

Practice

Write what the Spirit shows you in “Testify and Maintain Honor.” One sentence of truth. One act of occupancy.

7 Steps at a Glance







Step 1 • Identify the Curse

“Now Joram had returned to Jezreel to recover from the wounds...”

2 Kings 9:15

Principle: When authority vacates its seat, curses and control step in.

Your journey to freedom begins with awareness. Before you can take authority over anything, you must first see where that authority was lost or surrendered. This step invites you to slow down and recognize the repetitive cycles that have been playing out in your life. These might be emotional reactions, relationship conflicts, financial lack, or recurring disappointments that seem to follow you no matter how hard you try to change.

Step 2 • Reveal the Stronghold

“What peace, as long as the harlotries of your mother Jezebel and her witchcraft are so many?”

2 Kings 9:22

Principle: It's not enough to identify the curse — you must reveal the stronghold and name it, to pronounce God's judgment.

Once the root of the curse begins to surface, the next step is to name the stronghold that has been built up around it and reveal all the ways in which it has ransacked your life. You are now moving from recognition to revelation, from seeing the doorway to identifying the occupant that entered through it.

Step 3 • Confess, Forgive, and Repent

“The driving is like the driving of Jehu... for he drives furiously!”

2 Kings 9:20

“Immediately the Spirit drove Him into the wilderness.”

Mark 1:12

“Jesus drove out all those who bought and sold in the temple.”

Matthew 21:12

Principle: Holy drivenness — zeal that pushes forward without hesitation.

Here you stand on the threshold between bondage and freedom. Once you have recognized the curse and named the stronghold, the next step is to release its hold on you through confession, forgiveness, and repentance. This requires a drivenness: the same divine zeal that moved Jehu to cleanse Jezreel, that drove Jesus into the wilderness, and that compelled Him to turn over the tables of corruption in the Temple.

Step 4 • Submit to Order

“So the messenger went to meet him and said, “Thus says the king: Is it peace?” And Jehu said, “What have you to do with peace? Turn around and follow me.””

2 Kings 9:18–19

Principle: The battle is won by mandate and obedience, not a show of gifting.

Confession and repentance remove the debris that once clouded your spiritual vision. But freedom without structure leads to confusion. In this next step, you move from cleansing to reordering. You take what was exposed, forgiven, and released, and bring it under divine government.

Step 5 • Judge, Cast Down & Reassign

“Cast her down (Hashilichu-Ha).”

2 Kings 9:33

“Get behind Me, Satan!”

Matthew 16:23

“For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds...”

2 Corinthians 10:4–5

Principle: In Kingdom authority, judgment restores order.

True authority is proven in the face of accusation. The enemy's last defense is always to question your legitimacy, but discernment allows you to recognize neutrality and call it into obedience. Now you call every influence once ruled by the enemy to stand before Christ's verdict and be reassigned to serve righteousness.

Step 6 • Command Alignment

"Then he lifted up his face to the window and said, "Who is on my side? Who?" And two or three eunuchs looked out at him. Then he said, "Throw her down (Hashlichu-Ha).""

2 Kings 9:32–33

Principle: Authority is established when divine order is enforced.

The moment neutrality is confronted and called to choose, Heaven responds. Every silent force, within the soul or in the surrounding world, must take its place under Christ's command. Jezebel still sat on her throne, but her authority was hollow; it was power without Spirit. Around her stood the eunuchs, loyal by position yet unbound in heart. Jehu discerned their silence and summoned their allegiance with one decisive call: "Who is on my side?" In that moment, neutrality ended, and alignment began.

Step 7 • Testify & Maintain Honor

"He said, "Go, see now this cursed woman, and bury her, for she was a king's daughter.""

2 Kings 9:34

"Do not rejoice when your enemy falls, and do not let your heart be glad when he stumbles."

Proverbs 24:17

"And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony."

Revelation 12:11

Principle: Victory reaches its fullness when it is spoken with honor.

Testifying is the act of sealing what God has done, declaring His justice without pride and His mercy without mockery. Through testimony, Heaven's verdict becomes law in your life, and every victory matures into stewardship. This final step transforms spiritual authority into Christlike maturity. To testify is to stand as a witness of divine order restored, giving glory to God while calling all creation into alignment with His Kingdom.

Commissioning Decree

Father, I thank You for restoring me to divine order. I receive the mantle of holy authority to build, to bless, and to reconcile. Every gift, every relationship, every space under my care is consecrated for Your glory. I commit to walk humbly, to govern righteously, and to release life wherever I go. I am no longer bound by fear, shame, or striving. I reign with Christ, not to control, but to cultivate; not to boast, but to bless. From this day forward, my life becomes a living decree of Your Kingdom come, on earth as it is in Heaven. In

Jesus' name, Amen.

Part Three • Walking in the Light

Every spiritual journey reaches a moment where the terrain shifts and the soul realizes it has crossed a threshold. What once felt like pursuit becomes presence, and warfare becomes wisdom. This is a sacred turning where the end of deliverance gives way to the beginning of purpose. Maturity unveils this transition quietly, through clarity of conscience, steadiness of heart, and a deep awareness of who you have become in Christ.

Walking in the light reveals the way that God has shaped identity through process. The early zeal that carried you through repentance, cleansing, and alignment has matured into a deeper passion, one anchored in peace. Having invested time and energy in understanding what it means to have abdicated your position as a coheir with Christ, you are now convinced there is no other way, no other choice worthy of consideration than that which He died to give you.

You have walked through awareness, confession, repentance, and forgiveness and surrendered to divine order; you have pronounced judgment upon, cast down, and reassigned opposition and oppression; you have commanded alignment, and now here you are, a living testimony that divine alignment produces authority, and authority produces transformation.

Have you noticed that your voice carries more weight and your presence brings order? Can you sense the Spirit beginning to entrust you with what He once protected you from? Perhaps you have already noticed that your decisions are having an influence upon the atmosphere around you. This is the beginning hidden inside the ending, the shift from being the subject of ministry to becoming the one who ministers; from being carried, to one who strengthens; from receiving light, to carrying light into the places where darkness rules.

Jesus described this sacred turning when He said, “You are the light of the world.” But light is an identity, not an assignment, and once it is awakened, it shines by nature as its presence is revealed. When a believer reaches this place, ministry flows through life itself — through conversation, compassion, generosity, prayer, and the wisdom that comes from an aligned conscience.

However, the beginning that emerges in maturity calls you into a deeper partnership with Christ, where light becomes not a task to perform but an identity to embody. This rest does not mean inactivity; we are not called to do nothing. Faith without works is empty, but works without faith become dead. True impact,

assignment, and action all flow from intimacy.

As you enter this new beginning, we urge you to cultivate such an intimacy with the Lord. You will never regret the time you spend with the Lover of your soul. Our spiritual father, Dave Hodgson, discovered that a brief morning quiet time was not enough to sustain the depth of intimacy with the Father that is required to confront global systems of oppression and build sheep nations. He now dedicates one full day each week solely to slowing down, becoming quiet, and listening to the Lord. Dave cautions that without this intentional space and time, even the most well-meaning strategies can quickly drift toward personal ambition rather than Kingdom purpose. He testifies that the fruit of this weekly day of prayer is a divine intimacy so profound that in high-pressure moments throughout the week, he can attune to the Holy Spirit in an instant and flex immediately to the will of the Father. Having followed his lead, we are noticing the same fruit in our own lives, and we strongly encourage you to join us.

STAYING IN COMMUNITY

Just as intimacy cultivates depth, community cultivates stability; one roots you in Christ, the other roots you in His body. Alignment is strengthened through shared rhythms, shared commitments, and shared faith. To remain steadfast in the light, it is essential to stay connected to people who carry the same resonance in places where the Spirit is honoured, where conscience is sharpened, and where purpose is awakened. Community becomes the environment where calling is recognised, where gifts are refined, and where the believer steps into divine assignment with clarity and boldness.

As you move into such a community, you take your place among those who carry Heaven's peace into their families, their industries, their cities, and their nations. You join a lineage of sons and daughters across the earth who walk in the Spirit with integrity, maturity, and love. This shared life does more than support you; it situates you within a global story of transformation.

From here, your journey naturally widens into assignment. The community you choose becomes the soil in which your calling flourishes, shaping how you grow and how you give. And so we extend to you a warm invitation to join a global spiritual ecosystem designed to nurture your purpose and equip you to walk in your assignment with clarity and joy— WOWLife Church.

WOWLIFE CHURCH AND WOWLIFE ONLINE CHURCH (WOC)

believers committed to walking in divine revelation, freedom, and practical love. The ministry functions through coach groups and local gatherings around the world, providing spaces for discipleship, prayer, and shared learning. On the website, you'll find information on how to connect with a local coach group or online gathering that suits your time zone and season of life. for those who desire community, teaching, and mentorship but may not yet be connected to a local fellowship. WOC provides live online services and small group sessions led by trained coaches and facilitators, and the WOC community connects you with believers, mentors, and spiritual leaders from across the world, all dedicated to one purpose: to help you discover your assignment and walk it with confidence, consciousness, and Spirit-led authority.

A Global Ecosystem for Kingdom Influence

While the structure of WOC may evolve over time, its purpose will remain unchanged: to create a global space of spiritual covering, accountability, and growth for all who desire to walk in the freedom and authority of Christ. Through these gatherings, you can find prayer partners, mentors, and friends who will journey with you as you apply the principles in this book and continue to grow in the revelation of God's love and Kingdom order.

Conclusion and Commissioning

This journey of divine realignment has led us to a final revelation: the life you carry is no longer your own, it is lived in partnership with the Spirit of Christ, in a shared rhythm between Heaven and earth. You have learned to listen with a soft heart, to discern with clarity, to act from love, and to stand in divine authority shaped by intimacy. You are ready to serve the Church and to build the Kingdom.

Your assignment may express itself in business, ministry, creativity, leadership, innovation, healing, advocacy, or simple acts of love, but wherever and however it manifests, remember that the Spirit is your source. We are called to bring solutions to the problems of the world wherever we encounter them. But even though we are addressing these problems from a new, realigned place of authority in Christ, obstacles will be inevitable. So, as you bring your solutions, remember they originate from divine wisdom; every breakthrough you witness reflects the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ within you, and every victory you win reveals the authority of the One who goes before you.

Community now becomes the environment where this light matures. Through fellowship, counsel, accountability, testimony, and shared devotion, the flame is tended, and the assignment is clarified. Be assured that you walk with others who have encountered the same grace, received the same Spirit, and entered the same Kingdom call. Together, we form a body that carries Christ's presence and Kingdom solutions into families, industries, and nations.

So now all that remains is to speak a blessing over you, beloved, a prayer of impartation, alignment, and mandate.

Commissioning Prayer

Beloved of God, I speak over you now in the name of Jesus Christ. I bless your conscience, your spirit, your body, and your entire being. May the light of Christ arise within you with clarity that cannot be shaken and peace that governs every thought. I call your inner world into divine order. I speak alignment over your emotions, your will, your desires, and your imagination. May every fragmented place come together in the harmony of the Spirit. Right now, let the breath of God fill you, breath that awakens, breath that heals, breath that restores. I release over you the grace to walk in the Spirit. May your steps be ordered, your decisions be sound, and your conscience remain sensitive and bright. Let your heart become a throne for the wisdom of God, your mind a temple for revelation, your life a vessel of divine flow. You carry the light of Christ. I impart to you the confidence to shine, in your home, your calling, your business, your ministry, your relationships, and in every sphere where your feet shall tread. I speak the fire of assignment over you: a fire that purifies, a fire that directs, a fire that will not be quenched by fear, doubt, or

accusation. May solutions rise in your spirit. May creativity flow without obstruction. May discernment sharpen your sight. May compassion govern your influence. I call you into your assignment, not by the hand of man, but by the Spirit who rests upon you. You are blessed, you are commissioned, you are released to walk as a bearer of light and a carrier of rest. And now I seal you with an ancient promise: It is by My Spirit, says the Lord, that you will build, you will conquer, you will heal, you will restore. Walk now in the fullness of this grace. Walk now in the consciousness of Christ. Walk now in the intimacy of the Spirit. And may the peace of Heaven accompany you with every step of your journey. Amen.

Prayers and decrees

Prayers

Opening search

Psalm 139:23–24

Begin here — before a chamber, a step, or a hard day.

Search me, O God, and know my heart.

Try me and know my thoughts.

*See if there is any wicked way in me,
and lead me in the way everlasting.*

The easy yoke

When you are rushing or fighting.

Jesus, I take Your yoke.

I refuse collapse. I refuse combat as my default.

Love and fire, one stride. Time me.

Amen.

Stay covered

When you are tempted to walk this alone.

Father, I will not walk this alone.

Lead me to covering, to fellowship, to a trusted shepherd.

Let my story become someone else's hope.

Amen.

Release the debt

When you are still collecting.

Father, I bring the name I have been carrying.

I forgive. I release the debt. I will not keep this as a right.

Where I have been the one who owes, I repent.

Restore my stride. Amen.

Dwell here

When the body still flinches.

*Holy Spirit, this body is a temple. Dwell here.
Reach the place in me that still startles — not only the thought.
I consent. If tears come, they are not failure.
Amen.*

Reined, not abandoned

*When you are murmuring, or the dry place feels like a curse.
Father, I repent of entitlement dressed as prayer.
Teach me in this wilderness. Rein me as a son.
I will not accuse You of leaving me.
Amen.*

Decrees

Preeminence

*Colossians 1:15–17
Colossians 1 — He is before all things, including you.
Jesus Christ, You have the preeminence in all things — including me.
I confess where I have given other names first place.
Hold me together. Hold my house together. Hold my mind together.
I receive Your supremacy as rest, and from rest I will govern.*

Rank restored

*Authority is command under obedience — not volume.
I take my place under the command of Christ.
I refuse lawlessness, and I refuse legalism.
What was occupied without right is reassigned.
Every name that sat first is named under Him.*

This ground is holy

*When a room still feels owned.
This ground is holy. I am a temple. He dwells here.
I yield the old alarm.
What asked Jesus to leave me alone has no remaining right.
I occupy this body, this house, this day, under the King.*

The trap is named

When scandalon has halted your stride.

I name the offense. I will not keep it as a right.

I release the debt. I refuse identity built on the wound.

Blessed is the one who is not offended because of You.

My conscience is recovered. My stride is restored.

A son, not a hired hand

When you have left the house, or come back as a servant.

I come home as a son. I will not bargain for a wage.

The yoke times me. It does not crush me.

I refuse the prodigal's independence and the elder brother's ledger.

I take my place in the house.

The standard is lifted

When occupancy got comfortable because the line dropped.

I lift the standard in this house, this work, this mind.

Justice is how the Kingdom runs. I will not lower it to keep peace.

The fear of the Lord is first.

What was out of rank is called back under Christ.

Reassignment prayers

Supplementary Reassignment Prayers After you have judged and cast down the stronghold in Step 5, and you are preparing to reassign the bound spirits to serve righteousness, you might find yourself struggling to know where to send them. Below is a list of reassignment prayers to get you started that is appropriate to each stronghold. Jezebel: Jezebel operates on influence without accountability, wherever the narrative becomes more powerful than the truth and creates economies where emotional control is currency, influence is gained through seduction or manipulation, truth is replaced with narrative, and identity is destabilized so people can be controlled. Here are some prayers of reassignment for spirits working under the authority of Jezebel I send you to media and entertainment economies where attention, seduction, narrative manipulation, and emotional domination drive profit and where image triumphs over substance. I send you to social media economies built on validation addiction, comparison, emotional volatility, and self-curation whose platforms magnify seduction, manipulation, self-aggrandizement, and accusation.

I send you to religious control economies where spirituality is used to manipulate, flatter, and control, through prophetic manipulation, celebrity preachers who build emotional dependency, worship environments where sensuality replaces true devotion, church cultures where leadership uses secrecy, intimidation, and seduction to remain unchallenged and spiritual climates where discernment is punished and loyalty is demanded. I send

you to politics and ideological capture in environments of political spin-doctoring industries (narrative engineering, image crafting), to regimes run by shadow advisors who operate behind the scenes. I send you to political movements built on emotional warfare rather than truth. I send you to States where propaganda replaces reality. I send you to gender and relationally oppressive economies that weaponize sexuality, emotionality, or relational power such as sex industry economies (pornography, escorting, trafficking), corporate “glass ceiling” cultures where women must trade emotional labor or flirtation for advancement, household power- dynamics built on manipulation and narcissistic relationship structures where one person dominates through guilt, seduction, or emotional volatility. I send you to narrative culture economies where storytelling becomes a weapon, such as entertainment news tabloids built on gossip and character assassination, public relations industries that rewrite truth and spin reality, social movements where outrage replaces reasoning and universities that suppress alternative viewpoints through ideological intimidation. I send you to corporate and workplace manipulation economies where the narrative becomes more powerful than the truth, such as toxic workplaces where

promotion comes through alliances, not merit, environments where gossip is a currency, corporate politics where people are destroyed subtly, not directly, offices where supervisors cultivate emotional dependency or favoritism. I send you to creative and artistic economies where identity is shaped by emotional intensity, sensuality, and vulnerability without boundaries, such as fashion industries built on body-worship and image idolatry, music industries that sexualize artists for profit or art spaces where “transgression” is currency (shock value economy). I send you wherever beauty is divorced from holiness and turned into manipulation. Mammon: Mammon-based economies are systems shaped by fear, scarcity, exploitation, domination, and transactional identity. In these economies the spirit of Mammon thrives, gaining legitimacy to govern the emotional, financial, and spiritual climate of a people. Here are some prayers of reassignment for spirits working under the authority of Mammon: I send you into economic systems fueled by scarcity, anxiety and debt, where economic growth depends on consumer debt, credit dependency, and perpetual borrowing. I send you into economies that draw their identity from scarcity so that nations are known for hyperinflation. I send you into economies built on hoarding, accumulation and inequality, where a tiny elite controls the majority of wealth creating hopelessness. I send you to economies built on the exploitation of labor

and where human bodies are dehumanized such as human trafficking, migrant labor, forced labor, and child labor. I send you into economies built on transactional identity, where identity is monetized and intimacy becomes a commodity, where people are products, not persons. I send you into economies built on fear of loss and where fear becomes an economic strategy for security, insurance and status; and where fear is monetized, social rank is purchased and status becomes salvation. I send you to economies built on isolation, competition and self-preservation, where there is no security, no community, only productivity and where relationships are seen as currency, where personal success replaces collective well-being and mammon is worshipped through performance. I send you to shadow economies driven by corruption, where public services need bribes to function and where justice can be bought, where economies flourish on fear and secrecy, and dehumanization is profit. I send you into religious mammon economies where offerings become transactional attempts at blessings and worship is turned into commerce, where performance, platform, and money overshadow presence and people become spiritual consumers and not disciples. Leviathan: Leviathan systems thrive on distortion, twisting truth, and generating confusion, chaos, perception-warfare, and distrust. They profit from confusion and disempowerment and turn perception itself into a battleground. They

maintain inequity through interpretive distortion and twist identity into a tool of oppression. They rely on perception distortion more than actual economic fundamentals and use spiritual distortion to maintain emotional and social control.

Here are some prayers of reassignment for spirits working under the authority of Leviathan: I send you to disinformation economies, where social media platforms, political propaganda industries, troll farms, state-sponsored misinformation networks twist truth to generate confusion, polarize populations by distorting narratives, and reward outrage and falsehood (algorithmic amplification). I send you to bureaucratic obfuscation economies where corrupt government agencies, public procurement systems, and opaque regulatory frameworks that twist procedures to hide accountability, create complexity that prevents public understanding and weaponizes ambiguity to maintain control. I send you to media manipulation economies where state- controlled media and corporate-controlled media monopolies bend narratives to fit political or corporate agendas and fabricate divisions and frame events in distorted ways to steer public emotion. I send you to legalistic, interpretive manipulation economies such as court systems, legal firms, policy drafting, lobbying structures that twist language, exploit loopholes and turn justice into a technical game rather than a moral pursuit. I send you to identity-fragmentation economies where tribal politics, ethnic division industries, and culture-war ecosystems twist collective memory, weaponize identity to divide and control, and reinforce “us vs. them” narratives. I send you to financial illusion economies where perception of value is manipulated through speculative markets, predatory lending, and inflation manipulation by twisting the perception of value, creating illusions of prosperity or crisis, and manipulating scarcity for profit.

I send you to spiritual or religious manipulation economies such as cultic systems, religious authoritarianism, and prosperity-gospel manipulation that operate by twisting doctrine, distorting identity and trust, and creating confusion about God’s character to maintain control.

Glossary

Accusation. A formal or informal charge brought against someone, spiritually or legally, often used by the enemy to condemn or limit a believer. Revelation 12:10 “Then I heard a loud voice saying in Heaven, 'Now salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of His Christ have come, for the accuser of our brethren, who accused them before our God, day and night, has been cast down.'”.

Anthropology. The study of humanity, cultures, and societies. Spiritually, it helps us understand human behavior in light of God’s design. Psalm 103:14 “For He knows our frame; He remembers that we are dust.”.

Algorithms. Patterns or sequences of thought or behavior that govern outcomes. Spiritually, these are mental or spiritual ‘programs’ shaping life. Romans 12:2 “And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, that you may prove what is that good and acceptable and perfect will of God.”.

Alignment. Bringing life into agreement with God. Amos 3:3 “Can two walk together, unless they are agreed ?”.

Anointing. Empowerment of the Spirit. 1 John 2:20 “But you have an anointing from the Holy One, and you know all things.”.

Authority. The right and power given by God to act. Luke 10:19 “Behold, I give you the authority to trample on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy, and nothing shall by any means hurt you.”.

Chaos of the Unstructured Unconscious. Internal disorder arising from unrenewed or unsubmitted areas of the mind. James 3:16 “For where envy and self-seeking exist, confusion and every evil thing are there.”.

Cognitive Anthropology. The study of the influence of culture upon thinking. Spiritually, it shows how the Kingdom reshapes thought. Philippians 2:5 “Let this mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus.”.

Commissioned. Appointed and sent by God for a task. Matthew 28:19 “Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.”.

Conscience. The inner moral compass. Romans 2:15 “...who show the work of the law written in their hearts, their conscience also bearing witness, and between themselves their thoughts accusing or else excusing them...”.

Conscience Intelligence. Spirit-led discernment of right and wrong. Hebrews 5:14 “But solid food belongs to those who are of full age, that is, those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil.”.

Consciousness. Awareness of self and surroundings. 1 Corinthians 15:34 “Awake to righteousness, and do not sin; for some do not have the knowledge of God. I speak this to your shame.”.

Curses. Spoken or spiritual judgments. Proverbs 26:2 “Like a flitting sparrow, like a flying swallow, so a curse without cause shall not alight.”.

Cycle. A repeating pattern. Ecclesiastes 1:9 “That which has been is what will be, that which is done is what will be done, and there is nothing new under the sun.”.

Deliverance. The act of being freed by God from spiritual oppression, bondage, or influence, resulting in restored alignment with His will and purpose. Psalm 34:17 “The righteous cry out, and the Lord hears, and delivers them out of all their troubles.”.

Deliverance by Light. Freedom through God’s truth and revelation. Psalm 119:130 “The entrance of Your words gives light; It gives understanding to the simple.”.

Discern. To perceive spiritually. Hebrews 4:12 “For the word of God is living and powerful...”.

Divine Government. God’s rule. Isaiah 9:7 “Of the increase of His government and peace There will be no end...”.

Divine Jurisdiction. The realm where God exercises authority. Psalm 24:1 “The earth is the Lord’s, and all its fullness, The world and those who dwell therein.”.

Divine Law. The laws and standards established by God. Psalm 19:7 “The law of the Lord is perfect, converting the soul; The testimony of the Lord is sure, making wise the simple.”.

Divine strategy. God-given plans. Proverbs 16:9 “A man’s heart plans his way, but the Lord directs his steps.”.

Divine structure. The order in which God arranges things. 1 Corinthians 14:40 “Let all things be done decently and in order.”.

Dominion. Authority to rule. Genesis 1:26 “Let Us make man in Our image... let them have dominion...”.

Enervated. To be drained of strength spiritually, emotionally, or physically. Isaiah 40:29 “He gives power to the weak, and to those who have no might He increases strength.”.

Epistemic Justice. Right alignment of knowledge, ensuring truth is honored. Spiritually, it is seeing as God sees. John 8:32 “And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.”.

Ecclesiastical Authority. The divinely sanctioned or institutionally recognized power exercised within the Church to teach, govern, and administer the sacraments. Ecclesiastical authority encompasses the roles of clergy, bishops, councils, and other church leaders in maintaining doctrinal integrity, guiding worship, and upholding moral and spiritual discipline. Its legitimacy is measured by fidelity to Scripture, adherence to tradition, and alignment with God’s covenant purposes Matthew:18–19 fiAnd I also say to you that you are Peter, and on this rock I will build My church, and the gates of Hades shall not prevail against it, and I will give you the keys of the kingdom of Heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will be bound in Heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in Heaven."

Fragrance. A spiritual “aroma” representing worship, character, or sacrifice rising to God. 2 Corinthians 2:15 “For we are to God the fragrance of Christ among those who are being saved and among those who are perishing.”.

Forgiveness as warfare. Using forgiveness to break demonic strongholds. Matthew 6:14 “For if you forgive

men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you.”.

Gehenna. Gehenna is a symbolic term used in the New Testament—especially by Jesus—to describe divine judgment. Unlike Sheol (the neutral realm of the dead), Gehenna carries connotations of fiery destruction, covenant accountability, and prophetic reckoning. It originates from the “Valley of Hinnom,” a real geographic site outside Jerusalem with a dark history of idolatry and child sacrifice. In Jesus’ teachings, Gehenna functions as a metaphor for the consequences of rejecting God’s kingdom. Matthew 5:28 “Don’t be afraid of those who kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul. Rather, fear him who is able to destroy both soul and body in Gehenna.” (World English Bible).

Generational Patterns. Behaviors inherited through lineage. Exodus 20:5 “...visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children to the third and fourth generations of those who hate Me...”.

Gifting. God-given abilities. Romans 12:6 “Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us...”.

Glossalalia. Speaking in tongues—Spirit-empowered prayer or utterance. 1 Corinthians 14:2 “For he who speaks in a tongue does not speak to men but to God, for no one understands him; however, in the spirit he speaks mysteries.”.

Governance. Oversight and management under God. Proverbs 29:2 “When the righteous are in authority, the people rejoice; But when a wicked man rules, the people groan.”.

Hasmonean Rulers. The Jewish priest-kings who governed Judea following the Maccabean Revolt (2nd–1st century BCE). Descended from the Maccabee family, the Hasmoneans combined religious and political authority, expanding Jewish autonomy and restoring national sovereignty after Seleucid oppression. Their dynasty shaped the political and cultural landscape of Judea leading up to the rise of Rome and the world of the New Testament.

Heart. The central place, or core, of a person. One's deepest longings come from the heart. Romans 10:9–10 “fi...believe in your heart that God has raised Him from the dead....for with the heart one believes unto righteousness...” Proverbs 4:23 “Keep your heart with all diligence, for out of it spring the issues of life.”.

Humility. A submitted and lowly posture. James 4:6 “God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble.”.

Identify the curse. Discern spiritual hindrances. Lamentations 3:40 “Let us search out and examine our ways, and turn back to the Lord.”.

Insula. A region of the brain linked to emotion and awareness. Spiritually tied to discernment. Psalm 139:23 “Search me, O God, and know my heart; try me, and know my anxieties.”.

Jezebel. Ruling spirit of control, manipulation, and witchcraft. Revelation 2:20 “...that woman Jezebel, who calls herself a prophetess...”.

Judgement. God’s righteous decision- making. Psalm 9:7–8 “But the Lord shall endure forever; He has prepared His throne for judgment. He shall judge the world in righteousness, And He shall administer judgment for the peoples in uprightness.”.

Jurisdiction. Area of legal authority. Matthew 8:9 “For I also am a man under authority, having soldiers under me...”.

Kosmokrator. From the Greek kosmokrator (“world-ruler”), a term used in the New Testament to describe powerful spiritual beings who exercise dominion over the present evil age. It refers to high-ranking demonic powers that influence worldly systems, cultures, and authorities in opposition to God’s kingdom, the cosmic scale of spiritual conflict and the adversary’s rule within a fallen world order. Ephesians 6:12, fiFor we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.”

Latin Vulgate. The Latin Vulgate is the late-4th century Latin translation of the Bible produced primarily by St. Jerome at the request of Pope Damasus I. It became the standard biblical text for the Western Church for over a millennium.

Legal act. Heavenly or spiritual transaction. Colossians 2:14 “Having wiped out the handwriting of requirements that was against us... And He has taken it out of the way, having nailed it to the cross.”.

Leviathan. Ruling spirit of pride that twists the truth. Job 41:34 “He beholds every high thing; He is king over all the children of pride.”.

Maccabean Revolt. The Jewish uprising (167–160 BCE) led by the Maccabee family against the Seleucid Empire after King Antiochus IV Epiphanes outlawed Jewish worship and desecrated the Jerusalem Temple. The revolt restored Jewish religious freedom, purified the Temple, and established the Hasmonean dynasty.

Mammon. Ruling spirit behind the love of power and wealth. Matthew 6:24 “You cannot serve God and mammon.”.

Mandate. God’s authoritative assignment. Jeremiah 1:5 “Before I formed you in the womb, I knew you...”.

Martin Luther the Reformer. A 16th-century German theologian and Augustinian monk who challenged abuse in the Church, which sparked the Protestant Reformation. By teaching salvation by grace through faith, the authority of Scripture, and the priesthood of all believers, Luther reshaped Western Christianity. His writings—such as the Ninety- Five Theses, On the Freedom of a Christian, and his German Bible translation—established key Protestant doctrines and made Scripture accessible to ordinary people.

Matrix. A metaphor for the unseen system of powers, patterns, and influences that shape human perception and behavior within a fallen world. In theological usage, “the matrix” refers to the constructed reality governed by spiritual forces opposed to God—an environment that blinds, conditions, and conforms people to deceptive norms. It represents the world-order (cosmos) animated by lies, idolatry, and false identities, from which Christ frees humanity through revelation, truth, and new creation life.

Mosaic Legitimacy. The divine authority grounded in the covenant that God established through Moses at Sinai. Mosaic legitimacy refers to leaders, laws, or actions that align with the Torah, uphold God’s commandments, and operate within the framework of the Mosaic covenant. It is the standard by which Israel’s kings, priests, and prophets were measured —rooted in obedience to God’s revealed will and fidelity to the law given through Moses.

Neurology. Study of the nervous system; spiritually, how renewal transforms the mind. Romans 12:2 “And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind.”.

Order. A God-established alignment of authority, timing, and action that restores justice and removes what opposes God’s purposes. 1 Corinthians 14:33 “For God is not the author of confusion but of peace...”.

Paradigms. Systems of belief that shape perception. Proverbs 23:7 “For as he thinks in his heart, so is he.”.

Paradox. A situation where two truths coexist, seemingly in tension. 2 Corinthians 12:10 “Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in needs, in persecutions, in distresses, for Christ’s sake. For when I am weak, then I am strong.”.

Partnership. Working together. Amos 3:3 “Can two walk together, unless they are agreed ?”.

Pedagogy of Redemption. God’s instructional movement through Scripture that leads humanity to Christ—the fulfillment of the Law and the Prophets. Matthew 5:17: “Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I have come not to abolish but to fulfill.”.

Reassign. Refers to the act of bringing spiritual, emotional, and atmospheric influences that once operated under demonic distortion into submission to Christ’s authority so they may serve righteousness instead of rebellion. In Kingdom practice, reassignment occurs after judgment has been rendered and a stronghold has been cast down. Once an influence is removed from its illegitimate seat of authority, it is not merely expelled, it is redeployed to advance justice, healing, and divine order. Reassignment is not about commanding people, controlling spirits, or weaponizing prayer. Rather, it is the exercise of restorative judgment by calling everything that once served destruction to now serve redemption. Luke 11:21–22 “When a strongman, fully armed, guards his own palace, his goods are in peace, but when a stronger man than he comes upon him and overcome him he takes from him all his armor in which he trusted, and divides his spoil.”.

Rebellion. Resistance against God. 1 Samuel 15:23 “For rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft...”.

Redemptive Provocation. A divine stirring challenging a person toward transformation. Hebrews 12:11 “Now no chastening seems to be joyful for the present, but painful; nevertheless, afterward it yields the peaceable fruit of righteousness to those who have been trained by it.”.

Repentance. Turning away from sin. Acts 3:19 “Repent therefore and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out, so that times of refreshing may come from the presence of the Lord.”.

Ruler of the World. A title describing the dominion Satan usurped from a fallen creation. Originally the anointed cherub, Lucifer, rebelled against Yahweh, seeking to distort God’s character and overturn His order. When Adam fell, the authority God entrusted to humanity was forfeited and seized by the adversary. For this reason, Scripture refers to Satan as “the ruler of this world” and “the prince of the power of the air,” highlighting his temporary influence within the present age until Christ’s final triumph. John 12:31 “Now is the judgment of this world; now the ruler of this world will be cast out.” Ephesians 2:2 “... in which you once walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit who now works in the sons of disobedience...”.

Sanctify. To make holy. John 17:17 “Sanctify them by Your truth. Your word is truth.”.

Self-dependence. Relying on self over God. Proverbs 3:5 “Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and lean not in your own understanding.”.

Sheol. Sheol is the ancient Hebrew term for the realm of the dead. Isaiah 14:9 “Sheol beneath is stirred up to meet you when you come; it rouses the shades to greet you, all who were leaders of the earth; it raises from their thrones all who were kings of the nations.”.

Sigil. A symbol created for occult purposes. Spiritually forbidden. Deuteronomy 18:10–12 “There shall not be found among you anyone who makes his son or his daughter pass through the fire, or one who practices witchcraft... For all who do these things are an abomination to the Lord.”.

Singularity of Purpose. The state of being fully aligned to one God-given mission. Matthew 6:22 “The lamp of the body is the eye. If therefore your eye is good, your whole body will be full of light.”.

Socio-Cultural Phenomena. Patterns in society that influence behavior. 1 John 2:15 “Do not love the world or the things in the world.”.

Spiritual Authority. The power that God gives believers. Matthew 10:1 “And when He had called His twelve disciples to Him, He gave them power over unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal all kinds of sickness and all kinds of disease.”.

Spiritual principles. Heavenly laws governing life. Galatians 6:7 “Do not be deceived, God is not mocked; for whatever a man sows, that he will also reap.”.

Spiritual revelation. Truth revealed by the Spirit. Ephesians 1:17 “That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give to you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of Him.”.

Stronghold. A fortified pattern of thinking. 2 Corinthians 10:4 “For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds.”.

Sub-contrario. A way God reveals His Kingdom “under the opposite.” In Scripture and the life of the Kingdom, God’s true power, wisdom, and authority appear beneath forms that seem weak, ordinary, or insignificant by worldly standards. The Kingdom is hidden except to those with spiritual sight, its authority is real yet unseen, its wisdom runs contrary to human logic. Sub-contrario describes this divine pattern whereby glory is veiled in humility, strength is carried in weakness, and God’s reign is present but disguised, requiring seekers to perceive beyond appearances. Hebrews 1:1–2 “God, who at various times and in various ways spoke in time past to the fathers by the prophets, has in these last days spoken to us by His Son, whom He has appointed heir of all things, through whom also He made the worlds.” John 18:33–38 “My Kingdom is not of this world”.

Submission. Yielding to God’s authority. James 4:7 “Therefore submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you.”.

System. A structure or order, natural or spiritual, that governs operation. Psalm 119:89–91 “Forever, O Lord, Your word is settled in Heaven... They continue this day according to Your ordinances.”.

Talent. Natural abilities and gifts. Matthew 25:15 “And to one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one...”.

Whisperer. One who spreads subtle gossip or strife. Genesis 3:1 “Now the serpent was more cunning than any beast of the field...and he said to the woman, Has God indeed said ...?”.

Wisdom. The ability to apply God’s truth rightly. Proverbs 4:7 “Wisdom is the principal thing; therefore get wisdom.”.

Zeal. Passionate devotion. Romans 12:11 “Not lagging in diligence, fervent in spirit, serving the Lord.”.

About the Author

Kirby de Lanerolle serves as the Presiding Bishop of the Apostolic Diocese of Ceylon, where he oversees 800 churches. He is committed to protecting the rights of persecuted Christian minorities, spiritual awakening, doctrinal integrity, and the restoration of apostolic Christianity for the modern world. He and his wife Fiona co-founded WOW Life Church in 2006, now a global movement shaping the spiritual landscape of Sri Lanka and beyond. Kirby's academic background spans theology, neuroscience, psychology, and mental health, with advanced studies at King's College London and the University of Pennsylvania. His unique ability to integrate biblical revelation with cutting-edge scientific understanding has positioned him as a sought-after teacher on identity, transformation, and the nature of spiritual conflict. Before entering full-time ministry, Kirby served for over two decades as an advisor to the Sri Lankan Cabinet and Government, becoming one of the youngest national advisors of his time. His philanthropic and social-impact work has earned him multiple national recognitions, including awards from both the Speaker of Parliament and the President of Sri Lanka. His journey into the faith was forged through deep personal conviction. Having witnessed and personally experienced the destructive influence of occult spiritual wickedness infiltrating governmental, corporate, and even religious spheres, Kirby came to believe that the Church is God's answer to a world entangled in hidden systems of bondage. Through his own redemption and

deliverance, he carries a mandate to equip the Body of Christ to discern, overcome, and break free from the spiritual forces that seek to undermine human destiny. His teachings, including those in this book, flow from a life shaped by encounter, scholarship, and decades of pastoral leadership. Kirby writes with a single aim: to liberate captives, awaken purpose, and strengthen believers for the times in which we live.

Acknowledgments

I would like to extend my special thanks to Zach Hall and Yami Soto for their invaluable help that made the impossible dream a reality, to Amelia Larby for her youthful exuberance and ready solutions, and to Ian D. Westerman—author of *Longevity for the Mind and Body* amongst other excellent titles—who patiently guided us through the Amazon jungle. To Darren, Elijah, and Jude, of Wow Media Productions, who created the most elegant, thought provoking, and complementary designs, my sincere appreciation. You carry the heart of service without seeking attention, working with a dedication that is difficult to express fully in words. You show up with willingness, patience, and a gentle spirit that never pressures but always supports. You read the moment, understand my rhythm, finish my sentences, and somehow capture me from the angles that speak the truest. I extend my deepest and most heartfelt thanks to Sylvia Bryden, Fezile and Nkrumah Mauncho—the regional heads of WOW Life Africa and WOW Life East Africa—and Virginia Clay. Together, they not only initiated and facilitated this project, but they also authored most of the work. This amazing team faithfully shaped my concepts, revelations, and teachings into a coherent, accessible manuscript. They carried the weight of the project with humility, brilliance, and unwavering commitment. Their leadership, spiritual insight, and deep love for the Church shaped every stage of this book. Quite simply, it would not exist without them.

And lastly, Fiona—my Moana, my wife—your humor, joy, and deep wisdom transform my intensity into life and light. Thank you.

To Africa — beloved, rising, and stepping into her new season of light.

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